

The Traditions—Our Way of Unity

The Thirty-Second Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

1982

Final Report

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April 18-24**

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Regional Map Of U.S. and Canada

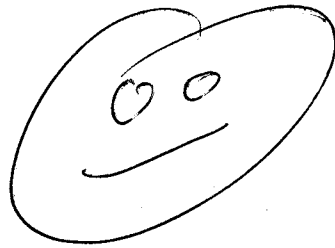
A.A. Regional Forums: See trustee committee and staff reports, page 40.

Regional trustees: See talks by retiring trustees, pages 7-8; report of trustees' Nominating Committee, page 42; Advisory Action 30, page 49; brief biographies, pages 58-59.

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The Conference Process—Unity in Action

Opening day



With a symbolic transfer of the gavel, Milton Maxwell (left) greets the new chairperson of the General Service Board, Gordon Patrick.

Taking as its theme "The Traditions—Our Way of Unity," the 32nd General Service Conference was an example of unity in action. From April 18 to 24, 1982, New York's Roosevelt Hotel hosted Panel 31 and 32 delegates, trustees, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff—for a total of 130 Conference members, plus many behind-the-scenes workers. It was a week filled with tireless dedication for all. Even with some disagreement and emotional responses, the Conference was finally and remarkably unified under the loving care of a Higher Power.

On Sunday afternoon, a sharing session served as an icebreaker, during which all Conference members introduced themselves and the following spoke briefly to the question "How does it feel to be a Conference member?": Bill Flynn, John Ryall, Virginia Turner, Lois Fisher, Maurice Welch, and Jill Johnston. Feelings of gratitude, joy, and deep responsibility were shared — "We are listening for many lives."

A jubilant mood pervaded the Sunday-evening dinner in the Grand Ballroom. Conference members, spouses, friends, and other guests were treated to an excellent meal followed by a moving A.A. meeting. Chairperson Webb Johnson (Panel 31, British Columbia/Yukon) introduced speakers Blackie Brandon (Panel 31, Western Missouri), Gertrude Brown (Panel 31, North Carolina/Bermuda), Janet Graves (Grapevine and G.S.O. literature consultant), and June Russell (G.S.O. staff member).

The opening session began on Monday morning in the Terrace Room with a welcome by Milton Maxwell, General Service Board chairperson, who shared thoughts on unity and the Conference process. Bob Pearson (G.S.O. general manager and Conference vice-chairperson) conducted the roll call, which was followed by a welcome address by Stan Brys (Panel 31, Northern New Jersey), area delegate chairperson. The keynote address was given by George Dorsey (Pacific U.S. regional trustee).

The official agenda began with the General Service Board report by Milton Maxwell, who informed the Conference that he would be retiring after the board meeting on Saturday, April 24, 1982. Thus began a hectic, often tiring week filled with committee meetings, reports, workshops, presentations, and Ask-It Basket sessions.

On Thursday evening, the "What's on Your Mind?" sharing session gave Conference members an opportunity to air questions or considerations not on the official agenda. A broad range of topics was discussed, including: the rotation principle as concerns nontrustee, nondirector members of trustees' committees; the principle of nonaffiliation and contributions made by clubs in the name of A.A. groups; questions about blind and otherwise handicapped alcoholics; and the issue of copyright in A.A. literature. It was a lively and spirited session despite the late hour.

Although proceedings appeared to be bogged down at one point, the Conference wound up on schedule on Friday afternoon, and the closing brunch on Saturday morning provided a relaxing ending to a productive and rewarding week, during which the principle of unity had again been affirmed in the Conference process.

The pre-Conference hubbub at G.S.O. included visits by many early-bird delegates, arriving for informal hellos and tours of the new quarters. On Friday, April 16, the 4-6-8 Meeting of A.A. was the first one held in the new and spacious conference room on the fifth floor. There was a feeling of beginnings in the air, and pre-Conference anticipation abounded. Among those present was Joan D. of New York, who would celebrate her first anniversary at the end of Conference week. Last year, Joan's old college friend June Boranian (Hawaii) had taken her to her first meeting on the day following the Conference (which was also June's 15th anniversary). This year, June and Joan would celebrate their anniversaries together. Reflecting on this experience, June remarked: "God goes to any lengths to make a Twelfth Step call. He got me elected delegate and sent me 5,000 miles to phone a friend I hadn't seen or talked to for 32 years."

Keynote

'Unity may be that simple'

The need for unity was clear from our beginning. Bill needed Dr. Bob to hold on to his own shaky sobriety. With Dr. Bob barely dry, both realized that they would have to find other alcoholics and share what they had found, or they would probably lose it.

As A.A. grew and groups formed around the country, there was recognition that, just as we could not go it alone individually, so the groups would have to work together in essential harmony to find ways to meet our purpose as a fellowship—staying sober and carrying the A.A. message. There was a lot of trial and error: public anonymity breaks, fund-raising efforts, membership rules, and other usually well-intentioned activities that had to be reconsidered. Two pioneers of California A.A. recall that the original group in Southern California battled to prevent the forming of new groups, apparently feeling that it held the exclusive A.A. "franchise."

As a result of those turbulent days, our founders realized that certain actions, however worthwhile they might seem, were a danger to the unity of the Fellowship. All of that experience—the consciousness of the danger of public controversy, the appreciation of limits, the understanding of our individual foibles, and the need for personal and collective humility—led to the forming of the principles incorporated in our Twelve Traditions. The First Tradition is almost a preamble, telling us what all the Traditions are for. The Traditions, in their spiritual lesson of sacrifice, can be vital for personal recovery; more than that, they tell us what we need do and cannot do if we are to preserve the unity that is indispensable for personal recovery. Above all, the Traditions spell out A.A.'s "Way of Unity."

We often talk about the letter vs. the spirit of Traditions. Perhaps this isn't the right way to look at it; we all want to observe both the letter and the spirit. It might be better to think about what the Traditions really *are*, and just what it is we *do* with them.

It seems to me that the Traditions are principles of a very spiritual intent, not laws or regulations. Legalistic and semantic argument about the meaning of their simple language is inappropriate and weakens their spiritual force. If we read "A.A. Comes of Age" and the "Twelve and Twelve," we don't need cracker-barrel lawyers to interpret the Traditions. Our individual and group consciences can be trusted to give us the answers if we are honest with ourselves and keep foremost in our minds and hearts their simple spiritual purpose.

What is it we do, as members and as groups, with the Traditions? I like to hear us say that we "observe," "embrace," or best of all, "honor" them. These are things I can try to do personally, and as a part of the collective conscience of my group and the service committees and boards on which I serve. I'm not good at "imposing" or "enforcing" the Traditions, though I've tried at times. "Calling attention to" or "reminding" is about as far as I now want to go with others, and even then, quite gently if I want to be effective.

Attempts to use and enforce the Traditions in a way contrary to what they stand for may arise from ego and power drive, but more often from fear, lack of thought, and misguided protectiveness. Public voicing of anger at an anonymity break may do more damage to A.A. than the break itself. A.A. unity would not survive if our manner suggested that we were trying to drive people out. Once, I adamantly felt that A.A.'s working in the alcoholism field should not participate in service. In time, I saw that there was nothing to fear and realized that if we believed in the Third Tradition, we could not have two classes of members, one of which was ineligible to serve.

Inventory-taking is healthy. We are never going to fix everything, reach perfection, as a fellowship any more than we do as individuals. So we keep working. A.A. today seems well aware and observant of the Traditions. As long as the vast majority of us continue to truly honor the Traditions, disunity is impossible.

While I was working on this talk, without much progress, I had to put it aside to go chair a small discussion group. At the meeting, I asked if anyone had a discussion topic, and a member wanted to talk about A.A. unity. Astonished but delighted, I whipped out pen and notepaper. Here are some of the comments of this very basic little group in downtown San Francisco:

"It's the togetherness that keeps me sober." "We're all in the

same boat." "We hang together or we hang separately." "In A.A., we're equal; we got no big shots; we got no little shots; but we're all shot if we take one shot." And "Everywhere in Alcoholics Anonymous we find the same spiritual force." Unity may be that simple—nothing more, nothing less.

George Dorsey, Pacific U.S. regional trustee

Welcome

A living tree with long roots

About 22½ years ago, September 30, 1959, I unknowingly began a journey to this podium. I was a few long blocks from here, on the Bowery. My arrival here was made possible, not by me, but by this God-given program and the hundreds of people in A.A. who were kind and loving enough to show me the way.

Preparing for this Conference, I found myself a bit uneasy, and the theme, "The Traditions—Our Way of Unity," prompted me to start taking my Twelve Traditions inventory. Questions like the following started cropping up. Am I so busy giving fellowship that I have forgotten how to accept some? Do I wear a sheath of plastic egotism to hide the real me from others? Do I criticize or trust and support my group's officers, my area's committees? Am I absolutely trustworthy, even in secret, with any A.A. responsibility? Do I try to rule out of my A.A. anybody who does not meet my requirements for membership? Have I built up a wall of rejection around my A.A., a wall so thick that it can leave me isolated—back where I came from? Do I constantly remind myself that my political and religious beliefs and my personal ambition have no room in my A.A. life? Am I careful not to be fanatic about this program that I love so much?

At this point, I said, "Halt. It's time to stop being hard on myself." This is a form of bossism, and bossism is contrary to our Traditions. Let us then get on with the business at hand, setting the theme for our Conference. The Traditions are really an extension of the Steps, helping me practice these principles in all my affairs. They have taught me what little I know about staying out of other people's way as well as out of my own way. The secret of their strength lies in the fact that they spring out of living experiences and have long roots of love and fellowship.

Stan Brys (Northern New Jersey), delegate chairperson

Delegates meeting

Role of past delegates examined

Conference delegates (Panels 31 and 32) met informally on Tuesday evening, April 20, after dining together. The discussion began with a reminder by Bill Bailey (Panel 31, West Virginia) not to spend the whole meeting deciding what to talk about. The delegates agreed to talk about anything but to spend a minimum amount of time on Conference topics. A lively evening was shared by all. Topics discussed ranged from the service role of past delegates to the current ceiling for delegates' expenses.

Contributions were collected to buy candy, flowers, and fruit for G.S.O. secretaries in honor of National Secretaries' Week. Chairperson Stan Brys (Panel 31, Northern New Jersey) reminded delegates to encourage group celebrations of June 10 as A.A.'s birthday, according to a resolution of the 1981 delegates meeting.

Jill Johnston (Panel 32, Southern Indiana) was elected as the new delegate chairperson and Barney John Malik (Panel 32, Western Ontario) as alternate chairperson.

Conference sidelights

While our hardworking delegates were totally involved with Conference commitments, their spouses were hosted by a committee of New York A.A.'s and Al-Anons who saw to it that no one had too much idle time. Beginning on Monday, April 19, events were scheduled each day that were designed to entertain our guests with local sights and restaurants, as well as visits to homes of A.A. members. Monday: the Federal Reserve Bank; a walking tour of historical Lower Manhattan; lunch in the World Trade Center. Tuesday: Lincoln Center; lunch at the Allegro Restaurant; the film "The New York Experience." Wednesday: the U.N.; lunch in the delegates' lounge there; various theaters. Thursday: Brooklyn Heights; the harbor-side promenade; the house on Clinton Street where Lois and Bill once lived; the Long Island Museum; an artist's studio; the Empire State Building; G.S.O. The week was rounded out on Friday with the sightseer's paradise—a Circle Line boat trip around Manhattan. Many local A.A.'s and Al-Anons pitched in to make the week an active and enjoyable one for our delegates' "better halves." . . . Statistics in terms of years give a quick composite sketch of the 1982 Conference delegate. In age, the 91 ranged from 34 to 73 years, averaging 54; in length of sobriety, from 5½ to 29, averaging 12¾; in length of A.A. service activity, from 4½ to 24, averaging 10¼.

Closing brunch

A.A. paradox—sadness and joy

A week of hard work and dedication culminated on Saturday morning at the closing brunch of the 1982 General Service Conference. Bob Pearson opened the meeting and introduced Milton Maxwell, who then introduced outgoing delegate chairperson Stan Brys (Northern New Jersey). The new delegate chairperson, Jill Johnston (Southern Indiana), read "How It Works."

After offering a few personal remarks about the Conference, Bob Pearson thanked those who worked on the Conference and its publications, including Tony Osnato, Cindy Katzman, Louis D'Amelio, Elizabeth Garcia, Adeline Wilmot, Janet Graves, Dorothy Graham, Ann Warner, and Betty Liddle (Conference coordinator).

Rotating trustees Fern Ippersiel and George Dorsey gave informative and stimulating farewell talks. In his closing remarks, Milton Maxwell said goodbye to the Conference, citing a health problem as his reason for retiring. Dr. Maxwell has been named a chairperson emeritus, joining "Dr. Jack" Norris in our linkage to the past. It was a sad but joy-filled

occasion for all as Dr. Maxwell introduced his successor, Gordon Patrick, who led us in the Lord's Prayer.

The farewell talks of Fern Ippersiel, George Dorsey, and Milton Maxwell are excerpted here.



In 1950, Nell Wing (right) served as a G.S.O. receptionist, among other chores. As 1982 ends, she'll retire as archivist, with memories spanning A.A. history.



Thank you, Nell

Fern Ippersiel, Eastern Canada regional trustee, expressed gratitude for finding A.A. more than 21 years ago. Then, he began to speak about Nell Wing, with whom he has worked closely for many years. (Nell was recovering from surgery and therefore unable to attend this year's Conference.)

"This morning, I would like to talk first about one person who's not here and who's very sad not to be here—our friend Nell Wing, the archivist, who's been working with Bill W. and the office for 35 years without having been sick, it seems to me, during all those years.

"When I came here as a delegate in 1968-69, after working during many years at the translation of the Big Book into French—we published it in 1963—I was, of course, fascinated by meeting Bill for the first time. I was also fascinated by Bill during all the years I knew him. At the same time, I met Nell Wing. We should take note of the friendship that exists for so many years between the two women who were so important in Bill's life—Lois and Nell. Sometimes, I wonder—if Bill and Dr. Bob had not been well supported by women dedicated to A.A. and to them personally, would A.A. be successful today?"

Fern then described the history of A.A. in his area and the changes since he became a trustee.

"I have a grateful heart for the privilege to work with human beings of the quality of Dr. Jack Norris and Dr. Maxwell, who've given to A.A. more than 30 years of their lives. They are the links with Dr. Bob and with Bill. And it has also been a privilege to work with Gordon Patrick.

"I just want to underline these principles: (1) Don't take your first drink today—that's the basic; (2) the principle of rotation; and (3) be careful, please, when you spend our members' money. The rotation principle will save us from any would-be

dictator. It's not easy for those who rotate, but it's very good for the A.A. movement.

"I suggest that you invite Nell Wing to your Conference next year. She has so much to tell you."

Rhythm—in recovery and in the Conference

George Dorsey, Pacific U.S. regional trustee, gave an inspiring and humorous farewell talk, enriched with many anecdotes about his Conference experiences.

"I feel very good about the state of the Fellowship. My only real concern is something that happens as institutions mature and grow powerful. A.A. is mature; although we don't like the word 'powerful,' you have to pin that label on us in view of our size and what we've done in the world. As this happens to an institution, it can become preoccupied with itself, get over-organized, try to perfect everything, iron out all the problems, become jealous of its image—and forget what it's there for.

"I don't feel that that is going to happen to A.A., because our purpose is so totally simple, so completely spiritual, and so absolutely necessary for each and every one of us. The purpose of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic is essential to the sobriety and therefore the survival of every member of A.A.

"During this week, I've been thinking about what I call rhythm. There's always been a kind of rhythm in my A.A. life, which makes it easy and natural for me to move on out of this scene. I've never done anything in A.A. for too long, never felt, 'This is exactly what I'm going to do forever in A.A.' I've had four years of this, and I think I have given of myself. So I'm ready to go now, and the rhythm is as natural as drinking coffee. It's time to open the door and go into another phase of A.A. life, and I can hardly wait to do it. So that's the rhythm in my own personal recovery.

"As a delegate, I was very dignified. As a trustee, I haven't always been too dignified. I have to have a sense of the occasional outrageousness and ridiculousness of what goes on here—because what goes on here is so important to me. The rhythm and the continuity of the Conference process are like an anthem in my heart. It is unimportant whether I am here or not. I find it tremendously moving and satisfying to know that this thing goes on, that we have this rhythm, and that *you* are still here."

'An internal harmony'

Milton Maxwell began his farewell talk as chairperson of the General Service Board by remembering the history of his long association with A.A., from the beginnings in Chicago in 1940 to the time, many years later, when he was asked to serve on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

"They'd never had a nonalcoholic, so they decided to look me over. I was taken to lunch at the Harvard Club, and I passed. And then came the time to be on the board of trustees, and then chairperson. All us Class A's were asked, 'Could you?' We all wrote, 'I couldn't,' including me. I had other commitments, and I didn't see how I had the time to do it. But I was asked to meet with the Nominating Committee. John Water-

field led me into the meeting. He had me by the arm—wasn't twisting it, except psychologically. He said, 'Milton, don't say no.' I went in there and began spilling out the reasons why I couldn't do it. All of a sudden, I heard myself saying, 'Okay.' For two months, I wondered whether I was guided—or nuts.

"Well, I'm grateful that I accepted. I'm grateful for the relationships and the support, for Bob, the staff, the directors, my fellow trustees, and Dr. Jack, to whom I could turn whenever I needed some perspective out of the past.

"One of the great things is that A.A. has most of its past experiences in writing. I visited Bill in his home at Stepping Stones. He put his feet on the desk in that little studio, looking out that big window at the trees. I said to him, 'You really have completed your contribution to A.A.'—with the writing of the Concepts.

"What Bill and Dr. Bob and other key persons helped to design is different, and I believe that A.A.'s survival and effectiveness lie in these very differences. In a general society characterized by competitive striving for status, recognition, power, and their material symbols, A.A. has a recovery program based upon opposite values—upon learning and an unself-centered way of life—never complete, but we make progress. Furthermore, A.A. has a collective life—Traditions, Concepts, minimum structure—that is remarkably in harmony with and supportive of the basic recovery program. There's no confusion of ends and means. There's an internal harmony of program and principles and practices that stands in striking contrast to the operations of most organizations and agencies.

"While it is true that no human organization lasts forever or is immune from drift or foundering, it appears to me that A.A. is provided with unusual assets for keeping itself on course. My faith in this survival was renewed and strengthened during this wonderful week."

Estimates of groups and members— spring 1982

	Groups	Members
United States	24,293	455,505
Canada	3,781	64,244
Overseas	17,650 ¹	354,465 ¹
Treatment facilities	935 ²	24,310 ²
Correctional facilities	1,138 ²	38,153 ²
Lone Members		493
Internationalists		535
	47,797	937,705

1 A.A. activity was reported in 108 overseas countries. Among them, 42 supplied no estimates of groups and members; estimates for figures there were obtained by taking an average among 60 countries that did respond (six others responding—the largest—were excluded).

2 U.S. and Canada only.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.

Searching Presentations Lay the Groundwork for Thoughtful Discussion

Presentations

Equal authority—equal responsibility

The first 1982 presentation/discussion, on Monday morning, was moderated by Mike Alexander, Class A trustee. Its topic, relevant to every type of A.A. service work, engrossed all Conference members.

Are G.S.O. staff members 'secretaries'?

Three years ago, when I was asked to join the G.S.O. staff, I thought staff members should be no more than secretaries, with no authority or voting privileges. They had not worked their way up through the "A.A. service ranks" as I had, so how could they possibly know about the real roots of A.A.?

After joining the staff, I began to realize that as my responsibilities grew, so did the occasions when I found it necessary to exercise authority. This was vital in carrying out my duties and getting the job done. In my current assignment as coordinator of Regional Forums, responsibilities include making arrangements with the host-city A.A. contact and the hotel representative and thus making decisions about meeting spaces, floor plans for the displays, and perhaps the availability of microphones. Because these authorities are well defined in the job description, I have felt no need to take the decision-making process to any other level of authority. I am, therefore, free to exercise the operational authority that helps me to get the job done more quickly and effectively.

On the Conference floor, each member votes according to his or her own conscience. This, of course, is in keeping with the traditional "Right of Decision." Members determine which matters the Conference will decide by itself and which it will refer back to the groups for further discussion. This final voting privilege gives all Conference members authority equal to their real responsibility.

Today, I understand there are other ways to "come up through the A.A. service ranks," including the daily experience of having to answer the hundreds of letters that pour into G.S.O. By hearing this voice of A.A. as a whole, staff members are in a position to relay this message to the Conference floor. I have come to respect the delegated authority needed to meet each service responsibility—and thereby to help carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

Lyla Bonney, G.S.O. staff

A special 'group business meeting'—the GV board

In preparation for this presentation, I spent some time going through old Grapevines and old writings by Bill. In reading Concept Ten, my thoughts went back to my group and its members, especially during the first years of my sobriety. "We have no bosses in A.A." was a statement I heard very often. Still, someone brought cake and milk and came early to make coffee and set things up for the group. The chairperson opened the meeting; the secretary read the announcements; and the treasurer took up the collection.

As a group member, I was invited to the business meetings. Sometimes I wished I was not there. But at those business meetings, I found out about the group conscience and who was the ultimate authority. Tradition Two tells me that the only authority is the group conscience and that we elect people to *serve* the



Pre-1982 visitors to the Grapevine offices entered the crowded space at left. Today, they wouldn't recognize the place. GV controller Don Meurer and executive secretary Naomi Strassberg are at the entrance to our magazine's editorial offices.

group, to do the odd jobs that fill our needs. If I want to be part of this group conscience, then I must participate. I was elected delegate for my area in 1977 and 1978. I was area Grapevine chairperson in 1979 and 1980. In 1981, I was appointed to the Grapevine Corporate Board.

"Equal authority — equal responsibility," as I see it as a GV director, means my authority is equal to a trustee's, a delegate's, or a staff member's, because my responsibility is equal to theirs. And in that responsibility, I have been made aware that all the experience I have had in service comes into play—it is simply another level of service. Our goal has to be what we look for at any level—an informed group conscience. The Corporate Board meetings have been interesting, and I have been grateful for the experience I have had in my group. On occasion, there has been great similarity!

As a new director, I have seen clearly the need for an informed group conscience and for the ability to work with other directors toward decisions good for our Fellowship as a whole. I am sometimes awestruck when what seems a very difficult problem is resolved beautifully by adhering to the principles of our program: trust in God, trust in our Legacies, and trust in each other.

Jim Shannon, director, Grapevine Corporate Board

A trustee sees a balance of powers

Our Twelve Concepts carefully delineate the traditions, customs, relationships, and legal arrangements that weld the General Service Board into a working harmony with its committees and its corporate arms—A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. If we can constantly keep uppermost in our consciousness the knowledge that our Fellowship is a spiritualized society, our democracy of service will work under all conditions.

The ultimate responsibility and authority for A.A. world service belong to the A.A. groups. But our groups and their members, scattered all over, cannot themselves actually manage our services. To avoid confusion, the groups have delegated administrative and operational authority to their Conference, which in turn has delegated authority to the General Service Board and its working entities.

A.A.'s board of trustees needs authority, leadership, and legal status in order to function at top effectiveness, because A.A. members hold the board responsible for the activities of the two subsidiary corporations, for our financial integrity, for our worldwide public relations, and for active guardianship of our Twelve Traditions.

Though the board of trustees is invested with complete legal power over A.A.'s funds and services, the Conference has such great traditional influence and financial power that, if necessary, it could overcome the legal rights of the trustees. Our present Conference Charter is so structured as to clearly give the Conference final authority and, at the same time, to legally preserve the trustees' right to function freely and adequately. Experience shows that this balance of powers is thoroughly workable.

If the Conference will always bear in mind the rights of the board, if the trustees in their deliberations will constantly realize that the Conference is the real seat of ultimate service authority, and if we remember at all times that the base of our service structure rests squarely on the dedication and ability of the G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, area committees, and Conference delegates—then grave issues can always be resolved, and harmonious cooperation will be the general rule.

David Aronofsky, trustee-at-large/U.S.

A time for blind faith

One Friday evening, a group of 11 adventurous delegates, including Doug Riley (Panel 32, Northwest Texas), attended an A.A. meeting some distance from the hotel. After the meeting, a kindhearted, hippie-type A.A. member offered them a ride back in his van. They accepted the offer gratefully, but as they entered the van—a no-window, no-seat contraption—and then sat all jumbled up every which way on the floor in total darkness, they experienced a moment of truth. Feeling like prisoners locked in a paddy wagon, our trusted servants decided it was a time for blind faith. Needless to say, they were safely deposited in front of the hotel, creating something of a sensation as they exited one by one from the innards of the sinister vehicle. It was another lesson in "Let go and let God."

Good delegates don't reinvent the wheel

A new member is asked by the group to chair a meeting. He has little experience, only a desire to remain sober. He arranges for a speaker, reads the Preamble, prepares coffee, passes the hat, presides over the discussion, and leads the group in the closing prayer. What has happened? The group has given him the authority to run a meeting, to act for them. He has accepted the responsibility and acts responsible.

This simple example of the authority/responsibility phenomenon leads to further development. As sobriety and spiritual health increase, he begins to see the wisdom of the structure, his patrimony. He believes that he can serve. He questions his own motives—love of recognition and praise?—shares his doubts with others, and receives encouragement. He enters service; it dawns on him that he has become a part of a worldwide spiritual union. Chosen by his fellows to perform sundry duties on their behalf, he acts for them, but gives no orders. He learns. He does not preach but tries to lead by example. He is elected as a delegate to the Conference. "What an order! I can't go through with it." But he does.

As delegate, he has been given the authority to act by his groups. They trust him enough not to bind him before he acts. Various members may not agree with his actions; he responds. He reports. He is accountable. He operates on the motive of "principles before personalities."

He finds an honest and just harmony in our structure. He does not seek to reinvent the wheel. One cannot, for example, initiate a referendum to all the groups on every issue, every problem. The authority to act, to decide, given to the delegate by his area ensures that the vital message is carried to the alcoholic, not fragmented or emasculated in bureaucracy. Our own area's preferences or disenchantments may not necessarily be best for the entire Fellowship. Shall we then deny the Fellowship our total experience, strength, and hope merely because we disagree with the ideas or actions of another branch of service or another area on a service issue? I think not!

While we gladly agree we must always act in the spirit of democratic principles, we are not consonant with the modern democratic practice of operating on the basis of majorities. We are a spiritual union, and we act on the basis of substantial unanimity. Our actions are decided by a sense of the Conference.

When we define authority, we generally conceive of a legal or rightful power, a right to command or act. In our beloved Fellowship, we have no right to command, but we do have the power to act on our fellows' behalf. This power, carefully harnessed and guided, is the energy that we exercise at the Conference. We must always remember—in committee, workshop, or general session—that others, too, have the right to function, using their own authority. Above all, ours is a collective responsibility. Let us act, each using our respective authorities in a manner truly responsible, for today's alcoholic and tomorrow's.

Lee Brooks (Eastern Pennsylvania)

Group records input from central offices/intergroups

With all 91 areas of the U.S. and Canada represented on the Conference floor, Monday evening's presentation/discussion provided an excellent opportunity to air problems in keeping our records up-to-date and accurate.

Let computers talk to each other?

Perhaps the most wrenching activity for Conference delegates is gathering names and addresses of newly elected G.S.R.'s or other group contacts each fall. From this collective effort come our U.S. and Canadian directories each spring. Reviewing

more than 30,000 group printouts is a monumental task even when divided among 91 delegates. (The average per delegate is about 330 groups, but the range goes from a comfortable 68 in Northwestern Ontario to a horrendous 902 in Southeastern New York.)

In recent years, many important improvements have been introduced into this process. Three seem worthy of reviewing here:

1 Obtaining our own computer reduced the turnaround or response time within G.S.O. from several months to one week. The turnaround begins when we receive notice of a change and ends when we can print that change onto a label, contribution statement, or printout. Now, relatively fresh printouts can be sent to delegates in the fall.

2 Doubling the collection period—from two months to four—lessened the crunch on delegates. Instead of hitting all groups in the area in November and December, a delegate can now begin as early as September if he or she chooses. All changes must still be received at G.S.O. by January 15 for publication in that year's directory, however.

3 Last summer, we began putting district numbers into our computer, when they were supplied by the areas. We can now provide printouts presorted by district number, simplifying the delegate's task.



G.S.O.'s computer is the responsibility of department head Chris Bradley. Through desk terminals, group information can be readily retrieved by Records Department employees like Shirley Steinberg.

Interestingly, a proposal has been put forward by the Los Angeles Central Office to provide a direct input—computer to computer—of information for groups listed there. A similar offer has emerged from Connecticut.

The advantages of direct input are obvious. Many groups are more directly and intimately involved with their local intergroups than with G.S.O., which sometimes has only a fraction of the groups and/or meetings listed in intergroup meeting books. The direct line would obviate all the delegate paperwork.

Disadvantages might be inherent also. Intergroups are usually not concerned with G.S.R.'s, but with group secretaries and chairpersons. G.S.R.'s are encouraged to remain in office for two years, while other group officers usually change every six months. Some intergroups serve only a portion of an area, such as a city; others, parts of several areas, such as a metropolis and its suburbs. In short, they are frequently out of sync with our

Conference areas. Also, for their purposes, such distinctions as groups vs. meetings may be different or nonexistent.

Achieving compatibility between separate computer systems may present some problems, but those problems would probably lend themselves to relatively speedy resolution.

Comments on this proposal are invited.

Frank Mauser, administrative assistant, G.S.O.

Why A.A. works—the Traditions

In groups of about ten each, Conference members went to 11 different rooms on Monday evening. Panel 31 delegates, trustees, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors served as moderators and secretaries at both this workshop and the second, later in the week. The following, drawn from the notes made in all 11 workshop groups, indicates the range of opinions and ideas.

Areas see A.A. principles in action

Most workshops responded to the background material on Traditions problems (items A through E), which were in fact not intended as questions. However, some valuable sharing resulted.

A "Conflicts arising about solicitations before, during, or after A.A. meetings in connection with alcoholism-related services"

Many areas are experiencing this problem, and all felt it to be a violation of Traditions. Most felt Traditions meetings (with emphasis on the Sixth) would help.

B "Anonymity"

Most areas are experiencing some problems, and the following are some of their shared solutions: (1) Have G.S.O. and/or area delegate write to or contact the person breaking his or her anonymity; (2) run Traditions workshops; (3) educate professional community through C.P.C. programs; (4) invite newspaper people to P.I. functions, and provide them with information; (5) read Traditions at group business meetings, and distribute "Why A.A. Is Anonymous" card and "Understanding Anonymity" pamphlet.

Some felt anonymity within A.A. or at the personal level was as much a Tradition break as lack of anonymity at the public level.

C "Nonalcoholic addicts and other non-A.A.'s attending closed meetings"

Most participants had some level of experience with this problem. Some felt educating treatment centers about A.A.'s relationship with problems other than alcohol was important. Others felt education of members at the group level was important. Some areas are able to refer nonalcoholic addicts to Narcotics Anonymous or other appropriate organizations. All felt problem should be dealt with lovingly.

D "Group decisions being made by individuals rather than by group conscience"

Some delegates are experiencing this problem, though not many

felt it was widespread. Most saw solutions in the group conscience and education of group members about the Second Tradition.

E "Rules concerning attendance at and participation in group meetings"

While some delegates experience this problem in their areas, others expressed surprise that it was occurring. Most felt there should be no rules for what is spoken of in an A.A. lead. One workshop participant suggested Rule 62: Cancel all rules!

1 "What do you consider to be the major Traditions problem in A.A. today?"

Almost unanimously, workshop participants felt it was lack of education and understanding of Traditions at the group level. One participant suggested explaining Traditions to help with group problems rather than using them to kick people out.

2 "How often are Traditions meetings held in your area? District? Group?"

"Not often enough," most participants felt.

3 "Are the Traditions in your area looked upon as principles to be voluntarily adhered to, or laws to be obeyed?"

Participants responded unanimously that the Traditions are (or should be) looked upon as principles to be adhered to voluntarily.

4 "What is the spiritual meaning of anonymity?"

Most participants saw it as self-sacrifice and humility. One put it this way: "That I *help* is what counts, not that I *do* it."

Advisory Actions mentioning Traditions: 10 (p. 47), 16 (p. 48)

Finance/new Conference locale

Tradition Seven loomed large in everyone's mind during the presentation/discussion held on Tuesday morning. The moderator was Tom Lepinskie (Northern Florida), alternate chairperson of the Conference Finance Committee.

How we run a big (and spiritual) business

In the beginning, A.A. had a difficult time financially. The fledgling service structure was barely able to get by on group contributions, plus some surplus from the sale of the Big Book. In later years, A.A. moved into a relatively better position—but not because the groups or members contributed more money. The total was greater, of course, since the Fellowship was constantly growing, but the total percent increase and the per capita contribution still failed to "pay the freight," as Bill used to say. Today, only a bit more than half of the groups listed in the U.S. and Canada contribute anything at all to the maintenance of services to the groups—services that the groups, through the Conference structure, have themselves requested. That structure, however, has taken positive steps to turn this situation around and, I am sure, will continue to work with the board to get the message across to the groups.



In 1950, Dennis Manders worked as a bookkeeper in a tiny room at G.S.O. In 1982, from his office as controller, he looks out on the spacious expanse of today's Accounting Department.



Part of the problem regarding G.S.O. finances is the lack of awareness of how big the Fellowship has become—and the extent and scope of the services required to reach that still-suffering alcoholic. The publishing operation is probably one of the least understood G.S.O. services. To the surprise of many visitors, A.A. World Services, Inc., does not have printing presses cranking out the literature at 468 Park Avenue South. A.A.W.S. publishes A.A. literature but hires printing companies to actually manufacture it. Last year, we published nearly 1,000,000 hardcover books and booklets, about 6,200,000 pamphlets, and hundreds of thousands of miscellaneous items. One printing of the Big Book, 200,000 copies (now no more than a five-month supply), requires over 350,000 pounds of paper, tons of board material for the covers, and thousands of yards of linen cover material—all purchased on a competitive-bid basis.

Such quantities of literature cannot be stored or handled at 468 Park Avenue South. Over the past 15 years, a distribution system has been developed to help carry the message, with central/intergroup offices playing the key role. We have warehouse locations in three states and in Canada to expedite shipments in bulk to those offices. We have storage and shipping facilities in printing plants in three other states and in Central America. More than 75% of our books and about half of all pamphlets shipped are now moved through those facilities, rather than G.S.O.'s Shipping Department. Groups are encouraged to get publications from the nearest central/intergroup office. That office calls an 800 number to relay the order to G.S.O.'s telex printer, which is also used to forward the order to the nearest warehouse. The literature is generally shipped from there within 24 hours.

As you can see, publishing takes a *lot* of money. For example, that single 200,000-copy printing of the Big Book currently requires about \$300,000. Of course, these A.A. dollars are not really expensed; they are converted into inventory. As

much as \$1,000,000 of A.A. money is invested in inventory at any given time. As the inventory is sold to the groups and central offices, it is turned back into dollars, which are again recycled.

Sales income pays all publishing expenses and a share of office expenses—with enough left over to pay other General Service Board expenses and cover the deficit in the group service cost created by the annual shortfall of group contributions.

Here are some facts and figures that help us realize the size and growth of the Fellowship. In 1975, 176,800 Big Books were distributed; in 1981, 430,800—an increase of 143%! In the same six-year period, the number of groups listed in the U.S. and Canada increased by 10,000, or 56%; groups worldwide, by 21,300, or 80%.

It was not my intention to razzle and dazzle, but to share and inform. Please ask plenty of questions. Ask me personally. If I don't have the answer, I will get it. Or drop your questions in the Ask-It Basket. Please don't leave here wondering.

Dennis Manders, controller/business administrator

'I am now a believer'

Since coming on the board in 1979, I occasionally suffer an identity problem: Are these reports from the chairperson of the Finance Committee or the treasurer of the board? The chairperson gives the factual information, and the treasurer gives the lectures. This report doesn't leave much room for lectures, so you will be mostly listening to the chairperson.

We were dismayed to see contributions running so far behind expectations by the latter part of the year 1980. Your G.S.O. contacted all groups and shared our concern. I have been told that when there is a need, it is only necessary to properly present that need, and the groups will respond accordingly. Well, you can bet that I am now a believer. Not only did the groups help to pull us out of a hole in 1980, but this effort continued through 1981, making the year one of the best contribution years in A.A. history—even allowing us to finish substantially ahead of our own budget predictions!

Contributions from groups and A.A. members totaled \$1,564,600 for 1981, compared with \$1,308,600 for 1980, a \$256,000 or 19.6% increase—we had budgeted for 8%. Net sales (after discounts to groups, \$191,500) totaled \$4,252,500, 11% over 1980. Total G.S.O. income—publishing gross profit, contributions, and interest generated by cash flow—was over 1980 by \$378,500, 2% over budget.

Adjusting for nonrecurring items (costs of construction and refurbishing and of upgrading our phone system in 1981; net Convention expense in 1980), increases in operating expenses amounted to \$395,600, 13% over 1980 and less than 1% over budget. Construction and refurbishing expenses are pretty much on target, but because construction is still ongoing, we cannot as yet give a final accounting of this project.

The 1982 G.S.O. budget has been reviewed in detail and approved by the committee. [See page 53.] It is prudent, making allowances for both A.A. growth and inflation. Both income and expenses are projected to reflect modest increases.

The Grapevine budget, also reviewed by the committee, reflects additional income as a result of subscription increases in 1980 and late 1981. Grapevine cost and expenses have been budgeted to show a decrease mainly as a result of improved price-shopping procedures and a change in printing methods.

As the Fellowship goes on expanding, rest assured that this committee will continue to keep a close and watchful eye on A.A.'s finances.

Frank Smeal, chairperson, trustees' Finance Committee, board treasurer

Alex Macaulay (Southeastern New York) was astonished to receive his travel-expense check when he arrived at the hotel on Sunday afternoon—a grand total of \$1.50. After all, Alex did have to buy two 75¢ subway tokens in order to travel to the Roosevelt and back to his home in New York City's Borough of Queens.

A look into the Fellowship's financial future

Long-range planning sometimes seems to be outside or even opposed to our cherished ideas. How does it relate to our sayings ("a day at a time"), our prayers ("Give us this day our daily bread"), our faith ("The Lord will provide")? There are things in A.A. that just wouldn't happen if planning didn't start well ahead of time. This Conference really began the day after last year's ended. Plans for our Conventions every five years start almost five years in advance.

So it really isn't out of order to look at trends that will affect G.S.O.'s well-being, to see whether any of them indicate actions we should take or plans we should make now. This report deals with major financial concerns: publishing income and costs, group contributions, and the cost of group services.

The unit sales price of our books has remained essentially constant over the past five years. The unit cost has increased about 15%—a remarkable achievement, since external publishing costs went up about 60% in the same period. Nevertheless, our costs will eventually catch up with and surpass our present prices. The unit sales price of our pamphlets has actually decreased 6% during the same period; the unit cost has increased 20%—compared with 70% externally. Here, too, costs will surpass our present prices. [See graphs, next page.]

The conclusion has to be that income from our publishing operations will vanish in the mid-1980's if our prices are not changed. What has shielded us from the effect of increased costs so far is increased volume of sales. That volume has made up for a decreased profit margin—but will amplify the deleterious effect once these operations begin losing money.

The Conference and the General Service Board have always hoped that group contributions would rise to the point where net income from the publishing operation would be unnecessary. In fact, over the past five years, contributions per group have risen 13% while service cost per group has risen 16%. (Of course, we have to keep in mind that inflation alone would have increased the cost by 39% per group. So we have been achieving a decrease in *real* cost.) Nevertheless, extrapolation

of past trends does not promise that group contributions will increase to cover the cost of group services.

We also need to look at trends in numbers of units: books, pamphlets, and listed groups. in 1986, when G.S.O.'s net income is estimated (by extrapolation) as a *negative* \$1,000,000, the sales of books will approach 2,000,000 units. An increase in price of 50¢ per book would generate the needed \$1,000,000. Other numbers extrapolated for 1986 are pamphlet sales reaching 9,000,000 units and a total of over 40,000 groups in the U.S. and Canada.

Some sources of income and expense—income from invest-

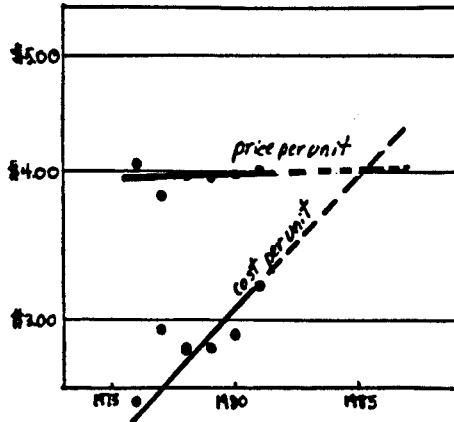
ment and miscellaneous items, and board expenses—are not included in this analysis, because they net out to an amount quite small compared with amounts we have been discussing.

There is a lot of approximation in drawing a trend line through past years' data, and even more in extending that trend line into the future. But the consequences for the future are well within our ability to manage. We ought to recognize today that we should plan either for an increase in our literature prices by about 1985 or for actions to bring about higher group contributions (perhaps double by 1985).

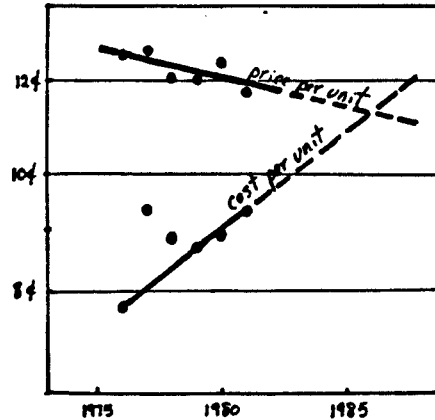
John Bragg, general service trustee

If we see a continuation of recent trends in . . .

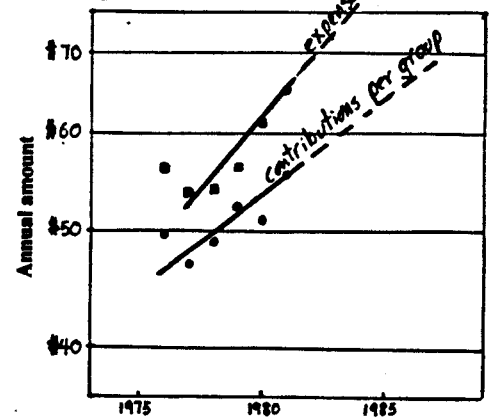
Book prices and costs



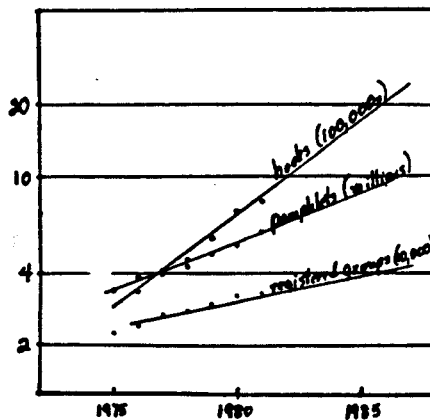
Pamphlet prices and costs



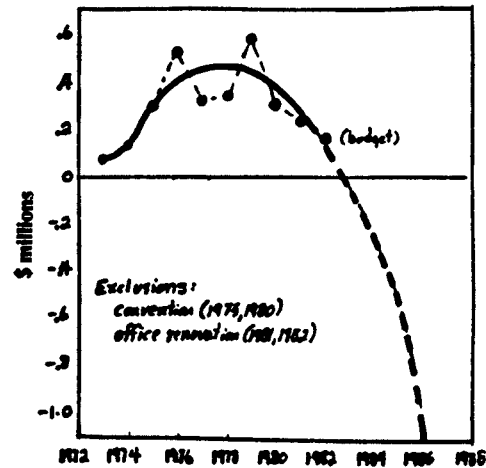
Group contributions and group service costs



Number of books and pamphlets published and groups listed



Net G.S.O. income (in millions of dollars)



Pros and cons on a suburban Conference

We are concerned over the rapidly rising expense of the General Service Conference. Our budget for this Conference, before area contributions, is \$168,300—25% over the cost of the Conference in 1980, when I last brought this to your attention. In addition, we can't be absolutely sure about the continuing

availability of the Roosevelt Hotel, which has changed ownership four times in recent years. Its present management assures us that they will stay in business, but it seems only prudent to consider alternative sites.

Conference costs are for the most part beyond our control; the largest are for airfare, hotel rooms, and meals. The present

rate at the Roosevelt, \$60 single and \$66 double, is considerably lower than quotations received from other hotels, in New York City and other locations. Meals, including service charge, are an additional \$42 a day (plus a \$5 breakfast allowance), also in line with quotations from most other hotels.

Conference centers in the New York area are at least as expensive as the Roosevelt. However, they do offer certain advantages. The last two World Service Meetings have been held at conference centers, and those who attended were unanimously enthusiastic about the meeting facilities (usually superior to those in commercial hotels) and the superb meals. The environment—away from the distractions and bustle of the city—is spiritually inspiring and conducive to good thought and good work.

For A.A. lawyers, it could be pointed out that the Conference Charter specifies that Conference meetings be held annually in New York "unless otherwise agreed upon." The 1945 Conference was held in St. Louis. A few have been held at other New York hotels (all now either unsatisfactory or defunct). All the others have been at the Roosevelt.

You should be aware of the sizable cost of the Conference, and we want you to know that we have investigated alternative sites in case the Roosevelt becomes unavailable. In that event, we hope you would give us the administrative authority to hold the Conference at an alternative site without coming back to the Conference for this decision.

Bob Pearson, general manager, G.S.O.

Advisory Actions relating to finance: 3, 10, 11 (p. 47)

A.A. in institutions

The profound spiritual impact of carrying the A.A. message behind the walls came through clearly in the presentations on Tuesday afternoon. The ensuing discussion was moderated by Al Hergott, Western Canada regional trustee and a member of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities.

Will they 'hang their A.A. on the gate'?

A.A. found me in the Colorado State Penitentiary, my third. Before that, I'd had no idea that alcoholism was my problem. Neither had anyone else. Now, I can see that I was in my first prison at age 19 as a direct result of alcoholism: I was 23 days A.W.O.L. on a spree while my unit was moved to a war zone.

The New Life Group in the Colorado state pen met each Friday night, and outsiders—"real people"—were allowed to attend. To go to this meeting, the new inmate or new member had to attend a five-week "Twelve Steps Study School." Each Saturday and Sunday afternoon, we gave up our movie and went to A.A., where sponsors read to us from the Big Book, guided us through the Steps, and shared their recovery experiences with us. My first Twelfth Step job was to sponsor the next group. There were about 90 men in it, and possibly ten meant business. Though only a few were serious, the only one I needed to be concerned about was me. Was I serious?

I hear A.A.'s say they don't want to go to prison meetings because they have never been to prison, so they feel they have

nothing to relate. Let me change that feeling. I knew how to live in prison. What I did not know was how to live successfully on the outside. My peers did not know, either, so the person I needed most to hear from and learn from was the free-world member who had not been locked away, who knew how to live in the free world. And remember—they would not let me out to see you.

I hear A.A.'s say they don't like going to prison meetings because they don't relate to the "criminal mind." I lived with a criminal mind for years. A.A. led me to a spiritual awakening. I was changed, by God's grace. I did not treat my drug problem. I did not treat my criminal problem. I did, through the Twelve Steps, deal with my alcoholism. The other problems ceased to exist. Our job is not to rehabilitate criminals. Our job is to carry A.A.'s message to alcoholics.

Effectiveness in institutions work calls for commitment and continuity. It was important to me to see the same faces show up regularly. It took me a while to trust anyone. I began to know and trust people like Reed and Sparky. Reliability is important to inmate groups. We have a unit that allows A.A. meetings, but if no outside members show up—no meeting.

Returning inmates talk about "hanging their A.A. on the gate." This can be avoided if there is an A.A. contact the first day out. I asked Reed the week before I was released how I would be accepted. He said, "Come and see." Reed told me if I would make an A.A. meeting my first night out, I would probably never have to go back. He told me if I would show up at the club, someone I knew would be there to meet me. Reed was at the top of the stairs when I got there.

Because someone cared enough to show regularly, to share honestly, and to be there my first night out, Reed's promise to me is a reality: I have not had to go back. The parole man gave me six days at the outside, based on my past record. It has been 12½ years free and 14 years sober now. My loyalty to my prison group is best shown by my never again being an active member of the New Life Group, but by remaining an outside member, one of the "real people," sober and free.

Don I. Pritts (Colorado)

'A tool to help us rebuild lives'

In 1942, A.A. was into its seventh year, with a membership of more than 8,000, when the progressive, now-legendary Warden Clinton Duffy of San Quentin asked for nearby members of A.A. to carry the message to alcoholics behind the walls. He said, "If the program will help just one man, I want to start it."

The first meeting had 20 inmates and several free-world guests in attendance. Warden Duffy recognized the importance of free-world visitors. Others—inmates and Duffy's peers alike—remained skeptical until the return rate for alcoholic parolees dropped from 80% to 20% and stayed there. What Duffy called "a tool to help us rebuild lives" began to give hope to alcoholics behind bars.

By 1944, the first A.A. group in a Federal penitentiary was formed, in Atlanta, Ga. By March 1958, there were active groups in 18. By 1960, there were 356 prison groups, with a total of 15,547 members. [See page 8 for 1982.]

A.A. in the Texas prison system had its beginning in 1948, when the first meeting was held at the "Walls." In 1951, for the first time, an alcoholic inmate from this system was taken to a state A.A. convention. Departmental records in the 1950's soon indicated that among inmates who had six months or more of A.A. while in prison, only 5% later returned to prison. Today, there are 20 groups in facilities of the Texas Department of Corrections, each with weekly meetings still supported by free-world visitors. About four times a year, selected inmates representing all the "A.A.'s in white" are allowed to attend free-world A.A. conventions.

In an article written for the Grapevine's "A.A. Today," a 1960 publication commemorating A.A.'s 25th anniversary, Warden Duffy (by then a member of the California Parole Board) said of A.A. in prisons: "The A.A. program is presented in a humble and human manner, without high-pressure frills. This is the approach necessary to reach the man who has developed a highly suspicious nature. It helps him to face truth and reality, without self-pity or dodging of responsibility. It rids him of fears, hates, jealousies, and suspicions that have been his for so long. He learns to eliminate his drinking . . . to get help and fellowship from his A.A. friends."

*W. J. Estelle Jr., chairperson,
trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities*

'She told me my story'

When first approached concerning getting clearance to go to A.A. meetings at Goree (the state prison for women at the time), I said no. In hindsight, I realize it was a no based on fear—not fear of the "ladies in white," but fear of being laughed out of the hall. "So she spent one night in jail and it made a believer out of her. So what?"

Well, of course, nothing like that happened; they welcomed me warmly on my first visit to Goree. During a cigarette break at the meeting, I had my first opportunity to visit one-on-one with a lady in white, and she told me *my story*—but with an important difference. We had both been in blackouts; we had both been driving with not a thought to where we were or where we were going; we had both rear-ended another car. And then the difference: The man she hit died, and the woman I hit lived.

She was serving 30 months. On that first trip to Goree, I learned exactly who was doing my time for me. Almost instantly, my fear changed to gratitude. Those of us attending A.A. meetings "inside" have the opportunity to learn of gratitude at a level that nothing else would teach us.

Too often, free-world A.A.'s visiting Goree for the first time would dress sloppily and color their language with profanities, trying to get the inmates to identify with them. We don't have to change who and what we are in carrying the message "inside." Most of those ladies know all the jive street talk—they don't come to A.A. meetings to hear it. One reason they come, I believe, is to see women who have come back from the brink of disaster and are now happy and productive citizens. They want to hear how we made the trip back and how they can make it. They want to talk about what we talk about at free-world meetings, not what's going on inside with the system, or what they did to be sent to prison. But there is an urgency within the inmate A.A. that we don't

always see outside—an urgency to make that 180-degree turn before discharge if they are to succeed outside.

Inmate A.A.'s have difficulty in the beginning understanding why anyone outside would spend Sundays going inside. Gradually, some learn more of the Twelfth Step and begin to understand that we may receive much more than we give on these trips inside. So some return to the unit once they have established themselves in the outside A.A. community. Certainly, no one carries a stronger A.A. message than they do.

In 1980, when rumors started circulating that the Goree ladies would be moved to a distant portion of the state, I was disturbed. My sponsor assured me that God might have something else planned for me. Indeed He did. In October 1980, I was elected delegate. Can you imagine my pleasure when I learned that I had been assigned to the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities? My heart is still at the meetings inside the walls.

*Martha Watson (Southeastern Texas), chairperson,
Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities*

G.S.O. opens a window onto the free world

About 25 or more letters arrive in my office on any given day. Here are sample excerpts: "In my last letter, I wrote that I have been a member of A.A. for 27 years. I did not mean to imply that I have had 27 years of continuous sobriety. If I had that, I wouldn't be in jail now. Please send more wallet cards! We need literature and Grapevines." . . . "I'm serving time in the state prison, and alcohol had a lot to do with my being here. I'm attending A.A. meetings. Since I stopped drinking, I've really had a lot of time to get to know myself again, and do you know what I see? A lonely man who needs very much to have some young lady to write to him. I'm not that bad-looking and I'm only 25. I would like to send a picture."

In answering a letter like the second, a useful quote is from "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship," page 7: "A.A. experience does suggest that it is best for men to sponsor men, women to sponsor women." We are not a pen pal service.

From a letter printed in our *Institutions Bulletin*: "I'm an inmate in the state pen. I'm on the side for new men. We don't get to go to A.A. I have never been to an A.A. meeting in my life. I've been doing drugs and alcohol for 20 years now and I would like to get away from alcohol. I'm looking for some A.A. people to write to. Please help me."

Appeals like that are answered by A.A. members in the Institutions Correspondence Service. One of them wrote to G.S.O., "Terry and I have a great friendship going—at least three letters every month or so. He seems to be keeping himself active in his A.A. group and sounds like a different person, compared to his first letter. We were talking about someday meeting each other. I believe there is a Convention in Canada in 1985, and Terry will be out of prison in '83 or '84. That's something to look forward to. Thank you for letting me share with those inside who need help."

We send inmate names to A.A.'s on our Institutions Correspondence Service list so the inmates will receive sharing from individuals, as well as from G.S.O. Every letter to G.S.O. is answered within a week. We receive wonderful sharing

through newsletters put out by A.A. groups in prisons, and some of it is used in our *Institutions Bulletin*.

Yet we are reaching only about 13% of the alcoholic prison population. Here are some suggested ways A.A.'s could serve: Correspond with an inmate by mail (write G.S.O.); speak at inside meetings or sponsor a prison group; collect A.A. literature and Grapevines for prison groups; make a personal donation to your local institutions group; offer your services on a local institutions committee; write articles for the Grapevine or your local newsletter on A.A. work in prisons; offer to meet an inmate upon his or her release.

Susan Daly, G.S.O. staff

Advisory Actions related to foregoing topic: 7, 8, 9 (p. 47)

New approaches to districting— how could they improve our service structure?

Late Wednesday afternoon, Panel 31 delegates from widely differing areas shared experiences on an essential element of the service structure. Dick Driscoll, Northeast U.S. regional trustee, moderated this notably stimulating presentation/discussion.

Trial and error—benefit through error

Sharing Virginia's experience with redistricting is like taking a Fifth Step—painful and humbling. It all began in June 1980 when the area chairperson announced at a summer planning meeting of D.C.M.'s and officers that he had appointed a committee to study redistricting in our area. As a consequence of splitting districts, the area committee had grown too large and unwieldy—26 districts and about 500 groups.

The redistricting committee did not function as a "study committee." Instead, its chairperson developed the following proposal and presented it to the fall assembly: (1) Divide the area into 12 districts (instead of 26), to be called "area districts," each with one D.C.M. elected by the district's G.S.R.'s; (2) subdivide each area district into an unlimited number of "local districts" (as suggested on page 39 of "The A.A. Service Manual"), with one local committee member, elected by the local district's G.S.R.'s, this L.C.M. to be a voting member of the district committee and the assembly; (3) permit G.S.R.'s to attend and vote at local committee meetings, any special district committee meetings, and area assemblies.

Benefits cited were: (1) efficient communication (L.C.M.'s could cover their small numbers of groups more easily); (2) a better flow of information from Conference to groups; (3) a smaller, smoother-functioning area committee.

This proposal was discussed briefly at the fall assembly and more fully at the winter meeting of D.C.M.'s and officers, who asked that it be presented in greater detail to G.S.R.'s at the spring assembly and given exposure in the newsletter while D.C.M.'s discussed it with G.S.R.'s at district meetings. This was done.

At the spring assembly, after much discussion, it was voted (1) to place a temporary moratorium on any new districts, and (2) to take the plan back to the groups for further study so that

alternative plans or revisions could be suggested and brought by the D.C.M.'s to the summer meeting.

No alternative plans or revisions were presented at that meeting. The redistricting committee chairperson gave the D.C.M.'s maps showing the boundaries of the 12 proposed area districts and asked them to discuss these with their groups and with other districts or portions of districts with which they would merge under the new plan, so any changes could be made and a vote on the redistricting proposal taken at the fall assembly.

The maps were a turning point. Opinion had been evenly divided, but it now began to swing against the plan. Many G.S.R.'s disliked the boundaries but found it difficult to draw up new ones. A number felt they were being rushed into approving a complicated plan they had not initiated and could not fully visualize in action.

When the redistricting plan was brought to a vote at the fall assembly, it was defeated, with only a small minority dissenting.

Other reasons given for the "no" vote were: (1) imposition of authority from the top—a violation of Tradition Two; (2) distaste for remarrying districts previously split for allegedly valid reasons; (3) doubt about adding another "layer of authority" (L.C.M.'s) in districts just beginning to feel a closeness and understanding of the present service structure; and (4) a strong belief that the area committee was not "unwieldy" but represented the necessary broad outlook.

It was not a bad plan, and it was carefully thought out by the redistricting committee chairperson. Nevertheless, hindsight indicates we should have moved *slowly*, with a well-balanced committee representative of the whole area, enlisting the groups' help in studying the matter and drawing up a plan with which they could feel comfortable. *We simply were not ready. And it did not begin with the A.A. group.* Redistricting is not a popular word now in Virginia, but our area is growing rapidly (70 new groups in 1981), so we'll soon have to take another look at ways to handle the problems and challenge.

Our experience has had one beneficial effect: Instead of destroying our unity, as at one point we thought it might, it has brought us closer together. The group conscience spoke loud and clear at our fall assembly—we heard it and were deeply moved by it. That may be far more important than reshaping districts.

Dottie Rapp (Virginia)

A new type of 'service communicator'

In 1969, our area instituted a new districting concept, a "modified book structure," which has effectively cleared up the confusion created by A.A. population growth and vague district boundaries.

Each county was declared a district (county-district), and subdistricts were formed within it. The county-district is headed by a D.C.M. chairperson (D.C.M.C.), and the sub-district (with eight to 12 groups) is led by a D.C.M.

With this restructuring, monthly area meetings at a central location can handle current business, freeing the quarterly

assemblies for other matters. Before restructuring, over 60 D.C.M.'s were scattered from Monterey County to the Oregon border, and some were unable to attend the monthly area meeting held in Oakland. D.C.M.C.'s provided the centralized, simplified system of direct communication that was needed.

Surveys, questions to districts, and other service matters are easily handled by contacting *one* person within a county rather than 12 or more. The D.C.M.C. then relays the information to the subdistrict D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s. The D.C.M.C. post has reduced the number of contacts within the area from over 60 to 17, making communication more effective. Another benefit: Each county-district can hold regular meetings for its D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s. By rotating assignments, this allows an area officer to attend every such meeting and share current Conference and G.S.O. information, which then goes directly to the A.A. groups. The D.C.M.C. is on the spot to assist in local problems, to report on them at the monthly area business meeting, and to carry suggestions back to the district.

The D.C.M.C. is primarily another service communicator. In fact, this function provides additional opportunities to serve. The D.C.M.C. programs and conducts the monthly district meetings, freeing the D.C.M. to visit the groups in the subdistrict and to generate G.S.R.'s in groups that have none. The creation of the D.C.M.C. office in no way detracts from the importance of the D.C.M. The active D.C.M. is the backbone of the local general service structure, as the G.S.R. is its lifeblood. As a member of the area committee and the leader of the subdistrict committee, the D.C.M. can pass the group conscience of that subdistrict on to the area committee and the delegate.

Because the D.C.M.C. attends each monthly area meeting and makes a report, there is direct word from each county-district each month. This requires comprehensive area-meeting minutes, which are taken by another new area officer—the recording secretary. Because the majority of the area's business is conducted at the monthly meetings, the quarterly assemblies are freed to conduct workshops, sharing sessions, and other educational events. So still another area officer was added—the assembly coordinator, who inspects sites and handles assembly programs. Because these assemblies are entertaining as well as informative, more A.A.'s have been attracted to attend. Another area officer was needed for communication purposes—the area literature and Grapevine chairperson. These additional area duties are sometimes duplicated at the county-district level, thus providing even more opportunities for service.

The delegates' express

Lyla Bonney (G.S.O. staff) led a group of about ten unsuspecting delegates to G.S.O. via the New York subway. After a cautious trek through the tunnel from the hotel to Grand Central Station, the delegates finally boarded the downtown train, under Lyla's watchful eye. After about ten minutes on the train, one delegate turned to another and said, "It was supposed to be a short walk, but it seems to be a heck of a long ride." Apparently, Lyla had carefully guided the delegates onto the downtown express train, barreling right past the G.S.O. stop. After an about-face trip, all emerged unscathed.

Because of this "modified book structure" and because of the monthly district (and often subdistrict) meetings, G.S.R.'s are better informed, D.C.M.'s are easier to come by, and lines of communication are shortened and simplified. It also provides a ready-made structure for expansion as A.A. population grows. County-districts can be split into two or more intra-county districts, and subdistricts can be further subdivided, calling for more D.C.M.'s. Over the years, our area has found that this modified structure is workable and produces outstanding results.

Sam Eddy (Northern Coastal California)

Sizable A.A. populations can magnify problems

Most of our problems are the same as those found all over; only with us, they are multiplied. We have more members, more groups, and more districts; therefore, we have more problems. We have more groups that need G.S.R.'s, and we have more districts that need D.C.M.'s; but we still have one delegate, one chairperson, one secretary, and one treasurer.

About eight years ago, all four New York areas had about as many groups as Southeastern New York has today. Then (and to some extent, now) New York Intergroup was A.A. as far as most of the groups were concerned. Few members knew anything at all about the Southeastern New York General Service Conference Area Assembly or Committee. So that committee decided to organize all districts within each county into county assemblies. In the first meetings, the percentage of groups represented by G.S.R.'s was small, and there were few D.C.M.'s. But the seeds were sown. In the near absence of district meetings, county meetings were a place where groups could air group problems, thus relieving the overcrowded agenda of the area assembly. County chairpersons became committee members whether they were G.S.R.'s or D.C.M.'s.

A strong service structure depends on good D.C.M.'s. We have several, but not nearly enough. The more enthusiastic hold district meetings. Many G.S.R.'s seem to feel that one meeting a month will meet their obligation—if they go to the district meeting, they don't need to go to the county or area assemblies; or if they attend the county assembly, they don't have to go to the area assembly.

So we ask ourselves: Have we created a monster? Have we fragmented our area structure? To some degree, it seems that we have. A few of the counties work on their own, appearing at area assemblies only when they have a Share-a-Day to promote or when there is an election. At least, they do have Share-a-Days, and one county has its own service meetings.

Another thing about an area this size: Just as we think one county is going strong and we direct our efforts to another, the strong county might start to fade. No matter what our concentration, it seems we are needed somewhere else. We have some counties that don't seem to be anywhere in the service structure. But we hope this situation will improve. One change we made, to try to entice G.S.R.'s from the farther-out counties, was the switch from evening to Sunday-afternoon assemblies. The result: same head count, different people.

Another indication of fragmentation in this area is the large

number of special-interest groups. When there are so many, they support one another just by the very nature of their existence, and in so doing create feelings of "us" and "them." So we must constantly take service meetings to these groups and hope to leave them with a "we" feeling.

Trying to create a good service structure and unity in an area with close to 1,000 groups calls for a lot of work. At the same time, we have to meet and deal with, as best we can, the problems that we all have with Tradition breaks, directories, etc.

It may well be that the time has come to consider redistricting.

Alex Macaulay (Southeastern New York)

Commenting on the Wednesday-afternoon presentations on districting, Bob Pearson noted their fine quality and remarked how courageous it was of the delegate from Virginia, Dottie Rapp, to get up there and tell us "how not to do it." Bob thought that, in fact, if he remembered correctly, it was the only presentation of its kind in the history of the General Service Conference.

'Clusters' serve as the districts' 'A.A. groups'

Active members of our area committee became increasingly aware that A.A. here was growing at a rate far beyond the capacity of our communication system. Districts and groups that actively participated in the service structure were benefiting, but most of the groups, new and old, were not being reached. Yet we have strong membership involvement in general service. About 250 groups have G.S.R.'s; more than 60% of our districts have active D.C.M.'s.

Since our area has over 1,000 groups, we divided into 26 districts about eight years ago. With so few G.S.R.'s, simply splitting into districts has not solved the communication problem. Any one district, representing 50 to 60 groups, may include an A.A. population not much smaller than the entire area had about 20 years ago.

One of our first observations was that active groups and districts tended to depend upon the area committee. Our committee has been meeting monthly and conducting all area business. It has four standing subcommittees—on institutions, public information, cooperation with the professional community, and treatment facilities—and other special committees. A few years ago, we began trying to reduce dependence on the area committee by encouraging districts to take on the subcommittees' work. Obviously, any district that could encompass 50 to 60 groups should be able to provide these services on its own, using the area committee only for guidance and sharing of experience. That approach has had only limited success. Strong districts have little problem taking on more responsibility, but inactive districts and groups remain unchanged.

We still had not attacked our real problem: How do we attract the inactive groups and districts? As of January 1982, we are trying a bold, new approach that has received the enthusiastic support of our entire area committee. We have divided our area into four clusters or zones. Cluster A has seven districts; B has nine; C and D have five each. Assignments were based on both geographic location and similarity of communities.

We have discontinued four of our monthly area committee meetings and replaced them with cluster meetings to be held in locations jointly decided by the D.C.M.'s representing each cluster. Each contains both active and inactive districts, and we hope the cluster meetings will attract greater local participation. Since they are geographically more convenient than area meetings, travel time and expense are reduced.

Cluster meetings will be chaired by D.C.M.'s, who will rotate for each meeting. A permanent (two-year) secretary-treasurer will be elected, and the area committee will fund all reasonable expenses. Area officers are being assigned to rotate among cluster meetings, so each officer will eventually have attended all four and participated where appropriate. The area committee will meet in the eight months when there are no cluster meetings, and three of these meetings will be assemblies.

It is too early to report the effect of this new approach; however, we have sensed enthusiasm from the first meeting. We are encouraging districts to keep an open mind and give the plan time to work. Also, we are encouraging D.C.M.'s to plan their own agendas, with guidance from area committee officers. The only recurring suggestion is to become better informed on Traditions and Guidelines. Spreading knowledge of our Traditions within the Fellowship will ensure our unity.

Bill Downey (Eastern Massachusetts)

Advisory Action related to districts: 4 (p. 47)

Anonymity breaks—how are we handling them?

A hot topic throughout A.A.'s history, anonymity breaks drew thoughtful attention on Wednesday evening, in the presentation/discussion moderated by Fern Ippersiel, Eastern Canada regional trustee.

G.S.O. sends friendly reminders

The General Service Office becomes aware of an anonymity break in either of two ways: A member may send us a newspaper clipping in which someone's A.A. membership was revealed; the clipping service we subscribe to forwards newspaper and magazine articles carrying mentions of A.A., and some include anonymity breaks. On the average, we became aware of eight per month in 1981.

Following Conference recommendations on handling these breaks, G.S.O. first notifies the area delegate where the member in question resides, enclosing the clipping and asking the delegate whether he or she cares to follow up in a friendly way. If the delegate prefers, G.S.O. will write and remind the person whose anonymity was broken about the importance of our anonymity Tradition. Because A.A. is never punitive, nor does G.S.O. have authority to tell any member what to do, the tone of our reminders is friendly.

G.S.O. does not try to determine whether the break was accidental or deliberate. The celebrity who makes a public announcement is also a newly recovered alcoholic in our Fellowship and may later choose to live within the spirit of Traditions Eleven and Twelve. Unfortunately, the fact of that celebrity's

A.A. membership can end up on file at newspapers, wire services, etc., and sometimes continues to be published or broadcast, even though this person no longer mentions it.

Other types of anonymity breaks occur in these instances:

- (1) A.A.'s write letters to the editor, and their names and A.A. membership are included, by intention or error;
- (2) membership is revealed from another source—such as a relative or employer who brags about the A.A. publicly;
- (3) recovered alcoholics who originally got sober in A.A. but no longer consider themselves members may publicly give A.A. credit;
- (4) some members—very few—do not accept the anonymity Tradition and continue to reveal their A.A. membership at the public level.

After the reminder—by either the delegate or G.S.O.—we rarely find the situation recurring. Evidently, most anonymity breaks occur simply because the member is not aware of Tradition Eleven. The Fellowship seems to agree that our Traditions were written for the guidance of A.A. groups and members and not for non-A.A.'s, so G.S.O. does not follow up on each individual anonymity break with a letter to the newspaper or magazine. We do send anonymity reminders annually to the media and biennially to treatment facilities—both in the nature of requests for goodwill and cooperation. The press memo goes to publications with circulations over 50,000; copies go to delegates, alternate delegates, and P.I. committees, to be shared with smaller local newspapers.

Some members are under the impression that anonymity is being broken at the public level more and more. Actually, over the past 15 years, about one member in 5,000 has had his or her anonymity broken. Despite our apprehension, our wonderful Eleventh Tradition seems as respected today as in the past.

*Jacquelyn Solomon, chairperson,
trustees' Public Information Committee*

An area emphasizes personal contacts

The frequency of anonymity breaks in our area is not, I believe, more than the national average—quite a low percentage of our membership. This certainly does not relieve us of responsibility; only A.A. members can in any way influence adherence to Tradition Eleven.

Some members in our area do intentionally break their anonymity time after time, though they are contacted by D.C.M.'s, area-committee officers, and G.S.O. There is nothing we can do about a member who wishes to be notorious or uses A.A. to further a political or personal career. But we follow up on these repeated breaks, no matter how often we have to contact the same member.

Some incidents were immediately referred to G.S.O. But we have usually tried to handle such matters at the area, district, or local level, for the following reasons: (a) The person breaking anonymity is likely to be well known in the home district; (b) the medium involved can best be approached by local members, personally; (c) misunderstandings and/or lack of information can often be cleared up effectively at the local level, again by personal contact.

A recent break was brought to my attention by a district committee. I discussed it with the district chairperson and suggest-

ed that she try to explain our Tradition to the person and the newspaper involved. I added that the area committee would follow up later if necessary. In just a few days, the contacts had been made; discussions had taken place; and the member reluctantly agreed that he had "probably acted without consideration of the Eleventh Tradition," and that it would not happen again.

Might it be well for each district to prepare a list of local print and broadcast media, to be added to the list used by G.S.O. for the annual anonymity letter? The smaller newspaper is more likely to carry stories, pictures, and information that constitute anonymity breaks. If copies of the anonymity letter could be furnished to district chairpersons, they would have the "entry" needed to show the persons involved that the Tradition stems from A.A. as a whole, not just local groups.

The full cooperation of district, area, and G.S.O. may well carry more weight in convincing the member involved that our Traditions are important to us all. A subcommittee of the area committee might well get the effort off to a good start. If many areas try this, the result could be shared with other areas through newsletters, minutes of meetings, etc.

As usual, it is a matter of communication—getting more members involved, having well-informed members participate in guarding the Traditions. Let us be ever-vigilant at all levels and encourage local groups and district and area committees to take an active part.

Lenore Tate (Southern Florida)

A delegate works to create better understanding

When an individual allows his or her full name to be used by the media, there is an underlying problem within that person. When I receive word of an anonymity break, I try to talk with the person responsible, to seek a motive for a break. Many times, I find such people's sobriety is at stake. I can encourage them to have a look at themselves by talking about myself; the Traditions are as important to my sobriety as are the Steps. I always make sure to leave with them our pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" and answer any questions they may ask. I also try to help them understand that their abuse of the Tradition is not going to be held against them. We all have the privilege of being wrong; the important lesson is that we should not let it continue.

I also try to contact the business—more particularly, the individual within it—responsible for the publicity. Often, the media people have not had the privilege of understanding our program. I leave them with information on the importance of our Traditions to the well-being and growth of A.A. Many of the businesses receive the anonymity letter from G.S.O., but it does not get circulated to the people in the departments. I try to encourage them to help the still-suffering alcoholic by protecting our anonymity. I explain that we in A.A. appreciate their help, and that their vehicle for carrying the message is very valuable to A.A. worldwide.

When I receive word of an anonymity break, I also get in touch with the public information committee in the district, whether it is a subcommittee of the central committee or of the general service committee. One of its members often makes the contact along with me—or for me, if I cannot be there.

I believe we have had some success in our area with this procedure. Often, we are able to get alcoholics back to A.A. meetings, and to discourage further problems with the particular branch of the media concerned. Nevertheless, I realize that even with all our literature on anonymity, many members seem to have difficulty understanding the Tradition. We have to spend more time talking to them about it, through P.I. committees, sponsorship, workshops, area meetings, assembly meetings, and group business meetings, and particularly when we speak, whether at A.A. meetings or at public meetings for the nonalcoholic.

Gordon Dracup (Eastern Ontario)

Subtle idea: Give the breaker a mission

Tradition Twelve tells us that "anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions." Therefore, it is the foundation of our entire Fellowship. When an anonymity break occurs, it is usually because the individual either chooses to ignore that fact or has not been made aware of it.

First, some members ignore the purpose of this Tradition because they think that revealing their A.A. membership will help other, "equally important" people to come to A.A. If we have an active public information program and such people have been exposed to it and still continue to reveal their membership at the media level, what avenues do we have other than the usual form letter? Personal letters from the local level, in our own words, could bring these people thoughts regarding anonymity in an unabrasive manner. We might then ask them to help us develop more effective communication with new members unaware of the importance of anonymity—now that they themselves fully understand. Involve them in arriving at solutions now or in the future. Then follow up that letter by a phone call requesting a meeting to explore some ideas!

Remember the vast numbers of people coming to us from outside facilities, seeing and hearing their professional counselors on radio and TV and in newspapers talking about alcoholism and its impact. Many new members arrive with ideas *they* feel will help others, and pay little or no attention to the full meaning of our Traditions. This brings us to the second reason for anonymity breaks. We have been told that the U.S. and Canada listed almost 3,500 new groups in 1981. Many of those groups may not read or discuss the Traditions. Through our workshops on anonymity and public information, we reach only a small segment of this annual increase in membership. Two additional avenues could be considered as a trial.

During discussion meetings, the topic of anonymity could be correlated with our recovery program to expose ideas from our Traditions, which so many recovering alcoholics try to avoid. Our groups started a workshop on anonymity after a regular meeting. The first time, nine members remained (not to learn more about the Traditions, I'm sure). After one month, weekly workshop meetings have an attendance of 20 to 30. This idea grew out of district meetings that discussed ideas for this Conference.

Another suggestion came from our group-conscience questionnaires: Close meetings by reading a brief excerpt from Bill W.'s article "Why Alcoholics Anonymous Is Anonymous." Repetition of this reading will do the same thing that repetition does for us in our program of recovery.

Finally, how can we improve communication with newspapers, radio, and TV? When we invite reporters and feature writers to a P.I. or C.P.C. program where prominent members of the community may be present as A.A. members, we ask the press not to use full names or identifying references. Approached in this manner, the writers respect our anonymity principle.

Any other methods of reaching the media used in your area should be shared, possibly through *Box 4-5-9*, for all of us to use.

Gregory MacNeil (Nevada)

Advisory Actions related to anonymity: 2 (p. 47), 20 (p. 48)

How we carry the message to alcoholics coming to us from treatment facilities

Both difficulties and vast opportunities were explored in this presentation/discussion, on Thursday afternoon. Moderator Ken Williams—as an M.D. and as a Class A trustee—has seen the situation from two viewpoints.

Today's patients—tomorrow's trusted servants

Our largest source of new members is the people coming from treatment centers. They are going to be our G.S.R.'s, delegates, and trustees. Our whole Fellowship depends on how our new members are introduced to A.A. They need to know what A.A. is and isn't.

They differ from the new member off the street, because they have been detoxed to some degree. But most are confused about what a group is and is not, our single purpose, our unity based on the love of one drunk for another, our need for a change of heart and a change of action.

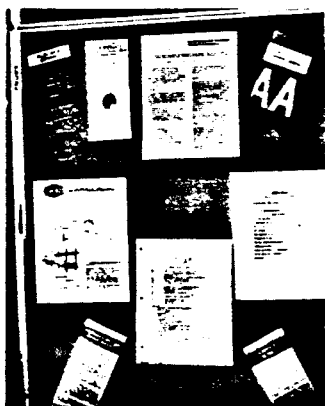
Where they are mass-produced (one district has seven or eight facilities; another, 11 or 12), committees are needed to provide uniform help, such as: (1) Take 'em to a meeting; (2) take a meeting to them; (3) sponsorship in A.A.

Some facilities have buses and take busload after busload to meetings. Committees can explain to the facility about open and closed meetings and let the groups know in advance, so they will be prepared to handle extra people.

In taking a meeting to them, committees can help by getting the right speakers for each meeting. Some share better at open meetings; some, at closed. We all came from different walks of life and got here under different circumstances. For example, if they sent me to a big, fancy treatment center full of people who had money and had paid thousands for treatment, and all I talked about was winos, weed patches, and barking at the moon, they might not understand. On the other hand, if I was at a Salvation Army or halfway house, that talk might be more effective.

Sponsorship in A.A. is of the utmost importance; but there again, all people can't be all things to all people. Most of us can be a friend and be available. Some A.A.'s can work with people who drink less than they themselves used to. Some can

One of this year's display boards at the Conference presented material useful to treatment facilities committees, ranging from flyers to lists of pamphlets that are included in special discount packages.



work with people who are on medication. And some A.A.'s can't tell the difference. Some can work with the mentally ill alcoholic that we hear about now—when all this time I thought we were *all* here 'cause we weren't all there!

As an old bleeding deacon, I sometimes find it hard to work with people who have been forced to read about A.A. and all kinds of other treatments. Some have learned more in two or three months than I have in 22 years, and they are real quick to tell you so.

I'm still a little old-fashioned. The Big Book says we have to have a personality change and give up those old ideas. Introducing the opinions of "Dr. Silky," as Bill W. called him (one of the best friends this Society has ever had), Bill said, "It is imperative that a man's brain be cleared before he's approached, as he has then a better chance of understanding and accepting what we have to offer."

Joe French (Northeastern Texas)

'You aren't even shaking'

Some oldtimers say, "It was really rough in the old days. We had no treatment centers to go to, and we shook it out at home and really did earn our right to be in A.A." So it was a revelation to read in "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers" that in the early, early days, most new members came from a stay in a hospital ward of some kind.

The Big Book states, "Call on him while he is still jittery. He may be more receptive when depressed." Today, when people come to A.A. from a treatment facility, they usually have been taken out to A.A. meetings during their stay or have attended meetings in the facility that are sponsored by a local A.A. committee. So they normally are not shaking too badly when they come to us. And it is alarming to hear an oldtimer say, "You may not be a *real* alcoholic, because you aren't even shaking." Today, with earlier confrontation, intervention, or whatever it takes, we see more people going into treatment earlier. This is good. The earlier people get to treatment, the earlier they most likely will come to A.A.

Suppose such a newcomer begins making many meetings, starts to feel comfortable, and tries to tell what he learned in the treatment facility. That does it! The oldtimers speak up: "We are here to talk about grass-roots A.A., not treatment facilities."

The newcomer is thoroughly confused. His counselor told him to go to A.A. and ask questions, because A.A.'s say, "No question is stupid." And now those oldtimers are saying, "Shut up and just listen. Forget everything they told you in the treatment facility. We'll tell you all you need to know." The newcomer feels rebuffed and may pull back into a shell of insecurity or worse yet, may be driven from A.A.

Having been in the Fellowship a few years, I can understand both sides of this dilemma. The oldtimer does not want to dilute his A.A. program with the "new bunk" that our new friends learned in the facilities. In his mind, he is only trying to protect his program that has been his way of life for so many years. This is the way he found A.A., and he feels this is the only way that A.A. will survive. The newcomer, direct from treatment, is so fired up with his newfound freedom from alcohol that he wants to impart to the world his knowledge of A.A. as it was presented to him. He has been instructed on the many aspects of our disease by the professional, and he may be over anxious to spread the word.

In this situation, I think, we can go by the Big Book: "We must be open-minded." It is wise to use a little restraint in talking with both the newcomer and the oldtimer. I will always remember my fear when I was new and the oldtimers spoke up. But now I thank them for helping me to form a lasting, durable, self-help program based on love, the Higher Power, and the fellowship of everyone in Alcoholics Anonymous, past and present. To them and to you, I owe my life. We are all trudging together on the Big Book's "Road of Happy Destiny."

Dick Pittard (Washington)

We don't care *how* they got here

Newcomers—how we love them! We love to have them come to our groups. For years, two or three a month trickled in. Then came the treatment centers in the area, and the numbers increased. A treatment facility was established in our city, and they came in droves. A.A. groups added new meetings, and new groups were formed.

At first, local A.A.'s visited the center, offered to sponsor the new people as they were dismissed, and took them to groups about town. But as soon as there were a few alumni from the center, they were asked to sponsor new people coming out of treatment. They started their own groups, because they felt more comfortable with their own kind and their own language ("chemically dependent" instead of "alcoholic," for instance). Many groups of that type are still going. But other treatment-center graduates found their way into established groups and stayed. It was explained to those newcomers that we come to A.A. meetings to talk about the A.A. program. Many of them had been inclined to think of A.A. as group therapy or "feelings" meetings.

When newcomers come to my group, we welcome them with a smile and a handshake, exchange names and phone numbers, invite them to call us and to come back to our next meeting. If they are from a treatment facility, we tell them it doesn't make any difference how they got here; we are happy they are here in A.A.

To sponsor a person from a treatment center, one must have

good (not necessarily long) sobriety. One must be dependable, available to the newcomer, ready to listen. What other people think of A.A. depends on us. If we are reliable, then A.A. seems to be. We should make the A.A. way of life look attractive. A sponsor needs to know the A.A. literature and the Grapevine. Tell newcomers about the history of A.A. Let them read "A.A. Comes of Age" and "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers." I swear, some people come out of treatment believing treatment centers came first and invented A.A. for their clients.

Communication is the key to all relationships. We need to talk with the newcomers, with the counselors in the treatment centers, and within our own groups, just to understand each other. We learn to love by knowing another person, and we learn to carry the message of love of one drunk for another. *Give them lots of love.*

Doris Beacom (Iowa)

The intellect versus the spirit

The problems we have in our area are an abundance of confusion and a lack of beginners meetings.

Many people coming to us today have spent their first few days of sobriety in the setting of group therapy, which is a wonderful thing in an institution but certainly has its drawbacks in A.A. Group therapy requires that individuals be responsible to the group for their actions. The group informs people when they are out of line and demands a solution to the problem. In A.A., individuals are responsible to themselves and their God. They are solely responsible for determining whether their actions will allow them to remain sober or will return them to drinking.

Some groups today engage in "confrontation." Defiance is an outstanding character defect of an alcoholic. The wall of defiance is only solidified by confrontation. It must crumble from within. Again, the responsibility falls back on the individual.

An A.A. group does not engage in any kind of coercion or enforcement. We do not provide lectures after which we demand a report. While we may attempt to "educate" newcomers, we go about it in a different manner. We share our own experience with newcomers, and they begin to see that we know how they felt doing the things they have done. Our approach is not one of understanding them, but rather one of understanding ourselves. We present ourselves to newcomers in a manner that allows for identification. Having identified with us, they are now able to see the miracle of sobriety before them. The choice is now clearly theirs—not ours.

The attempt to make the nonalcoholic drug addict into an A.A. member is a definite problem in my area. If newcomers are drug addicts, the spiritual or emotional exchange between members and newcomers is lessened. Communication must move to an intellectual plane—a sharing of the definitions of words, rather than a sharing of experiences. This again takes us back to the group-therapy process, which involves examination by the group—an intellectual endeavor.

The A.A. program must be presented to the still-suffering alcoholic, not forced upon him. To do the latter would be to encourage his defiance and possibly deprive him of that gift

so freely given to us—sobriety. As a solution to the confusion, I would suggest first, the rediscovery of beginners meetings by A.A. groups, and second, getting back to another old-time basic called sponsorship.

Stan Mann (Southern Minnesota)

Advisory Action related to foregoing topic: 29 (p. 49)

How appropriate!

During the Thursday-morning session, moderator Bob Pearson suffered fatigue from standing continuously. He was rescued by an accommodating hotel staff. For the remainder of the Conference, the trusted vice-chairperson was perched on a barstool.

How we carry the message to alcoholics coming to us from treatment facilities

The topic of the day before was fresh in Conference members' minds when they divided into 11 groups for the second workshop, Friday afternoon. In more intimate settings, all had a chance to share experiences and thoughts that might not have been brought up on the Conference floor.

The doors of A.A. groups widen in welcome

1 "What problems are there in your area with meetings in treatment facilities? For example:

a "How do groups in your area that meet in treatment facilities maintain the spirit of our self-support Tradition when space and coffee are provided gratis?"

Most groups find ways to maintain the Tradition by contributing literature or Grapevine subscriptions or making a cash donation.

b "When problems exist between facility management and A.A. members bringing meetings into facilities, what steps do you take to resolve them?"

All felt that communication must be kept open between these A.A.'s and centers' management. Some use C.P.C. committees for this purpose. All felt it important that A.A. members going into the facility be aware of and obey the facility's rules.

c "Are there problems posed by A.A. members working as counselors conducting or participating in A.A. meetings held in their place of employment?"

Some areas do have this problem. All felt, however, that it was better for all concerned if counselors were encouraged to attend meetings away from the facility, in accordance with the shared experience in A.A. Guidelines For Members Employed in the Field of Alcoholism.

2 "How is sponsorship arranged for members referred from treatment facilities?"

In some areas, sponsorship is arranged at the treatment facility through lists kept of responsible A.A. members willing to

serve in this way. Sometimes, this is done by intergroup offices. In some groups, an interim sponsorship program takes care of this job.

3 "How is heavy referral to A.A. groups handled in your area?"

Most participants felt that when excessively heavy referral of treatment facility patients to one group occurs, the problem can be solved through communication and cooperation.

4 "At the beginners meeting, do A.A. groups in your area experience any of the following problems?"

a "Longtime members' dominating the meeting so new people are afraid to speak or ask questions"

Most felt that when this problem occurs, it can be handled by an effective chairperson. Others reported a reverse problem: Beginners meetings were led by young A.A.'s with very little experience to share.

b "Speakers' talking about alcoholism and its physical and psychological components—with little emphasis on the A.A. program of recovery"

Some delegates have experienced this problem, but felt that when it occurs, it can be handled by the chairperson, who can encourage future speakers to stick to *their* active alcoholism and the A.A. program of recovery.

c "New members' being put down if they talk about what they've learned regarding their alcoholism in a treatment facility"

There appeared to be a very limited incidence of this problem in the groups known to the workshop participants. However, it was felt that when the problem arises, tolerance is the key word, and that A.A.'s should meet the newcomer *wherever* he or she comes from. Some participants said they will, after a time, suggest that such a new person retake the Fourth, Fifth, or whatever Step with an A.A. sponsor.

Advisory Action related to foregoing topic: 29 (p. 49)

The Traditions in personal recovery

The Conference theme was appropriately brought to the personal level in the final 1982 presentation/discussion. Like all delegates, the four who spoke are first and foremost A.A. members. So, indeed, is general service trustee Don Daly, the moderator.

"Winning and losing don't count"

When I came to A.A., I had no idea how crucial the Traditions would be to sustained recovery from alcoholism and from obsession with myself. My program consisted of getting through one day without drinking, and our Steps provided the tools.

But then came the maintenance of sobriety. A little recovery is a dangerous thing for an alcoholic ready to embark on the stormy waters of A.A. service. The Traditions made it possi-

ble for me to survive that rough voyage. In service, the Traditions save us from ourselves. Complicated people with a simple program can get jammed up over the most trivial matter. Every service problem has an answer in the Traditions; but before I can find it, I have to get myself out of the way.

When I became aware that my group had imperfections, I threw myself into correcting those imperfections with the same fervor that I had employed in my early recovery. Ah, the heady joy of A.A. service controversies!—the treasurer's disappearance with the treasury; intergroup bills (to pay or not to pay); petitions of recall for the state conference steering committee. I learned—without knowing I was learning it—that winning and losing don't count in A.A. Only the survival of the A.A. program counts. And because I learned that, I, too, survived—sober.

A.A. women lovingly assumed responsibility for pointing me away from the disillusionment and bitterness that often accompany controversy. They did it by pointing me toward Tradition phrases and words that changed my spirit and attitude: "principles before personalities," "unity," "a desire to stop drinking," "attraction rather than promotion," "trusted servants," "anonymity," "spiritual foundation."

Over the years, each Tradition has been the healing balm for serious controversies that involved our Fellowship as a whole. For me, the Traditions soothed the hurts I suffered because I had to learn to survive my own blatant errors and righteous anger in A.A. service. I cannot learn unless I experience; I cannot experience unless I am emotionally involved; and when I am emotionally involved, I had better be armed with a desire to put the Traditions into action.

Bill W. said that the Traditions were designed to be simply stated "principles which could offer tested solutions to all of our problems of living and working together and of relating our Society to the world outside." Those of us participating in A.A.'s Third Legacy know that personal change and progress—and yes, real recovery—come about through these Traditions in action. It's the only way we can disagree and survive. It's the only way we can deal with money and prestige, anonymity and membership, public controversy, unity, and one another.

How do I know that the Traditions help me become the whole person I strive to be? I know by my belief that our common welfare comes first and that I'll step aside in favor of it—willingly. I know by my recognition that our Traditions and service work exist solely to help me carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Sometimes, that alcoholic is me, bruised and battered from defending an indefensible position when all I really need to do is help strengthen A.A. as a whole, so that our program continues to reach out with its miraculous power to heal through a loving God and a loving group.

June Boranian (Hawaii)

One delegate reported on a discouraging item that appeared in a local A.A. newsletter. The writer evidently meant to say, "The delegate was sent to the General Service Conference uninstructed." Instead, the item read: "The delegate was sent to the General Service Conference uninformed."

'Living with reality'

Early A.A.'s were confronted with scores of perplexities, which made harmony and effectiveness extremely difficult. Trial-and-error efforts to find solutions to their problems are recorded as "this vast welter of explosive experience" from which "A.A.'s Twelve Traditions took form." Through sharing experience, those members discovered that individuals seldom recovered unless there was a group.

"Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," in discussing Tradition Three, says, " 'We don't want to keep you out. We aren't a bit afraid you'll harm us, never mind how twisted or violent you may be.' " My inventory demonstrated that I felt intolerance, anxiety, and fear toward the idea of A.A. membership, rather than being concerned with requirements. It was "those people" who might be twisted or violent. It would be my personal image that would be subjected to damage.

Reluctantly, I attended an open meeting. I obtained a copy of the "Twelve and Twelve." The desire to stop drinking came when I read this sentence: "Under the lash of alcoholism, we are driven to A.A., and there we discover the fatal nature of our situation." My situation became clear when I heard that many real alcoholics do not believe they are in that class.

The Third Tradition, by concentrating on "a desire to stop drinking," creates a beginning for personal recovery. Since there was a personal recovery for me, I shall always be grateful that "the only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking."

In my mind, the Fifth Tradition calls for singleness of purpose and responsibility on the part of each member, too. In our pamphlet "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated," a cartoon shows five A.A.'s hearing a signal for help. They drop their personal concerns and collectively show up at the bedside of a suffering alcoholic, indicating that as a group and as individuals, they know what their "primary purpose" is.

The pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" says, "Over the years, anonymity has proved one of the greatest gifts that A.A. offers the suffering alcoholic. Without it, many would never attend their first meeting."

Before my first meeting, I was deeply concerned about who would know. How could I risk the probability of my neighbors' discovering that I was troubled? But how could I determine if there was help for me at an anonymous meeting? I had gone back on a third promise to a sober brother that I would attend the next meeting. He called me one evening saying that he would go with me. My response was: "I can take the risk if it will do you any good." My curiosity was aroused. I wanted to understand why one particular member was so anxious to be friendly.

Subsequently, I understood that placing "principles before personalities" would result in my personal recovery. With new insight on humility, I was able to recognize the value of the Twelve Traditions and understand that anonymity was "the spiritual foundation" of them all. When I realized that the spiritual substance of anonymity meant sacrifice, rather than withholding identity, I was ready to live with reality. Living with reality has brought me here today.

Jess Bowen (Utah)

George and Mike jokes

At the Pacific Region delegates luncheon, George Dorsey (known affectionately as "Dennis the menace") was presented with two gifts—a giant chair (one foot long, one and a half inches wide) and a portable microphone. . . . At a Pacific Region convention in Oregon, George had remarked that perhaps he should consider starting a new fellowship called Microphones Anonymous. . . . And during his farewell talk at the closing brunch, commenting on the gift of a microphone, George said that perhaps the delegates thought he would suffer from "microphone withdrawal."

'My right to be absolutely wrong'

When I came into A.A., I was immediately told, "In order to stay sober, you must work the program." I read all Twelve Steps and went directly to the unwritten 13th Step, with many "out-of-bounds romances." I was not thinking about drinking, nor did I want to drink; yet I almost got drunk. Then, I had an awakening. I realized that God had done for me what I could not have done for myself—mastering my not drinking. And I was forced to take another look at the program—our own Twelve Traditions. They outline the very means how, through all my experiences, I did not drink.

My "personal recovery" depended "upon A.A. unity." Even some of my 13th Step partners informed me that our right to think, talk, and act as we wish did not give me or any other A.A. the right to impose our will on another. Some A.A.'s asked me, "Where are you getting your direction? Don't you know that in A.A. there is 'but one ultimate authority'? And there are no bosses, so please do not try to work your way to the top." Soon, I learned that "the only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking." Not only should this requirement for membership be met in the beginning, but it should continue to be met—to insure my not returning to drinking.

Now, life in A.A. was beginning to get exciting. I started finding groups that were not even lost, and I was eager to form groups to my own liking. "Autonomous" became the great word of the day. Like many other assertive A.A.'s, I soon fell victim to exercising my right to be absolutely wrong, picked myself up without any laughter, skipped over the next six Traditions, and really began to shine.

Yes, I am now at Tradition Eleven, which simply states that personal ambition has no place in A.A. But with my expertise, I knew I could help A.A. grow even faster. So I began A.A. politicking. Sure, this Tradition mentions "attraction rather than promotion," but that's "at the level of press, radio, and films." I saw nothing about promotion within our Fellowship. So I got "active," which got me more involved than any 13th-stepping I had ever done. At our 30th Anniversary Convention, I heard about the proposal to let Class B trustees outnumber Class A, and I thought, "That's for me."

Thank God, I kept making my home-group meetings, and I was finally given the privilege of being in charge. I was put in charge of emptying ashtrays, setting up tables and chairs, making coffee, and after the meetings, putting everything away. That attractive job lasted only until another grateful

alcoholic eased it away from me. So I volunteered to be my group's G.S.R. I had a problem with the group members' names, because anonymity within my group had taken on a distorted meaning. We had "You-know-who," "Whatchamacallit," "Mary A.," "Joe B.," C's, D's, right on through the alphabet. It is truly a sideshow how we A.A.'s identify each other. As G.S.R., I saw how important it was to know who my fellow group members were—full names, first *and* last—if we as a group were to survive.

Now, where am I today? Not in charge, but in essentially the same place as any other sober alcoholic in our Fellowship.

Dolores Colford (Chicago)

God's plan

Ruth Nichol (alternate delegate, Southern New Jersey) was called to the Conference on Tuesday, April 20, to replace Madge Mansfield, who had to return home because of a family emergency. After receiving that early-morning call, Ruth hung up the phone, shaking and thinking it was impossible, with all her responsibilities and family commitments. But she knew that if she was supposed to attend the Conference, God would get her there. Within two and a half hours, all arrangements had been made; A.A. friends pitched in to take over responsibilities.

Waiting for the bus to New York, Ruth realized she'd left all her cash at home—all she had was her ticket and \$4.57. But she kept going. In the cab on the way to the hotel, she told the driver to let her out when the fare reached \$4.00. He turned to her and snarled, "Lady, you do *not* come to New York without any money." That was precisely what she had done, Ruth explained. He turned again and said with a smile, "Don't worry. I won't put you out—I'll take you to the hotel. And have a good time!" Tony Osnato (G.S.O. office manager) assisted with some immediate cash, and Ruth received her expense check the next day.

Other people are 'autonomous,' too

I was brought to you by a guy in this room today, Garnet, the delegate from Saskatchewan. He visited me uninvited, and I went to an A.A. meeting that day and have not had a drink since. When he made that call, I wonder whether he looked at me and said to himself, "Now there is a trusted servant."

I recovered because of the unity in my A.A. group. In that light, I learned that I must not only contribute to my own recovery, but work selflessly with the A.A.'s who continue to teach me. Early in my sobriety, when all my world was falling around me, my sponsor told me that A.A. had survived for 33 years as a result of its dependence upon "a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience." He informed me that my work, play, and family life would be better served on that same principle—for my associates and family were also a group—and that if I removed self, allowing this new source of power to work in all my affairs, he would guarantee me a happy life.

If I did not exercise my ego by trying to govern, but rather de-

veloped until I could lead by example, all areas of my new way of life would be okay, my sponsor said. Upon arrival in A.A., I was an inventory-taker (of others, of course), so I am grateful for Tradition Three. It told me that any person, regardless of my judgment, could be a member if he or she had "a desire to stop drinking." Four also gave me explicit direction: Being a member of one group did not give me the right to determine how other groups might function. Another part of the valuable lesson: I had best keep my nose out of the behavior of associates, friends, and in-law family, for they, too, were entitled to make their own decisions and in effect were autonomous, as is each A.A. group. A sound personal principle also enhances the lessons of Traditions Five and Six: Like the A.A. group, I am given a primary purpose—to fit myself to be of maximum service to God and my fellows. Only then can I help my group fulfill its responsibility.

Prior to A.A., I was not big on working for a living. I was somewhat less than self-supporting—all contributions gratefully accepted. In A.A., it was brought to my attention that the success stories in our Fellowship were heard from those who packed a lunch bucket and went to work. "Earn your own way," said my sponsor. "Then, our group will know that money you put in the kitty will be the result of *your* effort, not someone else's. We decline outside contributions."

Tradition Eight, personally applied, teaches humility: I shall not be a professional A.A. or a professional twelfth-stepper. If there is a need for special services and workers, let those who are professionally trained fill that need. I was taught by Tradition Nine that rigidity and extreme personal organization are defects of character, expressing ego and perfectionism. Further, it cautions me that aggressively seeking wealth, prestige, and power creates a personality without humility and closes the door to spiritual growth.

The principle of "no opinion on outside issues" has been a valuable personal lesson: If I take sides *as an A.A. member*, my opinion can be construed by association as that of the Fellowship.

On the concept of "attraction rather than promotion," I think in personal terms. The longer I am sober, the greater my opportunity and responsibility in work, family, and community—meaning more people know of my being a member of A.A. Therefore, it is incumbent upon me to act and react appropriately; I may be the only Big Book the public may ever read. When I came to A.A., I was less than attractive, and my sponsors informed me that I should clean up my act.

"Anonymity at the level of press, radio, and films" not only protects me from me, but asks me to do all I can do to assure survival of our Fellowship, for those yet to come. Bill said, "The spiritual substance of anonymity is sacrifice." The connotations of anonymity as a spiritual foundation suggest that I set aside personal desires for the common good—perhaps not only within our Fellowship, but among all whom I may have contact with.

If only the Steps had been applied to my recovery, and not the principles of our Traditions, the degree of my recovery would be much different.

Stan Cameron, trustee-at-large/Canada

Reports on Area Service Highlights

Highlights

Alaska: We have 105 groups and about 1,500 members. Our small population and the great distances between our cities, towns, and villages (often accessible only by air) prompted a vote at the September 1981 conference for districting of our state. We hope the final plan will be agreed upon at the Kodiak Quarterly Conference in June 1982 and specific districts voted upon in September. We feel that lines of communication will be opened throughout the state. Our main problems stem from a lack of knowledge of A.A. structure nationally and worldwide.—*Jim McCourt*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: Using public information material supplied by G.S.O., our area has experienced much goodwill and acceptance from the media. One very special happening recently was the addition of the East Kootenays in British Columbia, bringing to our area seven communities with a total of 14 groups and approximately 183 members. Another special event was a sharing session in Calgary. Sponsorship workshops were conducted in many districts, and through these, we hope, we will not lose sight of getting back to basics and keeping it simple.—*Ken Treganowan*

Arizona: We are suffering growing pains. "If it works, don't fix it" is an excellent axiom if "it" is working. Unfortunately, assemblies and intergroup meetings are not well attended, and many A.A.'s and groups do not care about representation. We have two problems: New people do not find out about service and its benefits; and those involved in service become bored and do not stay or do not carry out their responsibilities. We are trying to make our assemblies and other service meetings more interesting. For example, we have moved our assemblies around the state and to outlying districts so that groups there feel more a part of the committee.—*Mary E. DeFer*

California (Mid-Southern): We have never taken a strong part in presenting new material to the Conference Agenda Committee. Last year, however, we initiated a Conference committee correspondence program involving all 19 districts. Each district is assigned to one Conference committee (some committees have two correspondents) and given the name of the G.S.O. staff member who is secretary of that committee. They correspond with "their" committee during the year and give reports at our assemblies and committee meetings.—*Dyanne Gilliam*

California (Northern Interior): The area committee has been concentrating on group registration and implementation of the 60-30-10 Plan. We have encountered a few problems where meetings want to remain as they are, with no ties or obligations to anyone. Through district workshops on the Twelve Concepts and buzz sessions at our area committee meetings, considerable progress has been made at the group level. Participation is the main ingredient in any gains made in establishing functioning committees or group cooperation. Repeated referral to Tradition One and study of that chapter in the "Twelve and Twelve" have been helpful.—*Doc Campbell*

Old-fashioned Manhattan

Early one morning, first-year delegate John Goetschel (Northern Illinois) stepped out for a leisurely city walk, only to find himself nearly flattened by one of Manhattan's avid cyclists. "It was a real eye-opener," he said, with a slight case of sober shakes.

California (San Diego): At our most recent district committee meeting, we took an inventory of our area assembly. Our basic concern was for four districts that are not currently active. It was suggested that monthly district meetings be created to stir up interest and participation. We are also busy revising and updating our statement of purpose and service-structure guidelines with the assistance of our past delegate. In addition, we are concentrating our efforts on developing more group participation and awareness and interest in world service.—*Don Callahan*

Delaware: Our attitudes toward service are outstanding, as expressed in the continued dedication needed for regular meetings at detox centers, prisons, and hospitals. Also, there is continued support for A.A. answering services in all three counties. These commitments are discussed and schedules arranged always with good attitudes and G.S.R. response.—*James Reeves*

Georgia: We have 16 districts, with the larger districts divided into zones, giving a total of 27 D.C.M.'s. Many districts have workshops, and there are plans for several regional workshops. We are emphasizing the need for sponsoring those who come to us from treatment centers and institutional facilities. This is being handled at the district level with help from the state institutions chairperson. We also have a state Grapevine chairperson, and nearly all groups have GvRs.—*John Langston*

Idaho: We have seven districts, with an agenda item for the spring assembly to discuss creating an eighth. Our area also includes cities in Oregon, Nevada, Montana, and Wyoming. Last year, District 6 was split to form District 7, too, consisting of 11 groups with 16 meetings. The request for an eighth district has come from four groups in District 2. We are working closely with treatment centers and youth. We are furnishing speakers for every health class at Ricks College (20 classes each semester).—*Bill Dick*

Illinois (Northern): Our area consists of 14 districts, with approximately 600 groups. Our Correctional Facility Committee is gaining acceptance at the county penal level, heretofore not fully coordinated in our area. Our P.I. Committee is now publishing a newsletter. Thus, we are reporting the progress of our area service to the members of our Fellowship who aren't reached by any other means. Hospitals and institutions have been kept fairly well informed in past years, thanks to hard-working committee members.—*John C. Goetschel*

Indiana (Southern): Last year, both areas in our state underwent redistricting, which doubled the total number of districts, and we are currently filling D.C.M. and alternate D.C.M. positions in some of the new districts. Our state committee, which serves both our delegate areas, has just formed two new committees, on archives and women's institutions. Also, a committee has been appointed for the purpose of writing a state structure. Currently, we are planning for the Tenth East Central Region Conference of Past and Present A.A. Delegates (February 1983) and for the fourth East Central Regional Forum (1983).—*Jill S. Johnston*

Kansas: Our major accomplishment last year was to complete a written service structure and have it approved in the assembly. We also established workshops for our preassembly meetings, and they have increased attendance tremendously. We have set up a Kansas State Conference Committee, with

the area treasurer also the conference treasurer. We have reduced the cost of our newsletter and communications by using nonprofit stamps. We have changed from two committees and two assemblies to four assemblies. We have also established a Kansas Area Archives Committee, which is now gathering material and compiling it.—*Bob Talkington*

During the Friday-afternoon session, Jesse Owen (Utah) prefaced his presentation by commenting that he wasn't really nervous—that morning, he'd merely found himself polishing his dentures with Preparation H. . . . At the closing brunch on Saturday, Jesse used his cane to reach for the sugar bowl, which was a fair distance across the table. As he pulled the cane-encircled bowl gracefully toward him, Peggy Scription (Northwestern Ohio) quipped, "Is that what you call sugar cane in your part of the country?"

Kentucky: We have a real good committee because of our past delegates' wisdom. We always have five to eight past delegates at each state assembly. It's good to know that they are there when we need them. I think our worst problem is communication. I don't think that's new, but I do hope it gets better. It will if we all work at it. I think we all want the same thing—the best for our area—but we all go about it differently. That's all right as long as we know that when the chips are down, we're together.—*Billy Moore*

Maine: We added 28 new groups in 1981 and now have a total of 165. We have redistricted twice in five years. Each district meets once a month, and we have two assemblies a year. We have 25 D.C.M.'s covering an area of over 33,000 square miles. Our C.P.C. Committee is very active. We have established a central office, and answering services have been set up within districts. We now have hospital and institution coordinators. Our laxity in following the suggested guidelines and "The A.A. Service Manual" at all levels seems to be hindering our ability to involve A.A.'s in service work. We are trying to rectify this by speaking more of service work.—*Frank Rinaldo*

Manitoba: We have 13 districts and 144 groups, and about 70% are represented at our assemblies. We have an active Institutions Committee, which provides literature and sponsorship to a federal penitentiary, two provincial jails, two work camps, two youth centers, and a women's center. The Hospital Committee keeps literature available, brings A.A. into hospitals, and provides contacts for patients being released. Last year, we established a C.P.C. Committee as an offshoot of our P.I. Committee. Our C.P.C. Committee is a joint venture with Winnipeg Intergroup and has not extended much beyond the borders of that city. We hope to establish a second committee to serve the Brandon area (180,000 population).—*Phil Cels*

Maryland: Baltimore has been redistricted according to the postal zones of meeting locations; 34 ZIP Code locations were grouped according to size and geographic proximity to make up 13 districts. The move facilitated correct placement of new groups, enhanced D.C.M. communications, and reduced complex travel procedures in D.C.M.-to-group contacts. The C.P.C. Committee is initiating a symposium for the professional community to exchange ideas for eliminating stumbling blocks in helping the suffering alcoholic.—*Frank Youell*

Massachusetts (Western): We now have five districts and 101 groups. Our communication and service participation have been continuously improving since we formed districts, in 1978. The C.P.C. Committee has increased commitments to our professional community in education and mental health. Groups are beginning to send representatives to the archives meeting. The P.I. Committee is very active and now has a weekly radio program. The Grapevine Committee has 37 GvRs. The Institution Committee is still one committee, having voted not to subdivide into correctional and treatment facilities. A new "sponsor roster" lists names of A.A.'s willing to transport ready-to-be-released inmates to A.A. meetings.—*Betty Reed*

Michigan (Western): The greatest asset that we have is our state committee meeting, which is held in Lansing four times a year for the sole purpose of communicating and sharing our experience, strength, and hope with one another so that we may better carry the message to alcoholics who still suffer, and may help their families and loved ones. I believe that God has blessed us with some very dedicated committee persons.—*Ron Bush*

Minnesota (Northern): Our area consists of 14 districts with 380 groups. The assembly has semiannual meetings and bi-monthly area committee meetings. The assembly includes the area delegate, alternate delegate, chairperson, secretary, and treasurer, and the P.I., institutions, literature, and Grapevine chairpersons. The districts have comparable chairpersons. We have one fall service workshop and many roundups, some with public information luncheons. Six districts have mini-service workshops, and there are many district roundups. Some districts have monthly and some bimonthly G.S.R. meetings.—*Tom LeTourneau*

Mississippi: As soon as I was a year in the Fellowship, I was elected G.S.R. I have served as state institutions chairperson and D.C.M. in the First District. Presently, I am the state convention chairperson. I can't find words to express my heartfelt gratitude for God and A.A. Trying to be of service has meant the difference—my being sober and not drinking. Thank you all for being a part of my sobriety today. "Faith in God, clean house, service to others" is the message I try to carry.—*Percy Moore*

Montana: Two years ago, we started a state newsletter, which will be continued for another two years. Last year, we held a regional mini-forum (requested by our past delegate), which perked things up a lot. Our Institutions and P.I. Committees are active where their members live, but need help statewide. We have grown to about 190 groups in 11 districts. Many districts are still too big geographically, and D.C.M.'s need financial help. My hopes are for a written service structure to acquaint our members with the purpose of the area committee and its obligations.—*Ray Vevik*

Nebraska: For the first time, we have separate chairpersons for our committees on institutions, workshops, public information, C.P.C., literature, archives, state newsletter, and Grapevine. We also have coordinated our state committee meetings and assemblies with the state Al-Anon meetings to help reduce conflicts. Our newsletter is new and will be issued quarterly. One of our main concerns is a workshop item at the Conference: how to better reach alcoholics coming out of treatment centers, institutions, and other organizations.—*D. L. Oberg*

New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island: In the past two years, awareness of unity and service in all districts has been our main goal. Through hosting area committee meetings and workshops at all levels, great interest has been taken in P.I., institutions, literature banks, and C.P.C. We now hope to start general sharing sessions to gain greater insight into the needs of our bilingual provinces. We are trying to hold assemblies in central locations in the provinces to increase attendance. We have 13 districts, 167 groups, and about 2,600 active members. We also hope to redistrict the larger districts.—*Myron Snow*

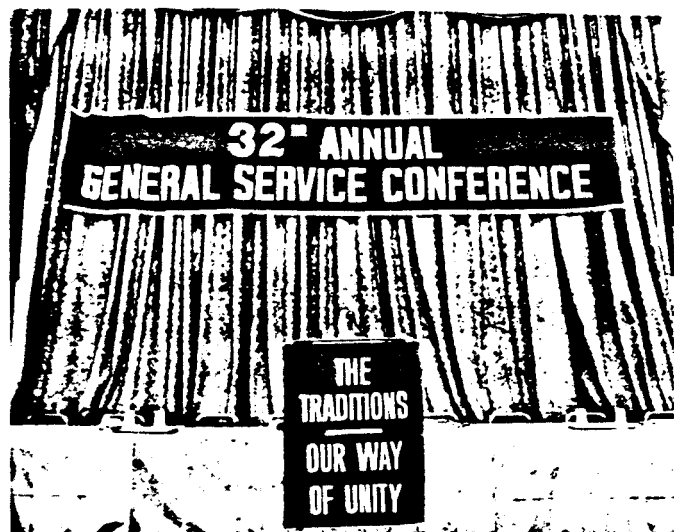
New Hampshire: We began 1981 with our 13th Annual Mid-winter Banquet. In May, we had the first area assembly meeting held in our "north country," and it was well attended. Our 16th Annual Area Convention was a big success. In 1977, the area assembly started a contingency fund to save money for an area service office. In August 1981, our assembly voted to open a small office. In October, we held our Fourth Annual Assembly Workshop. Our committees are doing well. The geographical structure of our state makes distance a factor in attendance at committee meetings, but this problem is being worked on with some success.—*Richard Darling*

New Jersey (Southern): To improve our service structure, we are now redistricting our area, consisting of 18 districts with about 200 groups. Our past delegate heads the committee to accomplish our goal of regular meetings in every district with workshops studying the Traditions, the Twelve Concepts, and "The A.A. Service Manual." The 60-30-10 pamphlet, assembly minutes, and convention information are being sent to G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s regularly. Our intergroup's P.I. Committee has had encouraging responses to letters sent to students from the third grade through college level.—*Madge Mansfield*

New Mexico: A key issue in our area was the problem of whether our annual area convention should be held in Albuquerque permanently. The area assembly decided to move our convention to a different part of the state each year. Another issue concerns ensuring that all area servants receive financial help to attend assemblies. It was felt that without such help, only those who could afford it would volunteer for jobs, and that the area is responsible for financing their attendance. At this time, we are not able to pay all expenses, but substantial headway has been made.—*David Leonard*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): We are expanding both south and north, including several groups in the Poughkeepsie area and half a dozen in the St. Lawrence area. We are hosting the New York State Convention in July 1982. Our C.P.C. Committee has launched a project with Albany Medical College in which freshman medical students are introduced to A.A. through "sponsors" and open meetings. Our P.I. Committee is now being revived. We have established the position of area newsletter editor and have decided to hold three day-long assemblies with workshops in the morning and voting in the afternoon.—*John Currier*

New York (Western): Our area voted to keep the same meeting schedule used for the past two years. The full assembly will meet four times a year; the area committee, six times a year. We now have three intergroups: Buffalo Central Office, Niagara Falls, and New York-Pennsylvania. We are working to coordinate the C.P.C., P.I., and Hospitals and Institutions Committees. The New York-Pennsylvania Intergroup



has placed "Alcoholics Anonymous" in all high schools, jails, and hospitals in that border region. We are working toward and receiving better cooperation with the medical profession and law-enforcement people.—*George Lathrop*

North Dakota: We have adopted a budget and set some priorities. Learning to live within our income has changed the whole complexion of our meetings, and we no longer waste time bickering about money. We also have asked the D.C.M.'s for input in setting up the agenda for the area meetings. This has worked quite well. Some districts are doing great things in P.I. work. At one area meeting, one of these districts put on a demonstration of a P.I. committee in action, using us as the audience. That made it easier to show other districts why we need P.I.—*Elmer Johnsrud*

Ohio (Northwestern)/Michigan (Southeastern): We have been redistricting our area, trying to break down the districts so that each has no more than 15 groups and no less than ten, and we've added five new districts. This year, for the first time, we have elected alternate D.C.M.'s. Also, we have been preparing for the Ohio State Conference (August 6-8, 1982) at Bowling Green State University. Taking the conference to a university makes it affordable to more people.—*Peggy Screptock*

Ohio (Southwestern)/Kentucky (Northern): In the past two years, we reviewed the Twelve Concepts covering the Third Legacy of A.A. During the next two years, we plan to review the responsibilities of G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s as well as officers. The Traditions will be discussed at length. Communication and unity within our area and with intergroups need to be improved. Past delegates will be given committee assignments. Growth of new groups has made it necessary to constantly realign districts and elect additional D.C.M.'s. The turnover of G.S.R.'s indicates a need to attract more members into service.—*Ralph L. Huelsman*

Ontario (Western): Our greatest concern has been the lack of knowledge and experience of our area committee pertaining to general service; but since the inception of two-day assemblies, all this has changed. We now have the time to not only transact our business but also conduct workshops and sharing sessions and show films. The enthusiasm expressed by all attending our assemblies is most encouraging.—*Barney Malik*

Oregon: Many speaker meetings have sprung up this past year, and those already established have grown. Because of the great increase in group population, we have divided another district into three districts; thus, in a little over two years, we have grown from 14 to 20 districts. Service workshops were held in several districts. Individual workshops were held on intergroup, secretary, G.S.R., and D.C.M. These workshops were well attended. A beautiful growth in open-mindedness has been sweeping the area. Many older members have come forth to attend workshops and mini-assemblies and lend their experience and strength to service work. This communication has fostered a different type of sponsorship. Sponsors working in service are actually becoming service sponsors in an unofficial way.—*Diane Salnave*

Puerto Rico: In 1981, we had 91 groups listed. We started service functions in the central office in 1980 and an intergroup service in the Central District in 1981. Both offices have a friendly relationship with the general service area. Different committees are proving to be very helpful in achieving our goals. Now that we are seeing continued and progressive growth, we are considering dividing the 28 groups in the Metropolitan District into two different districts.—*Luis Raul*

What's 'that'?

At the delegates meeting, Bill Bailey (West Virginia) reminded delegate chairperson Stan Brys not to begin by telling the delegates that "we can't talk about *that*, whatever *that* happens to be." Last year, he remembers, after being told not to talk about *that*, the delegates spent the rest of the evening talking about *what* to talk about, ignoring two fine presentations.

Quebec (Northwestern): We have 260 groups in ten districts. Some districts have up to five committee members. Nine districts have annual conventions. The area committee meets every two months with all D.C.M.'s, and committee members meet twice a year. The steering committee meets every month. Our only problem is translating our literature from English to French, but lately I believe we have found a solution.—*Rolly Brunet*

Quebec (Southwestern): Our area has 457 groups, 333 of which are French-speaking. A few years back, we started information sessions for our G.S.R.'s, and now we are reaping the benefits, because our groups are better structured. G.S.R.'s meet monthly with D.C.M.'s, and our 25 districts report to the area every month at the same time as our six different committees. We also hold quarterly assemblies. Our P.I. Committee gives informative sessions on how to carry the message and works with industry, commerce, the clergy, medical students, educators, and treatment centers. C.P.C. is still within the P.I. Committee, but by next year, we hope, a separate committee will be well established.—*Stella Lefebvre*

Rhode Island: We'll be having our third annual roundup and sixth convention this year, both sponsored by our assembly. We are divided into seven districts. Currently, five are active, a sixth is ready to open, and work is going on in the seventh. In this small state, we're able to attend all C.P.C., P.I., institutions, Grapevine, and district meetings. The young people

hold a large weekend convention, which they put together themselves. Last year, they asked the area committee to share in all-day workshops on Legacies, Traditions, and structure.—*Gerard Coutu*

Saskatchewan: This area is divided into 16 districts varying in size from 100 to 12,000 square miles. Each year, we have three area assembly meetings, which move to different districts. We have about 285 groups, and it is our aim to have each one active at the G.S.R. level. Last year, only 57% of our groups contributed to G.S.O. We realize that it is our job to explain to groups the need to contribute to help keep A.A. fully self-supporting. The last delegate was elected through the résumé system, and it was suggested that we continue the system in the future.—*Garnet Wipf*

South Carolina: The most important new development in our area is in C.P.C. Most detoxes and rehabs are state-operated, and a lot of misunderstanding has existed between our A.A. groups and the local commissions on alcohol and drug abuse as to their roles in the recovery process. We invited directors of various commissions and their staffs to attend a workshop, with a panel consisting of one director and two A.A.'s (one a past delegate, the other employed in the alcoholism field). The result was improved relationships with the commissions. The State Alcohol and Drug Abuse Commission then offered a course on the role of A.A. in the treatment process; A.A.'s participating emphasized the Traditions.—*Bill Blount*

South Dakota: We stress the importance of involvement of our trusted servants in all areas of A.A. We have two workshops, two state conferences, and one regional conference a year. We have formed committees and redistricted; recently, we formed an Archives Committee. Self-support is a popular subject. How are we going to make service attractive to those who feel such jobs are just for members who can afford it? Communication between groups and districts needs a more workable system. At this time, we are stressing the Traditions and GvRs—how vital they are to A.A. structure.—*Mabel A. Moebek*

Tennessee: We have four quarterly assemblies in different locations, giving added incentive to A.A.'s to become active in service work. P.I. media workshops have been held in three metropolitan areas. Hospital, treatment center, and institution committees have held joint statewide meetings. Failure of groups to consistently contribute to G.S.O. is of great concern, and suggestions for improving motivation are welcome. In 1982, we will host a world's fair in Knoxville. We anticipate between 11 and 13 million visitors and are preparing for increased Twelfth Step calls and attendance at A.A. groups.—*W. Buford Lewallen*

Texas (Northwestern): In our area, groups are becoming more conscious of the Seventh Tradition. Four years ago, there was \$150 in the area committee account; today, the amount is close to \$2,000. Also, groups are becoming more interested in electing G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s. Communications are open within the area. In the last year, attendance at service meetings has more than doubled. One large city will soon subdivide into four districts with additional D.C.M.'s. We held the first annual Northwest Texas Conference, which was a tremendous success.—*Doug Riley*

Texas (Southwestern): Our area covers 280,000 square miles, with 23 districts and 250 groups. A specific goal for

1982 is to encourage sponsorship, especially service sponsorship as it pertains to A.A. structure and committee organization and use. We feel a great need to carry the message through the service arm of A.A. Although our personal recovery begins with the Steps, much of our way of life is lost without the Traditions and Concepts as they apply, not just to groups and service assemblies, but to our happiness in sobriety.—*Clyde Mitchell*

Vermont: Four of our eight districts are structured and active. New groups have sprung up primarily in these structured districts, and each district has an answering service. Correctional facilities and treatment centers are well provided for by districts' rotating their groups each month to put on "inside" meetings. Other methods are employed in more restricted facilities. The area assembly meets monthly, alternating locations every two months, and participation has increased, mostly from structured districts. Our state convention is held in May and historically has been well attended.—*Sarah J. Gunzinger*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Michigan (Upper Peninsula): Our

area is becoming more service-oriented. Enthusiasm and interest are growing mainly because of the increasing number of workshops and sponsorship in general service. We also see growth in our monthly Saturday-night get-togethers for A.A.'s, Al-Anons, and anyone else interested. Our monthly area newsletter has expanded, with almost 400 groups now on the mailing list. Cooperation with treatment centers and institutions is good. We hold two conferences a year—spring and fall. At our spring conference, we will discuss the need for additional assemblies.—*John Heidemann*

Wyoming: Much progress has been made in the past few years in improving our service structure. In February 1982, a business meeting was held in Gillette, with an attendance of about 86, representing nine of our 11 districts—by far our best service conference yet. Many members now talk of service work and the spiritual growth it has given them, and past officers have given their support. Recently, we have started workshops on the Traditions and service. Larger communities have finally started intergroup meetings to alleviate difficulties before they become problems. This has helped immensely in promoting unity.—*Dave McHenry*

Quick Replies to Ask-It Basket Queries

Areas

Q Is there an experience or example to indicate that an area service structure is improved by increasing area assembly meetings to more than two per year?

A It was the sense of the meeting that the number held each year depended a good deal on the geographical setup of an area. Most of those who shared had at least two; many areas move the meeting site all over the area, using a bid process. It was felt that this generated interest and activity.

Q How many delegate areas help defray the expenses of area officers going to area assemblies?

A A show of hands among delegates indicated that at least one-third of the areas represented helped defray area officers' expenses, but that fewer were able to defray the expenses of alternates, secretaries, D.C.M.'s, and committee chairpersons.

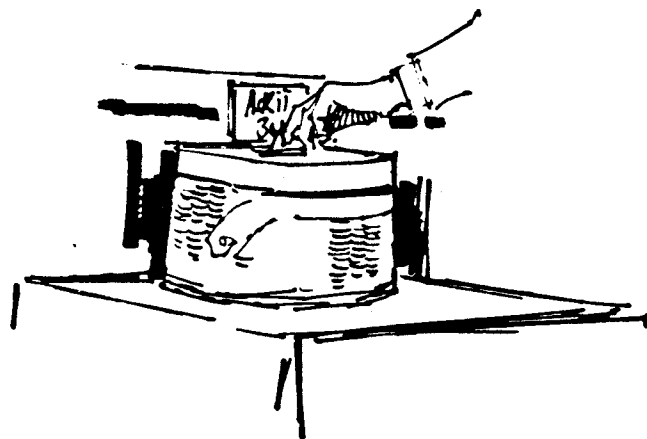
Q Should areas have paid employees?

A One area reported that it had no paid employees.

Q Should areas have any kind of reserves?

A It was the sense of the meeting that all areas, if possible, should have a reserve as a hedge against inflation. The amount varies from area to area; one area said its reserve equaled a year's operating expenses, the reserve being scrutinized yearly in view of the past year's expenditures; another kept a prudent reserve of about one month's expenses.

Q A new group can't join my district unless it has been in existence for six months. I would like some sharing from other areas on this subject.



A It was the sense of the meeting that this matter is up to local autonomy. However, of those who shared, *most* areas indicated that they do impose a trial period before a new group is listed, simply because so many groups fold in a short time and the listing process entails a lot of paperwork. Most areas have trial periods ranging from 30 to 90 days. It was suggested that new groups might start off simply as meetings for a certain time, and when the meeting was more securely established, it would be listed as a group.

Q Who pays the D.C.M.'s expenses to attend assemblies, etc.? "The A.A. Service Manual" does not specify exactly who pays.

A There was much sharing on this matter. In most areas, each district (through the groups) pays the expenses of its D.C.M.'s

attendance at assemblies. All agreed that as much financial support as possible should be provided for all our service workers, so that all may serve, not just those who can afford it.

Q Are there any areas that have their own offices? Any districts?

A The New Hampshire delegate said that his area had just opened an area office, by assembly vote. Office equipment formerly strewn all over the state was consolidated into one office, run by volunteers. A board of directors, selected from the assembly, represents as many parts of the state as possible.

Georgia has an area office that coordinates groups in the state, publishes a state directory, and maintains a supply of Conference-approved literature purchased from G.S.O. It is staffed by a non-A.A., part-time secretary, who answers the phones, and an A.A. assembly secretary, who coordinates area assemblies.

Central or intergroup offices

Q In our central office, there is no set rotation of the office manager—our last rotated out after he stole our money. Being manager seems to bring a lot of power. Is there any way to set a time limit on this job without fighting?

A After much sharing, it was the sense of the meeting that the rotation principle should not apply to salaried employees. People who are not doing their jobs properly should be fired. Other suggestions: a job description for the office manager, including a time limit; more frequent internal audits.

Q By a show of hands, how many areas have no central or intergroup office?

A Twelve hands were raised.

Clubs

Q Does G.S.O. accept a contribution from a club if it is made in the name of a group? (We have groups that meet in clubs but have no treasuries of their own; collections are turned over to the club treasurer; the club makes the contribution.)

A Yes. If a contribution comes as a club check but there is an indication that the club acts as agent for the group, the contribution is accepted. G.S.O. should be informed which groups are contributing.

Directories

Q Could the color of the cover of the *Eastern United States A.A. Directory* be changed so names of areas are more legible?

A Colors are changed each year. Anyone having a suggestion is free to submit a color swatch!

Q How closely are the composition and nature of groups screened before they are listed in the directories? Are special-interest groups listed?

A As a rule, we do not investigate information submitted to G.S.O. If there is any doubt as to the nature of a group, we write and ask for clarification. We list only A.A. groups in the directories. We do not list family groups or Al-Anon/A.A. groups or meetings.

General Service Board

Q Why is there only one woman trustee? Why can't a woman be considered for Class A trustee now?

A There is presently a vacancy for a Class A trustee; all members are welcome to propose potential candidates; both men and women candidates have been nominated. However, the ultimate selection comes about as a result of voting—a private matter, the outcome of which is not known until after the votes have been counted.

Is there a dentist in the house?

The sore and swollen jaw of the delegate from Iowa, Doris Beacom, was attended to in an emergency-style procedure by trustee David Aronofsky. A hotel bathroom served as dentist's office. Dave used a spoon as a tongue-depressor and an emery board to file down an ill-fitting partial, gave Doris some medication, and sent the grateful patient on her way. (Don't report him for practicing without a license—he's a legit D.D.S.)

Q It struck many delegates that all trustees except one are white, middle-aged males. Why aren't women and minorities represented at all?

A It is felt that there is inherent danger in any kind of quota system.

General Service Conference

Q If G.S.O. staff members are full Conference members, why don't they have a vote in committee?

A The Concept of the "Right of Participation" gives staff members the right to participate as voting members of the Conference. However, it would not be wise to allow staff members to vote on their own activities, which are generally the topics of committee meetings. Thus, they do not vote at the committee level.

Q What is the feeling of the Conference on canceling future Ask-It Basket sessions at the Conference? We, as delegates, should have experience and strength to share honestly and openly.

A This question was put to the floor of the Conference. It was the unanimous sense of the meeting that Ask-It Basket sessions should be continued, because they provide a means of communication for those who might otherwise not participate at the microphones or at committee meetings, and because these sessions cover a lot of territory in a short time.

Q Is it true that Bill W. was not a voting member of the Conference but was always present, and that nobody had the courage to tell him he was not a voting member?

A Bill didn't have to vote—he only had to get up and speak!

General Service Office

Q Could the names and addresses of delegates and D.C.M.'s be put on group information sheets?

A The sheets currently in use are quite expensive, and the cost of a supply specially printed for each of 91 areas would be

prohibitive. It was suggested, however, that the area itself could have the additional printing done locally.

Q Wouldn't a "special order" service (at extra cost) for material needed in an emergency be a good idea?

A This kind of special service is available now: If we are informed that an order is needed urgently, it is shipped on an expedited basis, such as using Federal Express.

Q Would it be possible to return to the old Literature Order Form or to simplify the one we have?

A We are now in the process of reviewing suggested changes. After this Conference, we will take all suggestions into consideration before printing a new form.

Q Are G.S.R. Kits sent to all new G.S.R.'s? Wouldn't it be less costly to pass them on at the local level?

A G.S.R. Kits (now available in English and French) are sent to all new G.S.R.'s. This service enhances communication, though it may be somewhat expensive. (And it certainly wouldn't hurt any group to have two service manuals.)

Q Can central offices be given a supply of Group Handbooks to furnish to new groups?

A As a matter of policy, G.S.O. does not provide New Group Handbooks to central offices, because this is an important method of getting new groups to list themselves with us. If we supplied handbooks to central offices for this purpose, we would lose direct contact with new groups.

Q What relationship does the International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A. have to the service structure of A.A. or to G.S.O.?

A This council has no relation to the service structure, as such. It is an A.A. entity, however, in the sense that it is made up of A.A. members who share A.A. experience, is self-supporting, and has no outside affiliation.

Grapevine

Q Could contributions to the Grapevine be acknowledged if or when the item is passed over for publication?

A The Grapevine acknowledges *all* manuscripts upon receipt at the office. If an article is chosen to be published, it is again acknowledged by sending the author an advance copy of the Grapevine issue in which his or her article appears.

Literature

Q Our Big Books are falling apart from use. Can we look into upgrading the quality?

A The Big Book is now expensively bound in the best materials available. (A comparable book from a commercial publisher would cost about \$15 in a bookstore. Our price to A.A. groups is \$4.65—in quantity, less.) Let us know if you have a poorly bound copy; we'll gladly replace it.

Q Can we expect films captioned for the deaf in the near future?

A Yes. This has been suggested, and a subcommittee is now working with the hearing-impaired on this matter.

Q Why doesn't G.S.O. stock a small amount of all foreign-language material for domestic use?



A sampling of A.A. literature in languages other than English made this Conference display board a striking illustration of the broad geographical range that the Fellowship now covers.

A This is done, and we also have information about overseas general service offices where this material can be obtained if we don't have it in stock.

Q Now that "The A.A. Service Manual" and "Twelve Concepts" are combined, will the manual still be sold separately or will we end up with a surplus of manuals? If so, let's put them to use somehow.

A Our stock of the separate manual is depleted. It was suggested that central offices or intergroups that still have these in stock could use them for institutions groups or sell them to other members. There is no reason to throw them away.

Q Why don't we completely review our literature and keep ours a single-purpose program?

A Various trustees' committees are presently reviewing all our literature. If any delegates or other A.A.'s have any suggestions, please communicate with the chairperson of the trustees' subcommittee charged with the literature review (via Curtis Monahan at G.S.O., secretary of the trustees' Literature Committee).

Miscellaneous

Q What is being done to assure the anonymity of living persons whose stories are being accumulated for the archives?

A The Archives Handbook shares information on how to gather local histories and maintain individual anonymity. It suggests that oral histories be made available to A.A. members only and that any transcripts to be distributed be carefully edited first.

Q Why can't we be provided with coffee before the morning Conference session?

A Coffee service at any hotel is very expensive; it was felt that it would be a more prudent use of our funds to provide it only during our short coffee breaks. At other times, members can buy coffee in the many coffee shops in and near the hotel.

Q What will become of Stepping Stones when Lois is gone?

A This is a private and confidential matter that is strictly up to Lois Wilson, who owns the property.

Q How many of the Conference members are nonsmokers?

A About 60% so identified themselves by a show of hands.

Reports From G.S.O., the General Service Board, and Trustees' Committees

These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

General Service Board

Outgoing chairperson sees growing A.A. strength

Trustees' report: This will be my last report to you as chairperson of the General Service Board. I am resigning at the end of the Conference. I am grateful for the trust and warm support given by my fellow trustees. I am grateful that I had the benefit of all I learned from Dr. Jack's example and experiences. Gordon has served the board well these past seven years. He understands A.A. and has a real feel for the Fellowship. I am sure he will do a fine job for us.

Group contributions in 1981 to support G.S.O. services were nearly 20% greater than in 1980—a heartening achievement. Sales of A.A. literature topped 1981 by 11.5%—about 1,000,000 hardcover books and booklets and over 6,000,000 pamphlets. Another indication of continued growth: About 3,500 new groups in the U.S. and Canada were added to the records at G.S.O., for a net gain of about 2,000. A large percentage of existing A.A. groups are not listed at G.S.O. at all—a situation that I hope will improve.

Many of you remember the great concern expressed at last year's Conference over the financial and operating problems of the A.A. Grapevine. As reported elsewhere [page 46], the board of directors of the Grapevine has undertaken heroic measures. My favorite magazine (and yours, too, I hope) is budgeting to end up in the black in 1982.

In my view, Regional Forums have been one of the board's most worthwhile endeavors. A mini-forum was held in Billings, Mont., for the benefit of members in remote and sparsely populated mountain states who are unable to attend regular Forums because of the long-distance travel entailed. Very few of the nearly 200 service-minded people who showed up in Billings had ever had the opportunity to meet a trustee or a staff member before. Forums in general provide the extra personal and accurate communication that is trust.

A dramatic strengthening of the A.A. service structure is evident in many countries. A.A. is truly coming of age around the world, much as it did in the U.S. and Canada in 1955. For instance, by underwriting the expenses of the First European Service Meeting, the General Service Board in the United Kingdom stepped into the same role that our board has played in relation to the World Service Meeting.

After inspecting meeting facilities, hotels, and transportation in Montreal, Que., the board approved that city as the site of the 1985 International Convention. Since that decision, a number of planning meetings have been held.

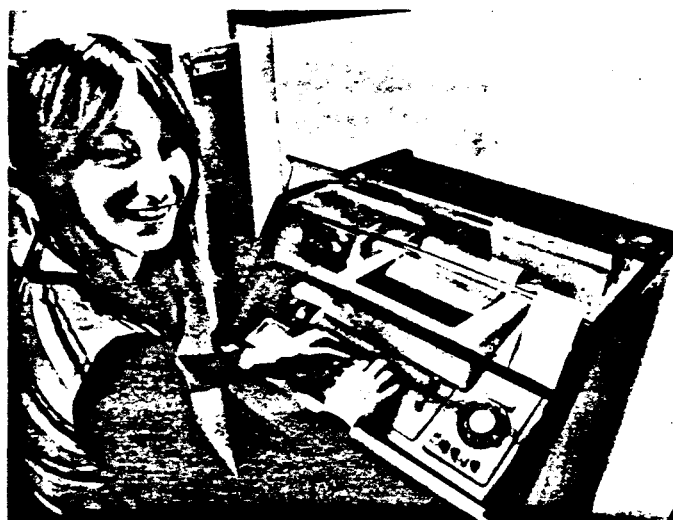
The entire period since the 1981 Conference has been occupied with the construction and refurbishing project at the General Service Office and the A.A. Grapevine, to provide more space and more attractive surroundings, as recom-

mended by the 1980 Conference. The job was complicated by the necessity to keep operating at full tilt during demolition and construction. Staff and employees deserve great credit for handling a record volume of service work under difficult conditions.

The writing of the biography of our co-founder Bill is going into its third draft. We will be living with this important book for a long time, and we want to be sure that it is the best possible work.

The board has suffered two tragic losses since we last met. LaVelle Clifford died October 14, in the midst of her third year as Southwest regional trustee. On December 8, M. T. (Bud) Grondahl, East Central regional trustee, died most unexpectedly in his sleep. Both will be sorely missed.

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D., chairperson



Quantity literature orders are handled via telex, and Cindy Katzman of Inventory Control is kept busy at the keyboard.

A.A. World Services, Inc.

A.A. publishing vigorous despite rising costs

Directors' report: Our net publishing income was \$669,286 in 1981. As a matter of perspective: This income achieved its highest level in 1979 at \$849,742; the decline is partly caused by the 6% bulk discount effective February 1, 1980. Our budget for the net publishing income in 1982 is \$662,300, with increased cost roughly offsetting increased sales.

The net overall income of G.S.O., excluding major nonrecurring expense items, was \$284,034 in 1981 and is budgeted to decline to \$173,200 in 1982. This is the publishing net income less the amount necessary to make up a deficit in group contributions' coverage of group services. Overall G.S.O. income also reached its peak in 1979, at \$585,504. An encouraging result in 1981 was the increase in group contributions, to \$1,564,600.

We authorized the transfer of funds to the General Service Board to cover operating deficits (\$703,504) for 1980. There

was no other surplus, and no money was transferred to the Reserve Fund.

We also took the following actions:

- Approved changes in salary levels that pertain to job classifications in G.S.O., established by reference to Hays Company standards, as updated to mid-1982. So our salary structure is fully competitive in the New York market for jobs that have analogues in that market.
- Approved an additional 5% discount on sales of books, in amounts of 2,000 or more, to non-A.A. purchasers. Two retailers order in such quantities, relieving us of distribution and mailing costs for small orders.
- Approved prices for new publications, gratis distribution for some, and a new design for *Box 4-5-9*.
- Withheld permission for G.S.O. Holland to publish a Big Book translation that took liberties with the text to conform to local usage. As a result of correspondence between our general manager and G.S.O. Holland, a new committee was formed there to create a faithful translation.
- Reviewed the pricing of Spanish literature, with the criterion that each piece be priced at the higher of these two: cost of producing the Spanish item; price of the English equivalent. Found 19 pamphlets to satisfy this criterion. Reduced five others an average of 25% to equal the price of the English equivalent and still remain above cost.
- Granted 67 requests to reprint and six to tape/videotape our literature; denied three to reprint and one to tape.

Services to the 1,000 French-speaking A.A. groups are discussed annually by G.S.O. representatives with the four Quebec delegates, the Eastern Canada trustee, the Canadian trustee-at-large, and French Literature Committee representatives. This year in Quebec City, it was agreed that A.A.W.S. should assume the cost of translating and producing service materials for French-speaking groups in Canada.

Because of difficulties with our publishing operation in Central America, we are exploring the possibility of turning it over to the Central American Literature Committee.

Bob Pearson attended the First European Service Meeting, in Frankfurt, West Germany, in October 1981. The 1978 World Service Meeting recommended such gatherings for the years between W.S.M.'s. Similarly, Phyllis Masback represented G.S.O. at the Second Ibero-American Service Meeting, in Buenos Aires, Argentina, in August 1981.

Although we encountered delays in the renovation project at G.S.O. and the Grapevine, the job now needs only finishing touches. Because of this project, the annual open house was canceled for 1981.

John Bragg, chairperson

During the Reports on Area Service Highlights on Tuesday morning, Doug Riley (Northwestern Texas) was introduced as a "real cowboy." "I call myself a bull-shipper," he remarked as he began his talk.

Archives

Newsletter becomes a worldwide best-seller

Trustees' committee: Activities centered on developing ways to present information in the archives to our Fellowship, as well as broadening our responsibility as A.A.'s principal repository for historical materials. Important progress was recorded in both areas.

The remarkable proliferation of archival centers within the A.A. world has made our recently fashioned newsletter, *Markings: Your Archives Interchange*, a runaway best-seller; we now mail over 700 copies per issue. The publication consists of archival center news, historical facts, and tips on preserving items. Three issues a year are planned.

During the past year, many photographs of our co-founders were added to our collection. Lois Wilson was the chief donor. Office visitors enjoy seeing pictures that capture the many moods of Bill and Dr. Bob.

Efforts to preserve historically significant press clippings continue; 15 scrapbooks have been completed and microfilmed. They cover newspaper stories on A.A. printed from 1939 through 1960.

On a saddening note: The following report will be Nell Wing's last to a Conference as our archivist. After 35 faithful years of service to G.S.O., Nell has decided to retire at the end of this year. I know all Conference members join me in thanking Nell for sharing her life with us in service to our Fellowship, and in wishing her a long, joy-filled retirement. Frank Mauser will assume the duties of archivist.

Our new quarters for the Archives Department have recently been completed and stand ready to greet the many members who visit.

Fernand Ippersiel, chairperson

Staff report: After many months of keeping the archival flame alive in temporary quarters, we are busy establishing our new, permanent home on the fifth floor. All four of our new rooms will display newly reframed photographs and artifacts on the walls.

We are exploring the feasibility of producing one scrapbook carrying out the "best of the scrapbooks" idea, with the possibility of making reproductions available to local archival centers.

Much time this past year has been given to assisting the author of the new Bill W. biography: providing biographical information and photographs, locating new material, and making reference sources available, as well as reviewing the first two drafts of the manuscript.

The contest to choose a name for our newsletter, *Markings: Your Archives Interchange*, has been fun for all of us; we received 96 suggestions, which the Archives Committee narrowed down to two. Since we couldn't decide between them, both were chosen! The winners were Herb M. for "Markings" and Tom P. (New Zealand archives) for "Archives Interchange."

We are saddened by the loss of two of our enthusiastic Archives Committee members this past year: LaVelle Clifford and Bud Grondahl. We miss them very much and feel grateful for their contributions to our committee and to each of us personally.

Nell Wing, archivist

Conference

Suggestions focus on first-year delegates

Trustees' committee: The committee reviewed suggested 1982 Conference themes and recommended to the Conference Agenda Committee "The Traditions—Our Way of Unity."

The evaluations of the results of the post-Conference sharing session and the Conference questionnaire were reviewed by the committee:

- Many Conference members indicated a desire for more small meetings of one type or another and thought that an explanation could be given to new Conference members as to what they'll experience during the week.
- Some expressed an interest in receiving all Conference committee agendas and background material. The trustees' committee felt that this action would in some ways undermine the committee system. They did think, however, that we should continue to supply background material on agenda items of interest to all Conference members.
- Some new delegates didn't seem to realize that a committee recommendation approved by the Conference body becomes a Conference Action. This might be clarified through the regional trustees' sharing session on Sunday afternoon.

The committee received a letter from the manager of G.S.O. in Great Britain letting us know that the English-Speaking Intergroup of Continental Europe had been included in their Conference. The English-Speaking Intergroup had requested acceptance by *our* Conference last year, but the request was tabled until Great Britain made its decision.

Topics submitted for Conference consideration were reviewed, discussed, and referred to the appropriate Conference committee, presentation/discussion, workshop, or Ask-It Basket session. A list of Conference members to participate in the various sessions was reviewed and accepted.

Dick Driscoll, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator serves as the focal point for all Conference members and all those serving on area general service committees. We now have on our mailing list: 789 past delegates, 96 area committee chairpersons, 89 area secretaries, 78 area treasurers, 12 area secretary/treasurers, and 2,401 D.C.M.'s. Most area assemblies and committee meetings send us minutes, which are circulated among the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs. This communication is very helpful, as it is an excellent way to stay in touch with A.A. activities in the U.S. and Canada.

All A.A.'s are encouraged to send in suggestions for the Con-

ference agenda. The suggestions are passed on to the trustees' Conference Committee and the Conference Agenda Committee for approval, then shared with everyone via the *Quarterly Report*, Box 4-5-9, and the preliminary Conference agenda mailed to the delegates in January.

The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- 1 Collecting items for the Conference theme and agenda.
- 2 Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Conference Committee.
- 3 Handling monthly letters and advance correspondence with all delegates in preparation for the Conference.
- 4 Working with the general manager, the office manager, and the staff in planning and coordination of the Conference.
- 5 Scheduling and routing all reports and other material for Conference Manuals, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, and the *Final Conference Report*.
- 6 Reviewing minutes, reports, and all communications received from area committees and D.C.M.'s.
- 7 Coordinating the annual G.S.R. Day at G.S.O.

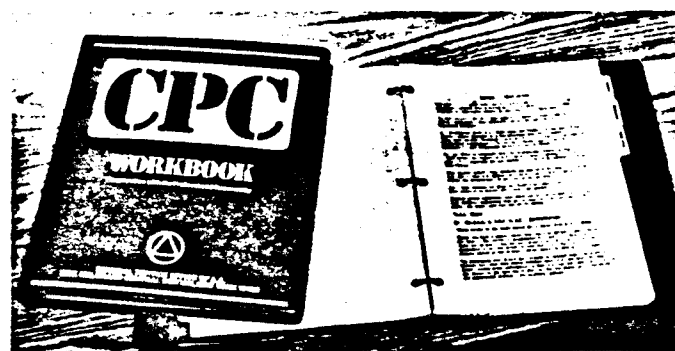
Betty Liddle

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Workbook and new medical pamphlet completed

Trustees' committee: There continues to be increasing interest among professionals in receiving A.A. literature and presentations about A.A. We have been given great support by local and national officials. Members of our committee associated with A.A. for many years are convinced that acceptance of A.A. by the professional community has never been greater and that improvement in recent years has been truly dramatic. The committee therefore recommended the purchase of two additional Professional Exhibits, shown at professional conventions around the country.

The Workbook for C.P.C. Committees was completed and sent to all committee chairpersons and delegates. We recommended its translation into French and Spanish as soon as possible.



The committee has worked all year on a pamphlet to replace "Alcoholics Anonymous and the Medical Profession," and recommends that the final draft on the subject of "A.A. as a resource for the medical profession" be presented to the Conference C.P.C. Committee for consideration. The new emphasis is less on information about A.A. than on techniques some professionals used to get their patients involved in A.A.

The committee is reviewing *About A.A.* and the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*, to make the former more responsive to the needs of professionals and to include in the latter more material helpful to A.A.'s who carry the message to the professional community.

William Flynn, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: To carry A.A.'s message to professional groups and individuals who have contact with alcoholics, staff or members of the trustees' C.P.C. Committee have attended or participated in:

- Meetings of Advisory Council on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism, Rockville, Md.
- 1981 Annual Forum of National Council on Alcoholism, New Orleans, La.
- Spring Conference on Alcoholism, Greensboro, N.C.
- Summer School of Alcohol Studies, Rutgers University
- University of Utah School on Alcohol and Other Drug Dependencies
- Southeastern Conference on Alcohol and Drug Abuse, Atlanta, Ga.
- Eastern Regional Conference Alcohol and Drug Problems Association, Washington, D.C.
- First New England Conference on Alcoholism and Deafness
- Seminar on Alcoholism and the Black Community
- Third Annual Conference of the National Black Alcoholism Council

Third-year students from Cornell University School of Medicine are continuing to visit G.S.O. every few months.

Our Professional Exhibit was shown at 24 meetings of national organizations in 1981, resulting in over 2,000 requests for additional information.

As recommended by the 1981 Conference, the pamphlet "A.A. in Your Community" was reinstated, and the pamphlet "A.A. and Occupational Alcoholism Programs" was published.

We estimate there are over 100 C.P.C. committees on the area, district, and intergroup levels; this form of Twelfth Step work seems to be taking off.

Helen Turnquest

Correctional Facilities

Wider participation needed to help inmates

Trustees' committee: Guidelines developed for outside correspondents on the Institutions Correspondence Service were mailed to all A.A.'s on the list (over 350), and they will be printed in a future *Institutions Bulletin* and shared with institutions committees.

An article published in *Box 4-5-9* requested more volunteers for the Institutions Correspondence Service; so far, over 100 A.A.'s have responded.

We discussed concern regarding inmates' corresponding with outside A.A.'s from other states. The chairperson felt that it would be more helpful if inmates developed strong ties with A.A.'s within their own states. The committee encouraged handling this on an individual basis, matching correspondents within a state whenever possible.

We discussed the progress report of the *Institutions Bulletin*—whether it should be divided into two bulletins: Correctional Facilities and Treatment Facilities. It was agreed that the *Institutions Bulletin* should remain intact at this time.

We reviewed the Institutions Discount Package sheet and suggested that several new items be added to the prison discount package.

We recommended to the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities that we add the statement "A.A. does not provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, or court officials" to the pamphlets "Memo to an Inmate" (page 36) and "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" (page 24 or 25).

We discussed ways of reaching institutions where no A.A. groups exist. The subject was referred to the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for discussion. Ways of reaching female alcoholic inmates were also discussed. We may write women's prisons in the U.S. and Canada to inform them about A.A. and our Institutions Correspondence Service.

Jim Estelle, chairperson

Staff report: There are 1,138 A.A. groups in correctional facilities in the U.S. and Canada, and 150 institutions committees serve them.

We list correctional facilities groups in G.S.O. records and send each a Group Handbook, the Big Book, and other complimentary literature. They also get our *Directory of A.A. Groups in Correctional Facilities*, *Box 4-5-9* bimonthly, and the *Institutions Bulletin* three times yearly.

Discount packages of A.A. literature (English and Spanish) are available to "inside" groups and to institutions committees. The Grapevine gives us back issues, which we pass along to these groups. Guidelines are available for A.A.'s interested in institutions work. A.A. films and filmstrips are lent without charge to correctional facilities groups.

The staff member on this assignment answers all correspondence from inmates and institutions committees. She writes about 500 letters a month. When an inmate is about to be released, information is sent to the nearest institutions commit-

tee or intergroup office, so the inmate will be met on that crucial first day out.

Our mail from local institutions committees, inside groups, and A.A.'s indicates a need for more literature, more Grapevines, more A.A. sponsors, more "outside" speakers, and more outside A.A.'s to participate in the Institutions Correspondence Service. We've reached only a small percentage of the prison population.

Services from G.S.O. only open the door to A.A. recovery. Real recovery for the confined alcoholic depends on local committees and sponsors who reach out the hand of A.A. in love and service.

Susan Daly

Finance

This year, the report of the trustees' Finance Committee was given in the form of a presentation. See page 13.

General Sharing Session

Advice on prescribed medication a major issue

Trustees' report: In July, our discussion topic was "A.A. Has No Opinion on Outside Issues, e.g., Giving Advice on Prescribed Medication." Many stories were related regarding A.A.'s who went off prescribed medications as a result of pressure from other A.A.'s and suffered grave and sometimes fatal consequences. It was agreed that we are not doctors nor should we tell anyone to stop taking prescribed medication. It was suggested that we share with our doctors, as well as our fellow A.A.'s, our personal experiences with drugs.

Although our literature, in some places, suggests that A.A. has no opinion on this subject, there are other places where opinions *are* expressed. It was suggested that our literature might be reviewed from this standpoint.

The subject is one of almost universal A.A. concern and also one on which it is extremely difficult to formulate any conclusive guidelines or policy.

In October, the topic was "How Can We Make A.A. Meetings More Attractive to Newcomers?" It was selected because many members have noted the continuing revolving-door phenomenon and recent P.I. surveys also indicate a high drop-out rate during the first few months in A.A.

Years ago, when groups were smaller and there were fewer newcomers, a newcomer was likely to be enveloped with personal attention. Although this is still true in many groups, the new person frequently goes unnoticed today. The ensuing discussion brought forth many practical suggestions on ways groups can carry the message more effectively. Here are a few:

- **All meetings**—A format in which a group breaks into smaller components, at least for part of the meeting, offers greater

opportunity for recognition of and sharing by the newcomer.

- **Beginners meetings**—A round-robin format gives newcomers a chance to briefly ventilate their fears, what's going on with them today, or what they don't understand about the Fellowship. Beginners meetings should stick to the basics of what we did to get sober when we were new and should be extremely careful to avoid becoming general therapy sessions.

- **Large meetings**—Those who are new might be asked to identify themselves, making it clear that the intention is not to embarrass them, but to ensure that members can get to know them after the meeting. Also, place greeters at the door and at the literature table.

In January, our focus was on the Fifth Tradition: "Each group has but one primary purpose—to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." Concern was expressed about the trend of discussions in meetings, i.e., too much focus on current life problems of A.A.'s with considerable sobriety and too much group therapy. It was felt that there should be more emphasis on "what happened"—how we got sober and how we use the Twelve Steps to stay sober. There was concern that the basic message becomes lost. Perhaps some A.A.'s expect too much out of meetings and should be looking for more help with their day-to-day problems through one-to-one sharing and working with sponsors.

Concern was also expressed regarding meetings in which alcoholics are unwelcome or not made to feel comfortable because they are different. Special-interest groups are formed because perhaps the message can be better carried in a group where A.A.'s can more easily identify and feel safe—particularly when new. Perhaps we should be less concerned whether special groups observe the Fifth Tradition and give more consideration to whether all A.A. groups truly observe the spirit of the Third, so that all alcoholics feel accepted and comfortable.

Although there are areas of concern, most A.A. groups are very aware of their primary purpose. The matters discussed and the language used to discuss them may not be terribly important if the spirit of this basic message pervades the meeting.

George Dorsey, chairperson

Delegate Bill Downey remarked that if Florida delegates can claim the Bahamas and North Carolina can claim Bermuda, then he wants the right to list Nantucket and Martha's Vineyard along with his Eastern Massachusetts Area.

Group correspondence

Volume of letters to G.S.O. calls for teamwork

Staff report: Because of the heavy work load of some of our service assignments, the position of regional correspondent has been developed during the past year. At the present time, the regional correspondent replies to letters on general group problems and concerns from two of our larger regions: Southeast and Southwest U.S.

Some of the general group problems during the past year have been: what to do about profanity at A.A. meetings; reading

from non-A.A. literature at group meetings; dually addicted members who share little, if any, of their alcohol experience at A.A. meetings; attendance by non-A.A.'s at closed meetings; and nonsmoking A.A. meetings.

The regional correspondent works closely with staff members in the unit composed of the Loners/Internationalists, Regional Forums/Box 4-5-9, and overseas assignments and also assists those who are involved in special projects.

June Russell

Group services coordinator

New aid now provided for the hearing-impaired

Staff report: The group services coordinator provides communication services to the Fellowship as a whole, supervising production of all service material, updating Guidelines and listings, Group Handbooks, literature displays, G.S.R. Kits, and other material, and working closely with the staff coordinator and other staff members on the literature and Conference assignments.

There are three New Group Handbooks: (1) New Group Handbook; (2) New Correctional Facilities Group Handbook; (3) New Treatment Facilities Group Handbook.

New groups in the U.S. and Canada receive a handbook, a G.S.R. Kit, a complimentary supply of literature, Box 4-5-9, and the appropriate regional directory.

It is our intention to provide identical services to all A.A. groups within our structure. We list more than 1,000 French-speaking and 300 Spanish-speaking groups, and our handbook and Box 4-5-9 are available in those languages. The G.S.R. Kit is available in French, and we plan to develop a similar kit in Spanish, pending the Spanish translation of "The A.A. Service Manual."

There are now 12 Guidelines. As the need arises, they are updated to keep up with current trends. Service material is available on request and includes the following lists: A.A.'s interested in exchanging tapes or correspondence; Loners; Internationalists; armed services groups; overseas G.S.O.'s; central offices in the U.S. and Canada; books and pamphlets in languages other than English. We also have suggestions for discussion-meeting topics, for conducting workshops and sharing sessions, and for carrying the message to hearing-impaired alcoholics. "A Brief Guide to A.A." has been "translated" into language easier for the hearing-impaired.

Three 16mm films are available: "Bill's Own Story," "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," and "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View." The first two are restricted to regular A.A. and Al-Anon groups (1974 Conference Action); the third is available outside A.A. as well. The films rent for \$35 per week and are distributed free to A.A. groups in institutions.

Three filmstrips are available: "P.O. Box 459" and "Circles of Love and Service" may be purchased at \$6.50 each for group meetings, assemblies, and conventions; "Markings on the Journey" is available in English and Spanish for \$8.50 and may be viewed within A.A.

The TDD is a device for transcribing teletyped messages from an ordinary phone call. We are arranging for the purchase of a TDD in order to communicate with hearing-impaired alcoholics.

Beth Kuhlmann



Soon after the Conference, the TDD (or TTY) was installed at G.S.O. in the Steno area, where Lynda Ernst works. The phone is placed in a cradle next to the machine, which types the message.

International

More service structures extend A.A.'s reach

Trustees' committee: This committee explores ways in which the General Service Board and/or G.S.O. may assist in the growth of A.A. worldwide, with particular attention to countries where there is no A.A. service structure. Two of our members are trustees currently serving as delegates to the Seventh World Service Meeting.

In 1981, we recommended that G.S.O. expand its use of translation services to be of maximum help to alcoholics who write from overseas. We are analyzing the findings of A.A. membership surveys from six countries: Belgium, New Zealand, England, Finland, France, and Brazil. Progress reports were heard from the G.S.O. Seventh World Service Meeting Planning Committee.

Because of the current political situation in Saudi Arabia, we recognized that we can do little "officially" to help A.A. groups there inform the general public about their meetings.

During the past year, reports were heard on the Second Ibero-American Service Meeting, in Buenos Aires, Argentina, and on the First European Service Meeting, in Frankfurt, West Germany.

The committee recommended that when our *International A.A. Directory* is updated, we list the English-Speaking Inter-group of Continental Europe in the section entitled "Special International Groups."

Stan Cameron, chairperson

International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums

Plans for 1985 emerge; Forums on fourth round

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—At the July board weekend, the committee heard the report of the International Convention Ad Hoc Committee's site-inspection trip to Montreal. The hotel and meeting facilities proved adequate for our needs. Our Big Meetings will be held at the Olympic Stadium. Since it can seat from 60,000 to 80,000, a backdrop may be used to divide it for our purposes. Acoustics and visibility are good. Two giant TV screens could be used to show the stage during the general sessions. Office space is available for registration on Friday night.

The Palais des Congrès (Convention Center) will be completed this year. The seating capacities of its meeting rooms run from 80 to 3,000. A large kitchen can produce meals for 5,000 at a time, and a lovely terrace can serve as a dining room. The Convention Center is located in the heart of Montreal's restaurant district. Within two miles of the center, there are 11,500 hotel rooms, and their complimentary policy is one room per 50 used.

The rubber-wheeled Metro (subway) trains are clean, fast, and efficient, with stops at major hotels, the Olympic Stadium, and the Convention Center. The Metro can carry up to 45,000 passengers an hour.

The committee recommended to the board that Montreal be approved as the site of the 1985 International Convention and appointed Denis Longtin (Panel 30 delegate from Southwestern Quebec) to serve as our Host Committee chairperson.



Crowds totaling about 1,000 (far above the Forum average) could hear A.A. talk in English or French from the translation booth at the Eastern Canada Regional Forum. When the sessions ended, only one headset turned up missing!

Regional Forums—Following the 1981 Conference, four regions have hosted Forums: Northeast (Danvers, Mass.); East Central (Akron, Ohio); Southwest (Kansas City, Mo.); Eastern Canada (Montreal, Que.). A mini-forum took place in Billings, Mont. Average attendance was 250 to 300.

Some topics most often discussed during the Ask-It Basket sessions, workshops, and general sharing sessions were: dual-

ly addicted members, special groups (with discussions on the six-point definition of an A.A. group), the A.A. group and self-support, anonymity, and how to carry the service message. Presentations and discussions have included topics such as "What About Finance?," "What Is Appropriate for Discussion at an A.A. Meeting?," and most recently (in Montreal), "Are A.A. Groups Responsible for Expenses of Their Service Workers?"

The Box 4-5-9 calendar keeps the Fellowship informed of Regional Forums. The following is a schedule of future Forums:

1982

June 11-13	Pacific	Las Vegas, Nev.
September 24-26	Western Canada	Winnipeg, Man.
December 3-5	Southeast	Nashville, Tenn.

1983

March	West Central	(tentative)
May	Northeast	(tentative)
September	East Central	Indiana
December	Southwest	(tentative)

Kenneth H. Williams, M.D., chairperson

Staff report:

Regional Forums—Forums are held on the invitation of the region, and the fourth round recently began in Montreal, Que. Regional trustees and delegates from areas in the region decide on the location and help plan the Forum. Board personnel who have attended include: trustees, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors. Hotel, meal, and travel expenses of all personnel in attendance are paid by the board, and expenses for the region's service people are the responsibility of either the individuals or area committees.

The Regional Forum coordinator plans Forums with the regional trustee and delegates and the general manager of G.S.O.; makes arrangements with the host-city contact (the local liaison), hotel, and host city; arranges travel and hotels for board personnel; handles mailings to the region's delegates (asking for agenda suggestions), G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, area committee officers, past/present delegates, past/present trustees, and central offices; and is responsible for display boards of sample literature and service material. Reports on Regional Forums are sent to all Forum participants, all trustees, and all current delegates.

Any member wishing to attend may request a registration/reservation form.

Lyla Bonney

Internationalists, Loners, LIMs

Growth continues; use of tapes increases

Staff report: The number of seagoing A.A.'s known as Internationalists continues to grow. There are more than 500 Internationalists and Port Contacts, with 38 Internationalists groups meeting aboard ships or in ports.

Loners also have continued to increase. The latest count indicated about 500 Loners in 98 countries. As the name Loner implies,

they are members unable to attend meetings because there are no A.A. groups nearby. Until a group is started, Loners stay sober reading A.A. literature and sharing via correspondence. Use of tapes among Loners is increasing.

LIMs are members who are housebound or physically handicapped. We have more than 50 corresponding with other LIMs, Loners, and Loner Sponsors.

Each new Internationalist, Loner, or LIM receives a package of A.A. literature, lists of Internationalists, Loners, and LIMs, the alternating bimonthly bulletins *Loners-Internationalists Meeting* and *Box 4-5-9*, and the appropriate A.A. directory.

A large number of A.A.'s serve as Loner Sponsors, sharing their experience, strength, hope, and group activities with Loners, LIMs, and Internationalists.

Loners in distant lands and Internationalists traveling the seven seas have contributed greatly to A.A.'s growth all over the globe.

Lois Fisher

Literature

Tape of "Twelve and Twelve" completed

Trustees' committee: Some of the measures taken since the 1981 Conference are as follows.

We approved publication of a "translation" of the pamphlet "A Brief Guide to A.A." for hearing-impaired alcoholics. This version was prepared with the help of the National Association for the Deaf.

The production of a tape cassette of the book "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" was approved for sale and distribution by A.A.W.S., Inc.

We reviewed the manuscript of Bill W.'s biography and recommended that it be reviewed again at the committee's meeting in July, after further editing.

At the recommendation of the 1981 Conference, a subcommittee was formed to review our literature and report whether any should be discontinued or consolidated. The subcommittee is proceeding with its review.

G.S.O. continues to receive many requests for the film "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View." Nearly 300 prints have been leased in many parts of the world, including England, Finland, South Africa, Australia, and Iceland.

The present committee decided not to support a recommendation of the 1977 committee to publish a history of the first 50 years of A.A. for distribution at the 1985 International Convention. It was thought that a shorter publication would be more appropriate, simply commemorating A.A.'s first 50 years.

A suggestion that a videotape be made of a series of A.A. meetings for presentation on cable television was considered. After expressing concern over protection of anonymity, it was

decided to refer the suggestion to the P.I. Committee.

The committee considered whether a filmstrip should be produced on the functions of central and intergroup offices and decided to refer the question to the Conference Literature Committee.

Michael Alexander, chairperson



The recorded version of the "Twelve and Twelve" comes in a plastic box designed like the familiar cover of the book—with one useful difference: The title is repeated in Braille below the printed letters.

Staff report: This assignment involves preparation, production, editorial supervision, and distribution of publications and audiovisual materials, in coordination with other staff members. The literature coordinator also works with the group services coordinator on all service material.

We distribute *Box 4-5-9* in English and Spanish and five other periodical bulletins with a combined circulation of 84,780, as follows:

	Mailing list	Issues per year
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (English)	44,111	6
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (French) ¹	2,555	6
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (Spanish)	11,852	6
<i>Loners-Internationalists Meeting</i>	2,614	6
<i>Institutions Bulletin</i>	5,630	3
<i>Quarterly Report</i>	4,397	3 ²
<i>About A.A.</i>	10,079	3
Total	84,780	36

The literature coordinator works closely with editors on updating and revising old pamphlets and with writers, artists, editors, and printers in the preparation of new pamphlets, displays, leaflets, and other service materials, including audiovisual.

There is frequent correspondence with A.A. groups and individuals requesting specific information about A.A. literature. A letter is sent semiannually to all central offices, intergroups, and literature distribution centers to keep them informed of new developments in A.A. literature, periodicals, other publications, and audiovisual materials.

Curtis Monahan

1 Translated and printed by the French Literature Service in Montreal, Que., in cooperation with this office.

2 The *Final Conference Report* takes the place of the fourth issue.

Bill Dick (Idaho), alias "Sweet William," had a memorable visit to G.S.O. He was accused of lifting a Big Book from the pile of defectives in the Shipping Department. Bill says he has found a new meaning in the Serenity Prayer. . . . Also during the visit to G.S.O., Diana Salnave (Oregon) experienced a moment of panic when the elevator doors closed but the elevator didn't move. She and a group of other delegates felt "trapped in space." "We came to visit, not to stay," she thought.

Nominating

Loss of two trustees brings on decisions

Trustees' committee: The committee discussed and reaffirmed the present method used at G.S.O. to determine the majority figures on voting sheets at each election.

We discussed the staggered expiration dates for terms of office of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors. To make the expiration dates uniform on the two boards, we recommended that the one Grapevine director now serving whose term ends in August 1983 and the one A.A.W.S. director now serving whose term ends in August 1985 be rotated in April of 1983 and 1985, respectively.

We accepted and approved the recommendation of the caucus of regional trustees and trustees-at-large that Joe Kraus serve as A.A.W.S. director, filling LaVelle Clifford's unexpired term of office on that board and serving an additional two-year term to expire in April 1984.

After the death of LaVelle Clifford, the committee discussed filling the vacancy of Southwest regional trustee and recommended to the General Service Board that it would not be feasible or fair to the region or the person selected to fill the vacancy for one year. The recommendation was based on the following: (1) a relevant paragraph in the Bylaws of the General Service Board (page 92 in "The A.A. Service Manual"); (2) a recommendation of the Nominating Committee in 1974, also related to the situation.

The committee reviewed and approved as eligible for election all candidates for regional trustees of the Pacific and Eastern Canada Regions with the following exception and comments: The résumé received from Utah was on a discontinued résumé form, and it was agreed that the delegate from Utah be invited to submit information about the Utah candidate following the same résumé format as other areas.

Résumés of candidates for regional trustee of the West Central Region were sent to the committee to meet the February 15, 1982, deadline established for that region because of the death in December of M. T. (Bud) Grondahl, West Central regional trustee.

Résumés of candidates for Class A trustees were reviewed. The committee decided to proceed cautiously, allowing time to gather names of additional candidates, to obtain more information about candidates already suggested, and to discuss inviting candidates under serious consideration to attend a board weekend.

The committee unanimously recommended that Gordon

Patrick be elected to serve as chairperson of the General Service Board following Milton Maxwell's retirement at the end of the 1982 General Service Conference.

We reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April, following presentation to the 1982 Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Michael Alexander
W. J. (Jim) Estelle
William E. Flynn, M.D.

Gordon M. Patrick
Frank Smeal
Kenneth H. Williams, M.D.

Class B

David H. Aronofsky
John Bragg
O. S. (Buck) Bruner
Stan N. Cameron
Donald F. Daly

Richard J. Driscoll
Albert J. Hergott
Joe F. Kraus
John Ryall
Jacquelyn Solomon

One regional trustee—Eastern Canada

One regional trustee—Pacific U.S.

One regional trustee—West Central U.S.

The committee approved the following slate of officers of the board:

Chairperson
First vice-chairperson
Second vice-chairperson
Secretary
Treasurer
Assistant treasurer
Assistant secretary

Gordon Patrick
Michael Alexander
W. J. (Jim) Estelle
Richard Driscoll
Frank Smeal
Dennis Manders
Sarah Price

We recommended that this slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., be presented to the 1982 Conference:

Michael Alexander
John Bragg
Richard J. Driscoll
Joe F. Kraus
Louis Kraus

Robert G. Pearson
Sarah Price
Jacquelyn Solomon
Virginia Turner

We recommended to the Conference as Grapevine directors:

O. S. (Buck) Bruner
Stan N. Cameron
Donald F. Daly
William E. Flynn, M.D.
Retha Gresham

Tom Neary
Mary Phelps
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
John Ryall
Jim Shannon

Following much discussion and after conferring with delegates from Canada on the method of electing the trustee-at-large/Canada, the committee agreed that since there is no clear consensus on an alternate procedure or on the need for a change at this time, the method remain as recommended in "The A.A. Service Manual."

The matter of alternate trustees was discussed, and the committee concluded that it is not in favor of alternate trustees.

The committee unanimously recommended that Milton Maxwell be invited to serve the General Service Board as a chairperson emeritus.

George Dorsey, chairperson

Overseas, World Service Meeting

A W.S.M. year—with another country added

Staff report:

Overseas—The staff member on this assignment corresponds with 27 G.S.O.'s and literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada, in Argentina, Australia, Belgium (French-speaking), Belgium (Flemish-speaking), Brazil, Colombia, Costa Rica, El Salvador, Great Britain, Finland, France, Guatemala, Honduras, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Norway, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, and West Germany. (We have heard from A.A.'s in Venezuela that a G.S.O. is being organized there.)

When letters are received from groups and individuals in those countries, they are encouraged to correspond with their own G.S.O.'s. If an overseas G.S.O. then needs a more detailed sharing of experience, it contacts G.S.O. U.S./Canada.

For countries having their own G.S.O.'s, we list only English-speaking groups and contacts, intergroups/central offices, and Loners. Travelers are encouraged to contact those offices for up-to-date meeting information. G.S.O. U.S./Canada is grateful for up-to-date information about A.A. in other countries, and asks all traveling A.A.'s to share with us their experience with A.A. in foreign lands.

Correspondence from countries where there is no such center or office is answered by the staff member on this assignment. We work closely with such countries to help them establish A.A. structures. Guidelines for the purpose are available from G.S.O.

Correspondence that comes to us in a foreign language is translated, and a response is sent in the same language.

To protect A.A.'s copyright, careful consideration is given to granting overseas boards and centers permission to print A.A. Conference-approved literature. A request should come from the board, and before any printing begins, G.S.O. first explores the way the material will be financed and distributed. The request for permission to print or reprint is then presented to A.A.W.S.

Here are some brief recent highlights about A.A. overseas:

- In the two years since the first printing of the Big Book in Japanese, almost all 2,000 volumes have been sold; a second printing is planned, under the same financial arrangement with A.A.W.S. as the first.
- The First Fellowship Business Conference of A.A. in West Germany took place in 1981.
- The Big Book has been translated into Thai.
- A G.S.O. staff member attended the Second Ibero-American Meeting, in Buenos Aires, Argentina, in August 1981.
- Our general manager attended the First European Service Meeting, in Frankfurt, West Germany, in October 1981.

World Service Meeting—The W.S.M. meets biennially at

locations alternating between the U.S. and overseas. The seventh will be held October 14-18, 1982, in San Juan del Rio, Mexico.

Each delegate serves four years, attending two Meetings. Delegates should be legal residents and preferably citizens of the countries they serve. It is recommended that a country be represented either by two A.A.'s or by one A.A. and one non-A.A., with one delegate being a member of the country's general service board or national service committee, the other a salaried or volunteer staff member. Delegates need a working knowledge of English to fully participate in the Meeting. This year, as a result of a Sixth W.S.M. recommendation, simultaneous translation in Spanish and English will be provided for general sessions.

When a country develops a national structure, it is qualified to send delegates. Italy, the most recent to form such a structure, will be represented in 1982.

A final report on the Seventh W.S.M. will be available.

Phyllis Masback

On her way home Tuesday evening, Betty Liddle (Conference coordinator) was carrying a suitcase when she boarded an elevator, where a delegate remarked, "Are you leaving us? I guess we'll just have to put a clone of you up on the podium." A Grapevine staff member topped him with "Yes—send in the clones."

Public Information

New approaches taken toward minority groups

Trustees' committee: The following projects have been completed.

- A press release on results of the 1980 membership survey was mailed to major newspapers and TV/radio news directors in July.
- The annual anonymity memo to the press and the biennial anonymity memo to treatment centers were released in December.
- A feature story about the Big Book, announcing distribution in excess of 3,000,000, was sent to book-review editors of major newspapers and periodicals.
- Copies of the foregoing were also sent to local P.I. committees.
- All 1,400 radio stations requesting the public service announcements that became available in April 1981 received them by November.
- Results of a report on reaching minority groups were published in the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*. In response to suggestions by local P.I. committees, we discussed ways to carry the message to alcoholics possibly neglected in the past. The word "minority" is used only in regard to groups of alcoholics conspicuous by their absence from A.A., depending on the community. In some areas, for example, they might be young

people or senior citizens; in other communities, blacks, Hispanics, native Americans, or women. Our feature story "A.A. Arrests Alcoholism Early" was sent to 300 newspapers and periodicals with a primarily black readership, and about 100 have requested additional information. A feature story about A.A. help for older alcoholics, completed in February 1982, was submitted to the publication of the American Association of Retired Persons.

- The "A.A. Member" pamphlet and tabletop display were updated to reflect the 1980 survey results, and a poster of the same title was produced, as recommended by the 1981 Conference P.I. Committee. A new edition of "Understanding Anonymity" became available in September. "A Message to Teenagers" in Spanish became available in September.
- Both the P.I. Guidelines and the P.I. Workbook now include sharing regarding attraction vs. promotion, as recommended by the 1981 Conference. The updated workbook also includes sample letters for use by local committees in reaching juvenile centers, senior citizen residences, and community health workers.

The following projects are now in progress.

- We are developing a feature story about A.A. help for young people, and all our feature stories are being translated into Spanish for the Hispanic press.
- Two TV public service announcements produced and approved in 1980 have not been released yet. We feel there is value in releasing both of these spots in 1982, as originally recommended. A suggested method of distribution was reviewed, subject to the approval of the 1982 Conference.
- We are exploring the possibility of arranging a network interview with a Class A trustee, who might discuss A.A. and Big Book distribution.

The following projects are planned for the future.

- A press release will be issued announcing the new chairperson of the General Service Board, following the 1982 Conference.
- We will discuss a possible press release on the Seventh World Service Meeting, to be held in October.

Jacquelyn Solomon, chairperson

Staff report: In 1981, we answered more than 10,000 requests for information about A.A., an average of 50 each workday. It takes three persons, including the staff member, to cover P.I. activities at G.S.O.

We processed about 500 press clippings each month. Some of the many fine articles that treat A.A. with clarity and understanding are the results of reporters' calls to G.S.O.; others, of work by local P.I. committees. Each month, we sent an average of 40 gratitude letters to publications that ran good coverage of A.A. We followed up on approximately ten anonymity breaks monthly. Over the year, we distributed 350 TV public service announcements and 1,970 radio spots, and we understand that they are in wide use. More than 200 "A.A. Member" displays were sent with labels and pamphlets for use at health fairs and local, county, and state meetings.

G.S.O. lists 540 local P.I. committees and 312 P.I. contacts. New committee chairpersons receive the P.I. Workbook free; additional copies cost \$7 each. A selection of complimentary P.I. literature and service material is sent to new P.I. committee members. A.A.'s who let us know they are interested in P.I. work receive the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*. Special discount packages of A.A. literature, priced at the cost to A.A.W.S., are offered to local P.I. committees. The contents were determined by a poll of local committees to find the titles most used. Two popular flyers, available in quantity free of charge, are "A.A. at a Glance" (410,400 distributed in 1981) and "A Message to Teenagers" (535,100).

The importance of public information work remains as critical today as years ago when Bill W. remarked that "a single large public blunder could cost many lives and much suffering, because it would turn new prospects away. Conversely, every real public relations success brings alcoholics in our direction."

Vincina McCarthy

Staff coordinator

G.S.O. tours benefit both visitors and staff

Staff report: There are 11 A.A.'s who are G.S.O. staff members. Each has a specific assignment. Some assignments are combined; some involve responsibility for the preparation of special service bulletins. Work is apportioned as follows:

Conference	Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; Early Bird Box 4-5-9; <i>Final Conference Report</i>
Cooperation with the professional community	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community; <i>About A.A.</i> ; <i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>
Correctional facilities	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; <i>Institutions Bulletin</i>
Group services coordinator, treatment facilities	Supervision of service materials and Guidelines; secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities
Literature coordinator	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees; production and distribution of eight G.S.O. bulletins, including Spanish Box 4-5-9; coordination of French Box 4-5-9; preparation of filmstrips; updating of old pamphlets; preparation of new pamphlets; film preparation and distribution
Loners, Internationalists	<i>Loners-Internationalists Meeting</i> ; secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees
Overseas, World Service Meeting, Spanish correspondence	Secretary, trustees' International Committee; secretary, World Service Meeting; <i>World Service Meeting Report</i>
Public information	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; <i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>

Regional Forums

Co-secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee; editor, *Box 4-5-9*

Staff coordinator

Assistant secretary, General Service Board; secretary, trustees' General Sharing Session; secretary, Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions; director, A.A.W.S.; *Quarterly Report*; secretary, International Convention; co-secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums

The basic responsibility of the staff is to answer correspondence. During 1981, over 20,000 letters were answered. The staff coordinator makes sure mail is answered promptly without interruption during vacations, sickness, or absences or a staff member's involvement with a special project. Most staff members also answer A.A. group mail from a specific region.

An exciting and rewarding aspect of G.S.O. staff service is invitations to A.A. conventions, assembly meetings, and get-togethers. These trips provide the staff opportunities to become acquainted with A.A.'s all over the U.S. and Canada, to inform them about G.S.O. services, and most important, to gain information on local activities that can be shared with other groups.

In 1981, more than 1,450 visitors from all over the world came to G.S.O. Each has the opportunity to tour the various G.S.O. and Grapevine departments. These visits give us a wonderful opportunity to explain G.S.O.'s work and to learn about A.A. activities in visitors' hometowns or countries.

Staff meetings are held once a week, and the staff coordinator takes the minutes. When necessary, a meeting is conducted by the group services coordinator for the purpose of improving services to A.A. groups and members.

Sarah Price



G.S.O.'s 1981 reception room (Lee Dean at the switchboard, as she still is) has given way to this handsome entrance, with a corner for resting tourist feet and



selecting literature. In 32 years, the Shipping Department has grown from two men to nine, in ample space.



Treatment Facilities

Pamphlets on drugs and alcohol reviewed

Trustees' committee: A subcommittee was appointed to prepare a statement that reflects the importance of A.A. members' not giving advice on the use of prescribed medications. The committee concluded that the pamphlets "The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse" and "Problems Other Than Alcohol" need to be totally updated and revised. The subcommittee will give a progress report at the July committee meeting.

In response to a letter from the Northeastern Texas delegate, expressing his area's concern about references to the use of medication in A.A. Conference-approved literature, the committee suggested that the trustee-at-large/U.S. explain to the delegate and his area that the committee is merely reviewing the two pamphlets just mentioned, for updating.

According to previous recommendations from this committee, the six points to define an A.A. group, as well as clarification of the difference between groups and meetings, have been added to the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Centers."

The committee suggested exploring the idea of mailing multiple copies of the Guidelines For A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field to people not included on the present mailing list, such as directors of treatment centers.

Gordon Patrick, chairperson

Staff report: Carrying the message into treatment centers con-

tinues to grow. Service material has been prepared by G.S.O. sharing how some areas cope with the influx of new alcoholics from these centers.

Correspondence from A.A.'s carrying the message into treatment facilities indicates that more regular A.A. groups are being formed that use meeting space in treatment centers but are open to A.A.'s in the community.

Correspondence questions this year included: "When alcoholics attend A.A. meetings away from the treatment facility, is it necessary to have meetings within the facility?"; and "Is it helpful to have both open and closed meetings at a facility?"

It is suggested that a group not be named after a treatment facility, since it does imply affiliation.

The one-page flyer "Where Do I Go From Here?," prepared by this committee, is still being used in large quantities. It was designed for the patient leaving a facility.

G.S.O. provides the following services to those in treatment facilities: correspondence with the staff member on this assignment; a correspondence service (putting outside A.A.'s in touch with confined members through correspondence); for new groups, a Group Handbook and complimentary literature; *Box 4-5-9* bimonthly and the *Institutions Bulletin* three times yearly; a discount package of A.A. literature (ordered through the committee or the group); Guidelines for Correctional and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Beth Kuhlmann

Reports From the A.A. Grapevine

A year of change—self-supporting by 1983?

Directors' report: All at the A.A. Grapevine were saddened by the loss of our director and friend, regional trustee Bud Grondahl. Just days before his death, Bud had journeyed to New York to attend a meeting of our board. O. S. "Buck" Bruner, East Central regional trustee, was nominated to finish Bud's term. The Corporate Board also approved the addition of one Class A trustee-director and nominated William Flynn, M.D., to the position.

Delivery of the magazine was hampered throughout 1981 by bad service from the company employed in this capacity. A new firm was employed late in the year, but transition interrupted deliveries, too. We are working hard to recover lost momentum and have asked the delegates and area Grapevine chairpersons for help.

Revenues for the year increased by more than \$65,000; expenses, by \$138,140 (16%), mostly as a result of higher postage rates, higher rent, and temporary help needed during the transition to our new fulfillment firm.

In November, we employed a controller, Don Meurer; and in December, Ann Warner rejoined the staff to fill the vacancy of associate editor.

Effective with the March 1982 issue, a new printer was employed, and we began mailing the magazine from Harrisburg, Pa.; our budget for 1982 reflects the expected reduction in printing and mailing costs. We have reduced paper cost and postage as well by going to lighter-weight paper.

During 1981, we embarked on a one-year plan to improve every facet of the Grapevine operation. Never has the Grapevine gone through so many changes in one year. This challenge to the staff and employees was accepted by all with enthusiasm. We hope for a 5% increase in circulation in 1982; if that is correct, our operations will be self-supporting by the end of the year.

Don Daly, chairperson



"Chaos" describes the Grapevine's cramped Circulation Department on the eve of moving. Today, a glimpse of the department's data-processing section



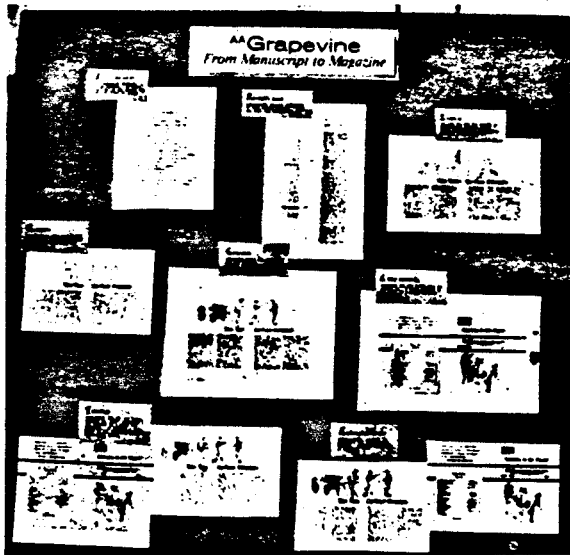
Staff report: Our "bottom line," unlike that of strictly business organizations, is not financial. Rather, it consists of one fundamental concern: How can we best carry the A.A. message through the Grapevine? We are working hard at cost-cutting primarily because as long as we remain on a sound financial footing, the magazine can do the best possible job for the greatest number of people.

Part of the Grapevine's one-year plan was a close scrutiny of the magazine itself. A subcommittee of the Corporate Board, working closely with both staff and Editorial Board, has made a number of suggestions, and changes in the magazine have been subtle but significant.

First, recognizing that more people are reading less, we are attempting to use shorter articles and are increasing the number of pithy, often humorous fillers. That gives each issue greater variety and provides a chance for more A.A.'s to be represented. Second, we are working harder than ever before to seek out articles by A.A.'s not often heard from in the magazine—young, old, gay, dually addicted, and minority-group. Many A.A.'s do not realize that the Grapevine is written by the Fellowship, not by "those people in New York." We have tried to get that message across in the magazine itself (for example, an invitation to writers in the April issue) as well as through correspondence, talks, and conversation. We continue efforts to impart a more contemporary look to the magazine by using advanced techniques in type, graphics, and layouts.

Though circulation dropped toward the end of 1981, it is up again and growing—making more hard work for the non-A.A.'s in the Circulation, Mailing, and Bookkeeping Departments. The process of moving into new and larger quarters created opportunities for using the Serenity Prayer. With that chaos behind us, and our major problems with delivery of the magazine under control, all of us at the Grapevine are settling down to a more peaceful — and if possible, more productive — year ahead.

Retha Gresham, managing editor



shows efficient order. On a Conference display board, steps in production of a finished magazine were traced.

1982 Advisory Actions 'Keep It Simple'

The group conscience of the Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory (to the Board) Actions, which the General Service Board approved in its legally required annual meeting just after the Conference. In addition to the action introduced on the floor before the whole Conference, others were based upon the reports of the Conference committees, as indicated in the headings. (Members and officers of the 1982 committees are listed on page 56.)

Floor Action

It was recommended that:

1 The alternate delegate for Southern New Jersey, Ruth Nichol, be seated to replace delegate Madge Mansfield, who had to leave the Conference on Tuesday, April 20.

Agenda

It was recommended that:

2 The following be considered for the 1983 Conference theme: (a) "Group Responsibilities in Service — Back to Basics"; (b) "The A.A. Member — Service, Privileges and Responsibilities"; (c) "Anonymity — Our Spiritual Foundation."

3 The following presentation/discussion subjects be considered for the 1983 Conference: (a) "How Is the A.A. Member's Voice Heard at the General Service Conference?" — (1) "Through an Informed Group Conscience," (2) "Through Correspondence to G.S.O.," (3) "Through District Activity," (4) "Through His or Her Delegate"; (b) "The Member, the Group, and Their Money" — (1) "The Cost of Involvement in Service," (2) "How Are District Activities Funded?," (3) "What Will a Dollar in the Basket Do Today?"; (c) "Sponsorship" — (1) "In Recovery," (2) "In Service."

4 At next year's Conference, the following structured workshops be considered: (a) "Communications: Group-G.S.R.-D.C.M.," (b) "Informed Group Conscience," (c) "Rotation in Service."

5 The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1983 Conference consist of five speakers—one trustee, two delegates, two staff members (one G.S.O. and one GV)—and one delegate chairing. It was further recommended that the format of the meeting be reviewed each year by the Conference Agenda Committee.

Presentations on topic touched on in Advisory Action 2: p. 19
Presentations on topic touched on in Advisory Action 3: p. 12
Presentations on topic touched on in Advisory Action 4: p. 17

Buck Bruner let himself in for some ribbing after the opening-night A.A. meeting, when he mentioned his toupee. During the joint meeting of the Conference Grapevine Committee and the GV Corporate Board, long-haired Naomi Strassberg (Grapevine executive secretary) was introduced by Don Daly as "having more hair than anyone here—except Buck."

Cooperation With the Professional Community

It was recommended that:

6 The draft of a pamphlet directed to the medical profession be approved with some minor changes to be made in the editing stage, with the title "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession."

Correctional Facilities

It was recommended that:

7 The following statement be added to the pamphlets "Memo to an Inmate" (page 43, inside box) and "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" (page 25): "A.A. does not provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials."

8 The pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate" continue to be published.

9 The pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate" be translated into Spanish. It was also suggested that "Carrying the Message Inside the Walls" and "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" be translated into Spanish, due to the high Spanish population in prisons.

Presentations referring to institutions: p. 15

No respect for history

Having arrived early for the Conference, on Friday evening, a group of enthusiastic delegates from the Pacific Region rented a van to tour the area and see the local A.A. sites. When they explained to the driver who they were and what they were about, he was terribly disappointed—he had brought along a cooler of beer for the occasion. Later, the van pulled up in front of the former home of Lois and Bill W., on Clinton Street in Brooklyn, just in time for the eager camera buffs to snap away at an odd sight—the present owner of the house emerging from the basement carrying a case of beer.

Finance

It was recommended that:

10 The following actions be taken in connection with the "60-30-10" pamphlet: (a) A new concept for a pamphlet to replace the "60-30-10" piece be considered; (b) all 1981 Advisory Actions, with the exception of the action requesting specific graphics, be incorporated into the new piece; also, emphasis on the Seventh Tradition and how it relates to the individual member be included; (c) the General Service Office develop the necessary copy and title to further present the need for supporting the A.A. support system.

11 The Regular Contribution Plan be used to supplement the 60-30-10 Plan.

Workshop on topic touched on in Advisory Action 10: p. 11
Presentations on finance: p. 12



Among the new furnishings in the G.S.O. general manager's office, one historical item stands out. The leather-covered couch was once in Bill W.'s office, in the pre-1970 East 45th Street building.

Grapevine

It was recommended that:

- 12 The price of miscellaneous items sold by the Grapevine be increased as needed.
- 13 No action be taken at this time on quantity sales of Grapevine subscriptions to outside organizations.

Literature

It was recommended that:

- 14 A draft of a pamphlet be developed for the homosexual alcoholic, to be considered by next year's Conference.
- 15 The suggestion that a filmstrip be produced on the functions of central and intergroup offices not be approved.
- 16 Since the book "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" is available on cassette tapes, there is no need to print the book in large type at this time.
- 17 The suggestion to seek Conference approval for "Problems Other Than Alcohol (Excerpts)" be approved.
- 18 The taping of our books and booklets be continued by A.A.W.S., Inc.
- 19 An index and illustrations be included in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet.
- 20 The following sentence be added in bold type on the cover of A.A. directories under the caveat "CONFIDENTIAL": "This directory is not to be used as a mailing list or for any form of solicitation or commercial venture."

21 The suggestion to produce a filmstrip on the functions of the group inventory not be accepted at this time.

Workshop on topic related to Advisory Action 16: p. 11
Presentations on topic related to Advisory Action 16: p. 24
Presentations on topic related to Advisory Action 20: p. 19

Policy/Admissions

It was recommended that:

22 All nontrustee, nondirector members of the trustees' committees be encouraged to attend and participate at the joint meetings and Monday sessions of the Conference, and as observers at one presentation session related to the committee on which they serve.

23 Each Conference committee carefully consider their agenda items and strive to make their recommendations for Advisory Actions to the Conference at the policy level.

Public Information

It was recommended that:

24 The additional TV public service announcements be distributed as follows: (a) G.S.O. will announce availability to delegates and P.I. committees; (b) the announcement will include a listing of local TV stations that requested spots in 1980-81, so that P.I. committees may initiate contact with the stations; (c) committees ordering P.S.A.'s may indicate if they wish spots sent (1) to them or (2) directly to stations; (d) four-color storyboard brochures, developed by the trustees' P.I. Committee, will accompany the mailing; (e) G.S.O. will contact and fill requests made by television network headquarters.

25 The sampling method for conducting the future membership survey be reevaluated by: (a) the trustees' Public Information Committee, which is requested to explore the value of designing a program to preselect A.A. groups listed at G.S.O., on a random basis by area; (b) area delegates, who are asked to



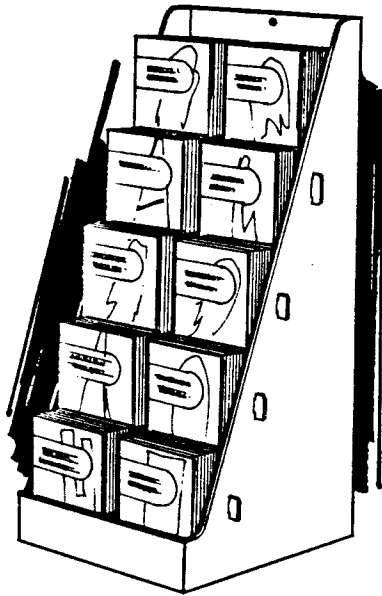
On G.S.O. tours, visitors come through the door past desks where Steno employees are conveniently seated outside staff offices.

consider the feasibility of distributing survey material to pre-selected A.A. groups in their areas.

26 The possibility of conducting a future membership survey on a random basis by area be an agenda subject for the 1983 Conference.

27 A.A.W.S. explore the feasibility of producing a small, low-cost cardboard literature display rack for public information purposes.

For public information use, a cardboard literature rack of the type indicated in this rough sketch could be easily folded when a display is dismantled. It might also be produced at lower cost than the wire rack available from G.S.O. for A.A. group meetings.



Report and Charter

It was recommended that:

28 The modifications made by the recommendation of the 1978 General Service Conference to Article 5 of the Conference Charter be reaffirmed.

Treatment Facilities

It was recommended that:

29 In light of the recent statistics showing the greater influx of members coming from treatment facilities, a bulletin directed primarily to treatment facilities committees be instituted. This recommendation be referred to the appropriate trustees' committees for implementation.

Presentations referring to treatment facilities: p. 21
Workshop referring to treatment facilities: p. 23

Trustees

It was recommended that:

30 The following slate of officers and trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April 1982 [see

page 42; Conference and board approved the slate presented by the trustees' Nominating Committee; among the regional trustee candidates, the Conference recommended the election of Kenneth L. Dunphy for Eastern Canada, Natalie Schwanke for Pacific U.S., and Joan Ullom for West Central U.S., all of whom were elected by the board]; that the following be elected as officers of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see page 42; slate of officers approved]; that the following be elected as directors of A.A. World Services, Inc. [see page 42; slate of directors approved]; that the following be elected as directors of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. [see page 42; slate of directors approved].



Near Steno, a woodland mural is an attractive background for brown-bag lunches or coffee breaks. Letters these employees handle also involve the new Mail and Files Departments. And no visit to G.S.O. would be complete without a look at Archives' welcoming quarters.

The General Service Office

INCOME STATEMENT

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1981

	1981	1980
INCOME		
Sale of literature	\$4,443,965	\$3,981,170
Less: Discount to A.A. groups	(191,495)	(155,123)
<u>Net Sales</u>	4,252,470	3,826,047
Less: Cost of printing	(1,533,539)	(1,306,058)
Royalties	(521,878)	(451,200)
<u>Gross Profit From Literature</u>	2,197,053	2,068,789
Contributions — A.A. groups and members	1,564,643	1,308,601
Interest income	20,442	26,225
<u>Total Income</u>	3,782,138	3,403,615
EXPENSES		
Salaries	1,467,392	1,293,494
Pension expense	185,230	146,928
Rent and electricity	168,990	106,165
Box 4-5-9	86,011	74,723
A.A. directories	57,467	53,095
Other Service Office printing	134,594	96,211
Shipping and mailing	483,652	400,383
Other office expenses	337,703	314,798
Insurance and payroll taxes	206,840	157,454
Professional services	34,250	38,491
Board, committee, and staff meetings	77,433	59,349
1980 World Service Meeting	—	34,704
Writers' fees	35,383	33,078
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	59,923	98,547
General Service Conference	115,680	107,240
E.D.P. system development, equipment, and maintenance	46,307	41,892
Regional Forums and other expenses	39,249	31,353
Filmstrips/film project	—	14,617
45th Anniversary Convention	—	202,950
Construction expense	791,238	—
<u>Total Expense</u>	4,327,342	3,305,472
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR (page 52)	<u>(545,204)</u>	<u>98,143</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION		
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc.	\$ 669,286	\$ 801,647
General Fund — General Service Board	(1,214,490)	(703,504)
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND		
Balance, January 1	\$2,959,335	\$2,692,527
Transfer to General Fund	(825,000)	—
Investment income	280,581	266,808
<u>Balance, December 31</u>	<u>2,414,916</u>	<u>2,959,335</u>

() denotes red figures

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.—Notes to Financial Statements, December 31, 1981

Note A — Purposes and Restrictions of Different Funds

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which, during 1977, was redefined as one year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The 1977 General Service Conference also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved by the board of trustees, and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

INCOME STATEMENT

Financial statements

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1981

	1981	1980
INCOME — from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$ 822,600</u>	<u>\$758,160</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including temporary help	\$128,710	\$ 99,448
Printing	222,524	200,775
Mailing — service	69,523	63,541
— postage	83,597	60,097
Other printing costs	32,432	17,719
Calendar costs	28,803	50,284
Occupancy costs	19,054	9,663
Telephone	1,481	1,522
Office supplies and expenses	4,322	7,399
Other editorial expenses	<u>3,494</u>	<u>4,362</u>
Total	593,940	514,810
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	156,436	143,643
Data processing costs	52,141	40,000
Stationery and supplies	9,566	8,853
Occupancy costs	19,054	9,663
Telephone	1,481	1,960
Office expense, including agency fees	15,555	13,846
Selling expense — regular	33,518	32,476
— GvR program	14,062	6,583
Postage	<u>37,147</u>	<u>28,059</u>
Total	338,960	285,083
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	5,497	5,496
Insurance	16,069	10,656
Legal and accounting	14,100	13,475
Payroll taxes	18,507	17,464
Meetings and conferences	4,604	3,915
Furniture and equipment	2,611	2,760
Contribution to Retirement Plan	14,473	12,202
Canadian exchange	<u>1,028</u>	<u>5,144</u>
Total	76,889	71,112
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,009,789</u>	<u>871,005</u>
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS	(187,189)	(112,845)
Interest earned	<u>50,487</u>	<u>48,574</u>
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR YEAR (page 52)	<u>(136,702)</u>	<u>(64,271)</u>

() denotes red figures

working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., were amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers and, therefore, reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund.

The GENERAL FUND comprises those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

(continued)

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

Financial statements

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

DECEMBER 31, 1981

	December 31, 1981		December 31, 1980	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
ASSETS				
Cash — checking accounts	\$ 295,431	\$ 34,028	\$ 220,768	\$ 31,672
Savings accounts and certificates	208,677	60,696	68,428	1,574
Investment (Note C)	—	380,720	—	480,718
Accounts receivable	78,220	9,556	71,352	52,104
Due from Grapevine	7,774	—	5,354	—
Inventories	1,079,275	70,548	1,053,800	23,373
Prepaid expenses	140,111	75,941	111,844	18,374
Total Assets	1,809,488	631,489	1,531,546	607,815
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and accruals payable	364,143	102,744	370,558	23,064
Deferred income	4,561	632,826	—	552,130
Total Liabilities	368,704	735,570	370,558	575,194
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	1,160,988	32,621	1,062,845	96,892
Net income (loss) (pages 50-51)	(545,204)	(136,702)	98,143	(64,271)
Transfer from (to) Reserve Fund	825,000	—	—	—
Total Net Worth	1,440,784	(104,081)	1,160,988	32,621
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note B)	\$1,383,771		\$1,103,975	
General Fund — G.S.B. (Note B)	57,013		57,013	
Total Operating Funds — as above	1,440,784		1,160,988	
Reserve Fund	2,414,916		2,959,335	
Total Net Worth	3,855,700		4,120,323	
RESERVE FUND				
Cash	\$ 230,370		\$ 29,625	
Savings accounts and temporary investments	145,216		136,612	
Due from (to) A.A. Grapevine	(5,400)		(48,057)	
U.S. Treasury obligations	1,689,999		2,471,055	
Government agency bonds	679,824		786,743	
Accrued interest	55,627		64,075	
Less: Liability for Grapevine subscribers (Note C)	(380,720)		(480,718)	
Balance, December 31	2,414,916		2,959,335	

() denotes red figures

(continued)

Note B — After transfers of \$389,490 in 1981 and \$703,504 in 1980 from Publishing to General Fund.

Note C — Grapevine investment with Reserve Fund — \$380,720 — represents the deferred subscription income of the Grapevine at December 31, 1979, less \$100,000 withdrawn by the Grapevine during 1981 to restore its depleted working capital.

These financial statements and the foregoing notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountant.

1982 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

Income: Sales income has been budgeted at \$4,722,500. Allowing for A.A. growth, income from sales is expected to show a net increase of 11% over 1981. During 1982, it is anticipated that A.A.W.S., Inc., will distribute 491,000 copies of "Alcoholics Anonymous," 246,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions"—regular edition, 50,500 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions"—pocket edition, 21,500 "A.A. Comes of Age," 56,000 "As Bill Sees It," 38,000 "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers," 180,000 booklets, and more than 7,000,000 pamphlets and miscellaneous items. After deducting \$2,386,300—the cost of printing and producing the items sold and the royalties paid on book sales—the gross profit from sales is estimated to be \$2,386,200. Adding interest earned on daily cash flow, the total income from the publishing activity is expected to be \$2,396,200.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$1,733,900, representing an increase of 12% over 1981. Considered in this increase are greater publishing activity, higher postage and shipping rates, and continuing inflationary pressures. Net publishing income, after operating expenses, is expected to be \$662,300.

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

Income: Contributions from A.A. groups and members have been budgeted at \$1,722,700, an increase of 10% over 1981 actual.

Expenses: Total expenses, representing the cost of group services that are paid out of contributions, are expected to be \$2,037,600. Included in this portion of the General Service Office budget is the cost of the General Service Conference, totaling \$141,000. The total cost of all service expenses is budgeted to be \$314,900 greater than contribution income. This shortfall will be funded from the net income of the publishing operation.

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Less the interest earned on a day-of-deposit-to-day-of-withdrawal account, other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$401,900. The largest portion of this expense, \$170,500, is allocated for the balance of construction and refurbishing costs under our new and expanded lease. The rest of this expense covers such expenses as the cost of the quarterly trustee meetings, the expenses of the Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community, the cost of Regional Forums, legal and auditing fees, the expenses of the archives, and the cost of the 1982 World Service Meeting. The bulk of these expenses will be offset by net income from the publishing operation. The balance will be funded by a transfer from the General Service Board Reserve Fund.

1982 Grapevine Budget

Total income: Income from magazine and other sales is budgeted at \$1,003,000. This represents an increase of \$179,400, or 22%, over 1981 and is expected primarily as a result of subscription increases in mid-1980 and in late 1981.

Total expenses: Total costs and expenses have been budgeted to reflect a decrease of \$39,100, or 4%, mostly as a result of a prudent print-price-shopping policy and a change in printing methods of the magazine. A net income of \$33,000 has been budgeted.

1982 G.S.O. Budget Financial statements

The budget for 1982 operations of G.S.O. activities is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$4,772,500*
Less: Cost of products and royalties	2,386,300
Gross profit from sales	2,386,200
Interest income	10,000
Total income	2,396,200

TOTAL EXPENSES 1,733,900

Excess of income (expense) 662,300

**Based on the sale of:*

491,000 books	—	"Alcoholics Anonymous"
246,000 books	—	"Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (reg.)
50,500 books	—	"Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (pocket)
21,500 books	—	"A.A. Comes of Age"
56,000 books	—	"As Bill Sees It"
38,000 books	—	"Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers"

and

Pamphlets, booklets, and miscellaneous items

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$1,722,700
---------------	-------------

TOTAL EXPENSES 2,037,600**

Excess of income (expense) (314,900)

**Includes cost of General Service Conference—\$141,000

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

INCOME

Interest	\$ 4,000
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TOTAL EXPENSE 405,900***

Excess of income (expense) (401,900)

***Office construction and refurbishing, board meetings, P.I.C. expense, C.P.C. expense, legal and auditing fees, Regional Forums, World Service Meeting, etc.

The publishing activity will contribute \$662,300 toward the budgeted deficits.

1982 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales	\$1,003,000
Total costs and expenses	970,000
Net income (loss) from operations	<u>33,000</u>

Contributions 1981 Contributions From Groups—by Delegate Area

Area #	General Service Conference Area	Total # of Gps.	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Total Group Contrib.	No. of Members	Contrib. per Capita	Area #	General Service Conference Area	Total # of Gps.	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Total Group Contrib.	No. of Members	Contrib. per Capita
1. Ala./N.W. Fla.		218	125	57.3%	\$ 8,615.54	2,855	\$3.02	63. S. Dak.		121	75	62.0	4,976.98	2,164	2.30
2. Alsk.		97	39	40.2	2,621.05	1,079	2.43	64. Tenn.		254	139	54.7	9,590.81	3,635	2.64
3. Ariz.		443	196	44.2	16,371.56	6,403	2.56	65. N.E.		206	114	55.3	17,901.08	5,789	3.09
4. Ark.		134	77	57.5	3,494.29	1,950	1.79	66. N.W.		160	85	53.1	7,330.98	3,402	2.15
5. S. Calif.		834	412	49.4	45,658.22	24,212	1.89	67. S.E.		215	119	55.3	13,107.83	6,525	2.01
6. N. Coastal		948	681	71.8	72,707.24	21,693	3.35	68. S.W.		265	150	56.6	13,540.89	4,728	2.86
7. N. Int.		374	188	50.3	16,652.78	6,937	2.40	69. Utah		121	83	68.6	6,020.74	1,677	3.59
8. San Diego		288	174	60.4	14,768.81	7,021	2.10	70. Vi.		85	45	52.9	4,952.40	1,354	3.66
9. Mid-S.		722	405	56.1	39,612.04	19,297	2.05	71. Va.		548	359	65.5	30,579.45	9,284	3.29
10. Colo.		346	198	57.2	18,816.69	5,864	3.21	72. Wash.		669	402	60.1	38,833.43	10,903	3.56
11. Conn.		670	401	59.9	27,836.12	13,171	2.11	73. W. Va.		135	85	63.0	5,579.34	1,297	4.30
12. Del.		91	65	71.4	5,376.23	1,398	3.85	74. Wis.							
13. D.C.		251	164	65.3	19,805.11	7,535	2.63	74. N. Wis./Upper							
14. N. Fla.		246	168	68.3	14,224.84	3,621	3.93	75. Pen./Mich.		366	196	53.6	18,084.95	5,297	3.41
15. S.		655	419	64.0	43,328.62	10,247	4.23	76. S.		395	213	53.9	15,266.98	5,759	2.65
16. Ga.		388	280	72.2	21,121.13	6,688	3.16	76. Wyo.		71	44	62.0	2,161.82	946	2.29
17. Haw.		108	72	66.7	5,089.55	1,846	2.76	77. P.R.		95	60	63.2	2,995.90	1,313	2.28
18. Idaho		111	77	69.4	4,043.91	1,244	3.25	78. Alta./N.W.T.		366	164	44.8	15,100.61	4,641	3.25
19. Chicago		531	256	48.2	22,520.33	11,274	2.00	79. B.C./Yukon		528	281	53.2	25,731.56	7,123	3.61
20. N.		555	272	49.0	23,302.91	9,857	2.36	80. Man.		134	60	44.8	6,469.94	3,048	2.12
21. S.		238	122	51.3	7,826.78	3,481	2.25	81. N.B./P.E.I.		181	105	58.0	5,754.62	2,411	2.39
22. N. Ind.		314	170	54.1	14,362.01	4,375	3.28	82. N.S./Nfld./Lab.		218	113	51.8	6,374.64	2,281	2.79
23. S.		200	137	68.5	12,860.95	3,502	3.67	83. E.		415	164	39.5	17,858.18	9,755	1.83
24. Iowa		391	208	53.2	14,738.31	7,035	2.09	84. N.E.		144	53	36.8	4,469.79	1,710	2.61
25. Kans.		239	155	64.9	11,099.57	4,730	2.35	85. N.W.		68	28	41.2	2,087.09	1,074	1.94
26. Ky.		272	139	51.1	17,249.16	3,766	4.58	86. W.		368	144	39.1	20,067.02	5,362	3.74
27. La.		260	161	61.9	12,480.02	3,739	3.34	87. Que.							
28. Me.		196	112	57.1	7,349.53	2,318	3.17	87. S.W.		439	406	92.5	13,227.82	11,683	1.13
29. Md.		414	235	56.8	20,434.00	5,210	3.92	88. S.E.		189	189	100.0	6,603.43	2,776	2.38
30. E. Mass.		683	371	54.3	36,000.99	18,232	1.97	89. N.E.		247	217	87.9	6,288.81	4,836	1.30
31. W. Mich.		114	52	45.6	4,871.92	2,228	2.19	90. N.W.		232	185	79.7	9,855.03	3,846	2.56
32. Cent.		259	153	59.1	21,863.26	5,014	4.36	91. Sask.		291	150	51.5	9,323.52	3,562	2.62
33. S.E.		274	144	52.6	16,356.79	6,395	2.56	Total U.S./		28,063	16,168	57.6%	\$1,381,484.60	519,496	\$2.66
34. W.		214	111	51.9	11,273.44	3,988	2.83	Canada							
35. N. Minn.		381	189	49.6	9,595.05	5,857	1.64	Bahamas		5	1	20.0	300.00	111	2.70
36. S.		637	362	56.8	32,108.82	20,242	1.59	V.I. of U.S.		6	1	16.7	40.00	142	.28
37. Miss.		131	84	64.1	4,361.92	1,641	2.66			28,074	16,170 ^①	57.6% ^①	\$1,381,824.60 ^②	519,749	\$2.66 ^①
38. E. Mo.		301	198	65.8	15,301.29	3,706	4.13	Individual, anniversary, & in-memoriam					48,498.97		
39. W.		134	78	58.2	7,791.00	2,503	3.11	Specials					121,446.47		
40. Mont.		189	84	44.4	5,183.89	2,178	2.38	Total for U.S. & Canada					\$1,551,770.04		
41. Nebr.		391	249	63.7	23,112.17	6,442	3.59	FOREIGN AND OTHER							
42. Nev.		123	70	56.9	4,568.15	1,395	3.27	Foreign					7,015.30		
43. N.H.		182	97	53.3	5,739.64	2,698	2.13	Birds of a Feather					380.70		
44. N. N.J.		626	336	53.7	30,084.51	13,056	2.30	Correctional facility groups					20.00		
45. S.		191	115	60.2	15,475.11	2,798	5.53	Internationalists					547.00		
46. N.M.		131	81	61.8	6,052.38	1,732	3.49	Treatment facility groups					4,827.12		
47. Cent.		336	168	50.0	22,963.55	4,593	5.00	World Hello					200.00		
48. H./M./B.		260	128	49.2	6,361.88	3,180	2.00	Grand Total					\$1,564,760.16		
49. S.E.		927	506	54.6	56,343.35	22,643	2.49								
50. W.		156	86	55.1	5,532.40	2,023	2.73								
51. N.C./Ber.		440	284	64.5	22,656.55	6,601	3.43								
52. N. Dak.		128	75	58.6	5,834.33	2,019	2.89								
53. Ohio															
53. Cent. & S.E.		225	104	46.2	8,379.08	3,091	2.71								
54. N.E.		505	176	34.9	13,666.78	12,388	1.10								
55. N.W. Ohio/															
S.E. Mich.		134	79	59.0	5,953.54	1,938	3.07								
56. S.W. Ohio/															
N. Ky.		220	118	53.6	8,136.01	3,491	2.33								
57. Okla.		240	200	83.3	16,119.51	2,817	5.72								
58. Oreg.		323	186	57.6	13,995.14	4,328	3.23								
59. E. Pa.		521	335	64.3	31,873.27	10,754	2.96								
60. W.		346	215	62.1	15,373.86	5,031	3.06								
61. R.I.		135	88	65.2	6,464.71	2,055	3.15								
62. S.C.		146	110	75.3	7,587.37	1,910	3.97								

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

② Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and anniversary.

③ Reflects 1980 contributions from Conference Areas 87, 88, and 90 at 100%.

1981 Total Contributions—by State/Province

Contributions

	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
CANADA (stated in Canadian dollars)						
Alberta	335	158	46.6%	\$ 23,405.56	4,395	\$5.33
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	128	77	59.2	4,993.23	1,544	3.23
Nfld. & Lab.	76	33	43.4	1,990.17	731	2.72
Nova Scotia	141	79	56.8	5,751.46	1,574	3.65
Prince Edward Island	55	29	53.7	2,193.44	907	2.42
British Columbia	541	285	53.0	36,921.71	7,179	5.14
Manitoba	132	63	47.3	9,105.71	3,025	3.01
N.W. Territories	14	1	6.6	51.65	130	.40
Ontario	973	374	38.7	60,082.42	18,710	3.21
Quebec	1,087	1,007	92.6	44,787.69	22,359	2.00
Saskatchewan	291	151	51.1	12,098.31	3,556	3.40
Yukon Territory	8	1	25.0	350.25	134	2.61
TOTAL for CANADA (Canadian dollars)	3,781	2,258 ^①	59.7% ^①	201,731.60	64,244	3.14 ^①
(converted to U.S. dollars) (167,941.56)						(2.61)
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA (U.S. dollars)	28,074	16,170 ^①	57.6% ^①	\$1,551,770.04	519,749	2.99 ^①
FOREIGN AND OTHER						
Foreign				\$ 7,015.30		
Birds of a Feather				380.70		
Correctional facility groups				20.00		
Internationalists				547.00		
Treatment facility groups				4,827.12		
World Hello				200.00		
GRAND TOTAL				\$1,564,760.16		

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1980-1981 (U.S. dollars)

	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
U.S. 1981	24,293	13,912	57.3%	\$1,383,828.48	455,505	\$3.04
U.S. 1980	22,169	12,081	54.5	1,130,972.05	414,434	2.72
Increase (Decrease)	<u>2,124</u>	<u>1,831</u>	<u>2.8%</u>	<u>\$ 252,856.43</u>	<u>41,071</u>	<u>\$.32</u>
Canada 1981	3,781	2,258 ^①	59.7% ^①	\$ 167,941.56	64,244	\$2.61 ^①
Canada 1980	3,624	2,159 ^②	59.5 ^②	161,926.49	61,531	2.63 ^②
Increase (Decrease)	<u>157</u>	<u>99</u>	<u>.2%</u>	<u>\$ 6,015.07</u>	<u>2,713</u>	<u>(\$.02)</u>
U.S. and Canada 1981	28,074	16,170 ^①	57.6% ^①	1,551,770.04	519,749	\$2.99 ^①
U.S. and Canada 1980	25,793	14,240 ^②	55.2 ^②	1,292,898.54	475,965	2.71 ^②
Increase (Decrease)	<u>2,281</u>	<u>1,930</u>	<u>2.4%</u>	<u>\$ 258,871.50</u>	<u>43,784</u>	<u>\$.28</u>

U.S.	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
Alabama	168	94	56.0%	\$ 5,955.08	2,325	\$2.56
Alaska	97	39	40.2	2,682.05	1,079	2.49
Arizona	433	192	44.3	17,427.62	6,352	2.74
Arkansas	132	75	56.8	4,923.79	1,950	2.53
California	3,230	1,863	57.7	217,709.79	80,556	2.70
Colorado	346	194	57.3	19,686.50	5,864	3.36
Connecticut	673	397	59.7	32,417.94	13,264	2.44
Delaware	91	63	71.4	5,572.88	1,398	3.99
District of Columbia	111	60	57.6	8,687.37	3,601	2.41
Florida	938	617	65.0	80,083.27	14,266	5.61
Georgia	382	279	71.9	21,491.95	6,688	3.21
Hawaii	108	72	67.2	6,337.01	1,846	3.43
Idaho	139	92	66.1	5,142.31	1,565	3.29
Illinois	1,332	659	49.5	57,260.46	24,828	2.31
Indiana	527	316	59.1	30,805.93	8,105	3.80
Iowa	384	207	53.6	17,127.90	7,034	2.44
Kansas	237	155	64.5	13,934.37	4,683	2.98
Kentucky	265	134	50.3	17,995.02	3,702	4.86
Louisiana	254	161	62.4	12,939.38	3,662	3.53
Maine	187	110	58.2	7,440.26	2,232	3.33
Maryland	553	332	60.5	35,648.48	9,118	3.91
Massachusetts	793	427	53.3	45,338.62	20,316	2.23
Michigan	871	471	54.1	57,695.35	16,958	3.40
Minnesota	1,032	551	53.9	48,434.86	25,965	1.87
Mississippi	130	84	64.1	4,623.92	1,573	2.94
Missouri	432	275	63.5	24,051.94	6,056	3.97
Montana	193	84	44.2	5,470.89	2,178	2.51
Nebraska	389	248	63.2	28,777.24	6,457	4.46
Nevada	115	67	58.7	5,017.37	1,314	3.82
New Hampshire	186	97	54.4	6,413.64	2,842	2.26
New Jersey	803	449	55.2	56,930.11	15,329	3.71
New Mexico	130	81	62.3	7,353.38	1,732	4.25
New York	1,707	905	52.9	94,825.06	32,654	2.90
North Carolina	436	283	65.8	23,818.64	6,548	3.64
North Dakota	136	76	59.3	6,765.83	2,023	3.34
Ohio	1,059	465	44.2	37,341.12	20,385	1.83
Oklahoma	235	199	84.2	16,478.48	2,817	5.85
Oregon	306	187	58.4	15,766.64	4,173	3.78
Pennsylvania	893	554	62.9	53,646.87	16,136	3.32
Rhode Island	121	85	65.3	7,201.82	1,808	3.98
South Carolina	148	109	75.1	7,808.17	1,910	4.09
South Dakota	130	76	62.8	5,451.98	2,164	2.52
Tennessee	270	139	54.7	10,698.98	3,753	2.85
Texas	844	469	55.3	59,452.58	20,559	2.89
Utah	118	83	68.0	6,085.39	1,677	3.63
Vermont	85	45	51.7	5,252.40	1,339	3.92
Virginia	559	365	65.7	33,208.11	9,167	3.62
Washington	612	383	61.7	42,026.51	9,914	4.24
West Virginia	133	85	63.9	9,039.21	1,252	7.22
Wisconsin	649	355	54.0	31,632.04	9,709	3.26
Wyoming	73	44	62.8	2,155.82	991	2.18
Commonwealth of P.R.	95	60	62.5	3,206.15	1,313	2.44
Virgin Islands of U.S.	6	1	16.7	40.00	142	.28
Bahama Islands	5	1	20.0	300.00	111	2.70
Bermuda	12	0	00.0	250.00	122	2.05
TOTAL for U.S.	24,293	13,912	57.3%	\$1,383,828.48	455,505	\$3.04

①Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by all areas).

②Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas). Since lists were not received from Conference Areas 88, 89, and 90, it is assumed that 100% of the groups in those areas contributed to G.S.O.

1982 Conference Committees

Agenda

²Doris Beacom, Iowa
Dolores Colford, Chicago
Jack Elbert, La.
¹Greg MacNeil, Nev.

Rolly Brunet, N.W. Que.
Phil Cels, Man.
Gerry Coutu, R.I.
John Langston, Ga.

Secretary: Betty Liddle

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Joan Anderson, N.E. Ohio
¹Bill Bailey, W. Va.
Stan Brys, N. N.J.
²Dick Pittard, Wash.

Sarah Gunzinger, Vt.
Jim McCourt, Alsk.
Dave McHenry, Wyo.
Garnet Wipf, Sask.

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

Correctional Facilities

Jack Atwell, D.C.
²John Bremer, S. Wis.
Art Ludwig, Ala./N.W. Fla.
¹Martha Watson, S.E. Tex.

Ron Bush, W. Mich.
Derral Campbell, N. Int. Calif.
Luis Hernandez, P.R.
Ken Treganowan, Alta./N.W.T.

Secretary: Susan Daly

Finance

Gordon Dracup, E. Ont.
¹Sam Eddy, N. Coastal Calif.
Marcel Labrie, N.E. Que.
²Tom Lepinski, N. Fla.

John Heidemann, N. Wis./Upper
Pen. Mich.
Clyde Mitchell, S.W. Tex.
Jim Reeves, Del.
Peggy Screptock, N.W. Ohio/S.E.
Mich.

Secretary: Dennis Manders

Grapevine

¹June Boranian, Haw.
Bill Downey, E. Mass.
Bob French, S. Ill.
Carlene Reel, E. Mo.
²LaVern Walker, Okla.

Elmer Johnsrud, N. Dak.
Cork Oberg, Nebr.
Doug Riley, N.W. Tex.
Frank Rinaldo, Me.

Secretary: Retha Gresham

Literature

Art Caldwell, N.W. Ont.
¹Bill Peters, N. Ind.
²Dottie Rapp, Va.
³Rosaire Vanasse, S.E. Que.

Mary DeFer, Ariz.
John Goetschel, N. Ill.
Ralph Huelsman, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.
Bob Talkington, Kans.
Frank Youell, Md.

Secretary: Curtis Monahan

Conference Policy/Admissions

Eddie MacMullin, N.S./Nfld./Lab.
¹Skip Murphy, N.E. Ont.
²Lenore Tate, S. Fla.
Maurice Welch, Cent. N.Y.

Don Callahan, San Diego
Madge Mansfield, S. N.J.
Percy Moore, Miss.
Myron Snow, N.B./P.E.I.

Secretary: Sarah Price

Public Information

³Roscoe Betsill, Cent. & S.E. Ohio
¹Gertrude Brown, N.C./Ber.
Jim Ockerman, S. Calif.
Clyde Swaim, S.E. Mich.

Bill Blount, S.C.
John Currier, Hudson/Mohawk/
Berkshire
Tom LeTourneau, N. Minn.
Diana Salnave, Oreg.

Secretary: Vinnie McCarthy

Conference Report and Charter

Stan Mann, S. Minn.
¹Charlie Parmley, Ark.
Bud Turner, W. Pa.
²Jack Whitehouse, Cent. Mich.

Jill Johnston, S. Ind.
George Lathrop, W. N.Y.
Mabel Moebeck, S. Dak.
Billy Moore, Ky.

Secretary: Lyla Bonney

Treatment Facilities

¹Lee Brooks, E. Pa.
Cynthia Fifield, Conn.
Joe French, N.E. Tex.
²Webb Johnson, B.C./Yukon

Bill Dick, Idaho
Dyanne Gilliam, Mid-S. Calif.
Dave Leonard, N.M.
Barney John Malik, W. Ont.

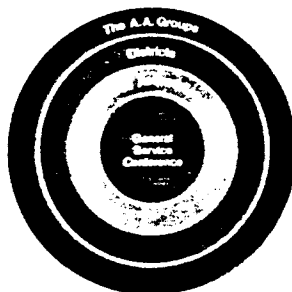
Secretary: Beth Kuhlmann

Committee on Trustees

Jesse Bowen, Utah
¹Blackie Brandon, W. Mo.
Alex Macaulay, S.E. N.Y.
²Don Pritts, Colo.

Dick Darling, N.H.
Stella LeFebvre, S.W. Que.
Lew Lewallen, Tenn.
Betty Reed, W. Mass.
Ray Vevik, Mont.

Secretary: Lois Fisher



New chairpersons and alternate chairpersons

Committee

Conference Agenda
Cooperation With the Professional
Community
Correctional Facilities
Finance

Grapevine
Literature

Conference Policy/Admissions
Public Information

Conference Report and Charter
Treatment Facilities
Committee on Trustees

Chairperson

Gerry Coutu, R.I.

Garnet Wipf, Sask.
Derral Campbell, N. Int. Calif.
Clyde Mitchell, S.W. Tex.

Cork Oberg, Nebr.
Mary DeFer, Ariz.

Myron Snow, N.B./P.E.I.
Tom LeTourneau, N. Minn.

George Lathrop, W. N.Y.
Barney John Malik, W. Ont.
Lew Lewallen, Tenn.

Alternate

Phil Cels, Man.

Jim McCourt, Alsk.
Ron Bush, W. Mich.
Peggy Screptock, N.W. Ohio/
S.E. Mich.

Doug Riley, N.W. Tex.
Ralph Huelsman, S.W. Ohio/
N. Ky.

Don Callahan, San Diego
John Currier, Hudson/Mohawk/
Berkshire

Billy Moore, Ky.
Dave Leonard, N.M.
Stella LeFebvre, S.W. Que.

- 1 Chairperson
- 2 Alternate chairperson
- 3 Alternate delegate

1982 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Fernand Ippersiel, *chairperson*
Joe Kraus
Gordon Patrick
Mary Phelps
James Shannon
George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
Nell Wing, *archivist*
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

Richard Driscoll, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
David Aronofsky
John Bragg
George Dorsey
Jacquelyn Solomon
Virginia Turner
Betty Liddle, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

William Flynn, M.D., *chairperson*
John Bragg
Jack Hennessy
Albert Hergott
Herbert McBride, M.D.
Gordon Patrick
Shepherd Raimi
Helen Turnquest, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

W. J. Estelle Jr., *chairperson*
Jack Anderson
Daniel Fitzgibbon
Robert Gregush
Albert Hergott
Sonny Johnson
Louis Kraus
William McDuffie
Susan Daly, *secretary*

Employee Retirement

Frank Smeal, *chairperson*
John Bragg
Donald Daly
George Dorsey
Joe Kraus
Virginia Turner
Michael Alexander, *consultant*
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Robert Pearson, *secretary*
Dennis Manders, *assistant secretary*

Finance

Frank Smeal, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
David Aronofsky
John Bragg
Buck Bruner
Stan Cameron
Donald Daly
W. J. Estelle Jr.
Robert Morse
John Ryall
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Dennis Manders, *secretary*

International

Stan Cameron, *chairperson*
Donald Daly
William Flynn, M.D.
Louis Kraus
Ann Macfarlane
Hal Marley
John Norris, M.D.
James Shannon
Isa Stanfiel, *consultant*
Phyllis Masback, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

Kenneth Williams, M.D., *chairperson*
Buck Bruner
Donald Daly
Richard Driscoll
Louis Kraus
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
John Ryall
Lyla Bonney, *co-secretary*
Sarah Price, *co-secretary*

Literature

Michael Alexander, *chairperson*
David Aronofsky
Albert Hergott
Fernand Ippersiel
Mary Phelps
Virginia Turner
Kenneth Williams, M.D.
Janet Graves, *consultant*
Curtis Monahan, *secretary*

Nominating

George Dorsey, *chairperson*
Stan Cameron
John Bragg
Richard Driscoll
W. J. Estelle Jr.
Joe Kraus
John Ryall
Jacquelyn Solomon
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

Public Information

Jacquelyn Solomon, *chairperson*
William Dowling
Robert Durling
Frank Mauser
Philip Parker
Mary Phelps
Eduardo Ramos
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
Desmond Towey
Loudon Wainwright
John Bragg, *consultant*
Sean Callery, *consultant*
William Croke, *consultant*
Jerry Danzig, *consultant*
Vinnie McCarthy, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

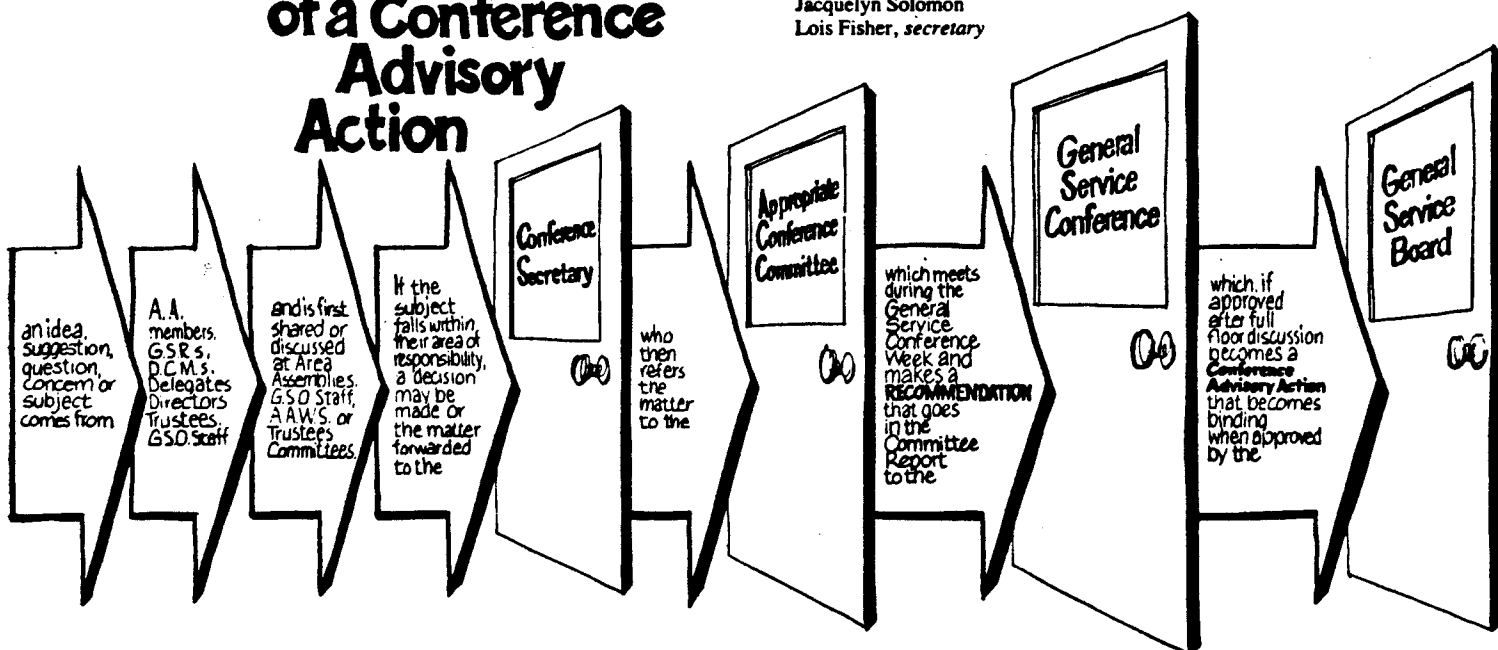
Gordon Patrick, *chairperson*
James Barry
Buck Bruner
William Flynn, M.D.
Fernand Ippersiel
Bill Jason
Thomas Jasper
Earl Mullen
Robert Stuckey, M.D.
Kenneth Williams, M.D.
Beth Kuhlmann, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

George Dorsey, *chairperson*
Sarah Price, *secretary*
All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Milton Maxwell, Ph.D., and Robert Pearson are ex officio members of all committees. Committee secretaries and consultants do not vote.

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



"Were it not for Committees, it is doubtful that any Conference could get over a fraction of the ground it now covers. As the Conference has grown in size and influence the Committees' importance has grown even more."
...from the A.A. Service Manual, p.72.

1982 Conference Members

Nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D. (25 Bacchus Ct., 3300 Carpenter Rd. S.E., Olympia, WA 98503), was elected to the board in April 1971 and became its chairperson in 1978. Before his retirement in 1975, he was professor of sociology in the Center of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University, New Brunswick, N.J. From 1965 through 1973, he was also executive director of the Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies. For 18 years prior to that, he was on the faculty of Washington State University, Pullman. He has published many research papers dealing with alcohol, alcoholics, and A.A.

Michael Alexander (150 E. 69th St., New York, NY 10021) was elected a trustee in 1976 after 20 years as legal adviser to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, P.C., he was an associate of the late Bernard Smith—so significant in A.A. history. Mike is a director of the British American Chamber of Commerce, a trustee and past president of the Consular Law Society, and a director of the Ireland-U.S. Council for Commerce and Industry. He is chairperson of the Literature Committee, a member of the Conference and Finance Committees, and nonvoting consultant on the Employee Retirement Committee.

W. J. Estelle Jr. (director, Texas Department of Corrections, Box 99, Huntsville, TX 77340) was named a trustee in April 1977. He was born in Indiana and educated in California, where he began his career in corrections in 1952. He then spent two years as warden of Montana State Prison. Jim has taught courses in corrections in two California colleges and is a member of seven professional societies concerned with criminal justice, corrections, and services to children and youth. He is chairperson of the Committee on Correctional Facilities and also serves on the Finance and Nominating Committees.

William E. Flynn, M.D. (1164 Old Gate Ct., McLean, VA 22101), joined the board in April 1980. A graduate of the Georgetown University School of Medicine, he was certified in psychiatry by the American Board of Psychiatry and Neurology. Currently assistant professor of psychiatry at Georgetown and director of studies in alcohol and drug abuse, he also serves as a consultant to the National Center for Alcohol Education and to the alcohol treatment unit at Arlington Hospital, in Virginia. Bill is chairperson of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee, and a member of the International and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Gordon M. Patrick (Box 100, Lyndhurst, Ont. K0E 1N0, Canada), elected to the board in 1975, is a senior consultant with the management consulting firm of Beech & Partners, Ltd., Toronto, and a consultant to the Donwood Institute. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario, he is a member of the Association of Labor-Management Administrators and Consultants on Alcoholism. Gordon is chairperson of the Treatment Facilities Committee and also serves on the Committees on Archives and Cooperation With the Professional Community.

Frank Smeal (Goldman Sachs & Co., 55 Broad St., New York, NY 10004) began service as treasurer of the General Service Board in April 1979. He is partner and member of the management committee of an investment banking firm, after 30 years with Morgan Guaranty Trust Company, New York. He has degrees from Pennsylvania State University, the Har-

vard Graduate School of Business Administration, and New York University Law School. Frank is a trustee and member of the executive committee of the Citizens' Budget Commission and a member and former chairperson of the Government and Federal Agencies Securities Committee of the Public Securities Association. He chairs the Employee Retirement and Finance Committees.

Kenneth H. Williams, M.D. (Neumann Addiction Treatment Center, St. Joseph's Hospital, 12th and Walnut Sts., Reading, PA 19603), joined our board in 1979. Now director of a community-oriented alcoholism treatment program, he has been on the faculties of the Yale and University of Pittsburgh Schools of Medicine and a medical consultant to the Governor's Council on Drug and Alcohol Abuse (Pennsylvania) and to a residential detoxification program for alcoholics. Ken is chairperson of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee, and a member of the Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community, Literature, and Treatment Facilities.

Diligence beyond the call of duty

Early in Conference week, Tony Osnato received a late-evening telephone call from the Roosevelt Hotel's convention manager. Hearing much shouting and commotion at the other end, Tony conjured up visions of a wild party. But it seemed the convention manager was so concerned with the welfare of our trusted servants that he just had to take time out from an exciting hockey game (and a \$75 seat) at Madison Square Garden to make sure that all was well.

Alcoholic (Class B) trustees

David H. Aronofsky (2503 W. Jefferson, Dallas, TX 75211) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in May 1981. Dave has been chairperson of Dallas Metroplex Intergroup and of the Conference Finance Committee, as a Panel 27 delegate. He has remained active in area service. A doctor of dental surgery, Dave belongs to five professional organizations. He serves on the Conference, Finance, International, and Literature Committees.

John K. Bragg (2295 Pinehaven Dr., Schenectady, NY 12309), elected general service trustee in May 1981, is chairperson of the A.A.W.S. board, and a member of the Conference, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Finance Committees. John has his own management consultant firm in the technology and research fields.

O. S. (Buck) Bruner (5161 Windridge Dr., Indianapolis, IN 46226) joined the board as East Central U.S. regional trustee in May 1981. With a background of intergroup, area, and state service, Buck was a Panel 28 Conference delegate. He is owner of one trucking company, part owner of another, and head of his own agency. Buck serves as a Grapevine director and a member of the Finance, Treatment Facilities, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

Stan N. Cameron (P.O. Box 1201, Saskatoon, Sask. S7M

2X4, Canada) became Canadian trustee-at-large in 1979. He was a Panel 26 delegate after service as a G.S.R., intergroup representative, and roundup and public information chairperson. Stan helped set up two A.A. central offices. He is chairperson of a halfway house and member of an occupational alcoholism association. He has had governmental and union experience, and is now president of an industrial-relations consulting firm. He serves on the Grapevine Corporate Board, on the Nominating and Finance Committees, as chairperson of the International Committee, and as a U.S./Canada delegate to the World Service Meeting (1980-82).

Donald F. Daly (1361 Madison Ave., New York, NY 10028) was elected as a general service trustee in April 1980, to join the board in August. Don has served groups in Northport (Long Island), N.Y., and in Manhattan in most capacities. On the Grapevine Corporate Board since 1976, he is now its chairperson. Don is an investment counselor, former secretary of the Investment Counsel Association of America. He is a member of the Finance, Employee Retirement, International, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

George Dorsey (4761 Paradise Dr., Tiburon, CA 94920) was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1978. He was a Panel 25 delegate and chairperson of the 1976 Conference Finance Committee. George had previously served as a G.S.R., D.C.M., and alternate delegate. Prior to general service activities, he served for several years in various capacities for the San Francisco Bay Area Intercounty Fellowship. George is executive vice-president and director of an insurance corporation. He serves as chairperson of the Nominating Committee and the General Sharing Session, and a member of the Conference and Employee Retirement Committees.

Richard J. Driscoll (129 Rhinebeck Ave., Springfield, MA 01129) was named Northeast U.S. regional trustee in 1979 after serving as G.S.R., on P.I., C.P.C., institutions, and area committees, at an intergroup, and as a Panel 22 delegate. Besides belonging to various health and civic societies, Dick does volunteer work for two local non-A.A. alcoholism agencies. A licensed public accountant, he is now an officer in a bank and trust company. He is treasurer of the A.A.W.S. Board, and a member of the Nominating, Finance, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

Kenneth L. Dunphy (115 Humphrey St., Moncton, N.B. E1C 6P2, Canada), elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1982, has been active in district and area A.A. service and was a Conference delegate in 1976-77. Ken's background is in the electro-mechanical field; he was a draftsman in the mining industry and the Canadian Federal Government, for which he now works as a drafting supervisor. At his present office, he is A.A. contact for the Employee Assistance Program.

Albert J. Hergott (Box 220, St. Louis, Sask. S0J 2C0, Canada) became Western Canada regional trustee in May 1981, to serve three years (filling out the term of his late predecessor, elected in 1980). On Panel 28, Al chaired the Conference Literature Committee. Formerly in the merchandising field, he is now consultant to an investment company and chief executive officer of a correctional institution. Al serves on the Literature, Correctional Facilities, and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees, and chairs the subcommittee to review literature.

Fernand Ippersiel (1025 Sherbrook E., #1504, Montreal, Que. H2L 1L4, Canada) was chosen Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1978. He was a Panel 18 Conference delegate and became editor of *La Vigne A.A.* in 1969. He was one of the translators of the Big Book and the Twelve Concepts into French. Fernand is a TV director, chairperson of the Archives Committee, and a member of the Literature and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Joe F. Kraus (P.O. Drawer G, Lawrenceburg, TN 38464) joined the board as Southeast U.S. regional trustee in May 1981. After a term as a delegate (Panel 26), Joe returned to area activities. He has been in insurance, real estate, and finance, has his own company specializing in the last two fields, and has also taken part in many aspects of community service. Joe is an A.A.W.S. director, and a member of the Archives and Nominating Committees.

John Ryall (32 Garden Ave., Carle Place, NY 11514) was elected general service trustee in 1979, after three years as a Grapevine director. John has been a delegate (Panel 21) and was instrumental in founding the Northeast Region's Delegates Association. A marketing specialist for a major communications network, he serves on the Finance, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Nominating Committees, and as treasurer of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Natalie Schwanke (1406 N.E. 35th, Bellevue, WA 98007) was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1982. She has served both Seattle Intergroup and her area, which sent her to the Conference as delegate in 1975-76. Outside A.A., Natalie has been active in community affairs, formerly as P.T.A. president and currently as a board member at a treatment center.

Jacquelyn (Jackie) Solomon (303 E. 37th St., New York, NY 10016) became a general service trustee in May 1981, having been an A.A.W.S. director since 1976. Jackie has also been involved in group, intergroup, and area service. Her background is in the fashion sales field, but she is now a distributor/supervisor in the field of nutrition. Jackie is chairperson of the Public Information Committee, and a member of the Conference and Nominating Committees.

Joan Ullom (P.O. Box 42, Aurora, SD 57002) was elected in 1982 to serve the remaining two years of the late Bud Grondahl's term as West Central U.S. regional trustee. A Conference delegate in 1976-77, Joan has taken a particular interest in her area's public information and archives work, becoming chairperson of both committees. In 1971, she started a county center for alcohol and drug information and referral, staffed chiefly by volunteers.

¹ Retiring at close of 1982 Conference meeting

² New trustee, becoming a Conference member immediately after election by the General Service Board, April 24, 1982

A.A. World Services directors

John Bragg, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
Richard Driscoll
Joe Kraus
Louis Kraus

Robert Pearson
Sarah Price
Jacquelyn Solomon
Virginia Turner

A.A. Grapevine directors

Donald Daly, *chairperson, president*
Stan Cameron
Retha Gresham, *secretary, vice-president*

Tom Neary
Mary Phelps
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
John Ryall, *treasurer*
Jim Shannon

General Service Office staff

Robert Pearson, *general manager*
Frank Mauser, *administrative assistant*
Lyla Bonney
Susan Daly
Lois Fisher
Beth Kuhlmann

Betty Liddle
Phyllis Masback
Vincina McCarthy
Curtis Monahan
Sarah Price
Jane Russell
Helen Turnquest

Grapevine staff

Retha Gresham, *managing editor*

Tom Neary, *associate editor*

G.S.O./Grapevine personnel assisting at the Conference (nonvoting)

Norman Bradley, *supervisor, Data Control*
Charles Columbia, *assistant controller/internal auditor*
Louis D'Amelio, *supervisor, Mail Department*
Owen J. Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*
Elizabeth Garcia, *supervisor, Steno/Clerical Department*
Edward Gordon, *assistant controller/manager, supporting departments*
Dorothy Graham, *writer, Conference Report*
Shirley Grant, *personnel manager/interdepartmental coordinator*
Janet Graves, *editor, Conference Report*
Robert Hughie, *supervisor, Shipping Department*
Wilma Joseph, *supervisor, File Department*
John Kirwin Jr., *supervisor, Accounting Department*
Lena Machado, *supervisor, Records Department*
Dennis Manders, *controller/business administrator*
Dorothy McGinity, *Conference Manual coordinator*
Don Meurer, *Grapevine controller*
John L. Norris, M.D., *trustee emeritus*
Tony Osnato, *office manager*
Naomi Strassberg, *Grapevine executive secretary*
Ann Warner, *Grapevine associate editor*
Madeline Whitlock, *secretary, A.A. World Services*
Adeline Wilmot, *assistant to the Conference coordinator*
Nell Wing, *archivist*

Observers (nonvoting) from the following may also attend:

Trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities
Trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community
Trustees' Finance Committee
Trustees' Literature Committee
Trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities
Trustees' Public Information Committee
Grapevine Editorial Board

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 32nd Conference includes Panel 31 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 32 (new delegates).

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	31	Art Ludwig Sr., 1511 Cahaba River Estates, Bessemer, AL 35023
Alaska	2	32	Jim McCourt, P.O. Box 280, Wasilla, AK 99687
Arizona	3	32	Mary DeFer, 4733 W. Mediterranean Dr., Glendale, AZ 85301
Arkansas	4	31	Charles (Charlie) Parmley, Rte. 1, Maysville, AR 72747
California	5	31	Southern — Jim Ockerman, 10831 Roycroft St. #82, Sun Valley, CA 91352
	6	31	Northern Coastal — Samuel (Sam) Eddy Jr., 1255 N. Walnut, C-57, Napa, CA 94558
	7	32	Northern Interior — Derral G. Campbell, 7720 Robles Dr., Redding, CA 96001
	8	32	San Diego — Don Callahan, 463 E. Bobier, Vista, CA 92083
	9	32	Mid-Southern — Dyanne Gilliam, 202 11th St. #9, Huntington Beach, CA 92648
Colorado	10	31	Don I. Pritts, 1009 S. Lewiston Way, Aurora, CO 80012
Connecticut	11	31	Cynthia Fifield, 46 Wilshire Rd., Madison, CT 06443
Delaware	12	32	James A. Reeves, 1543 Savannah Rd., Lewes, DE 19958
District of Columbia	13	31	John W. (Jack) Atwell, 1131 University Blvd. #1518, Silver Spring, MD 20902
Florida	14	31	Northern — Thomas J. Lepinski, 1167 Park Dr., Casselberry, FL 32707
	15	31	Southern — Lenore Tate, 2418 Hayes St. #8, Hollywood, FL 33020
Georgia	16	32	John Langston, 2053 Woodberry Ave., East Point, GA 30344
Hawaii	17	31	June M. Boranian, 16 Kahoa St., Hilo, HI 96720

State	Area no.	Panel	
Idaho	18	32	William T. Dick, 1064 Hillview, Idaho Falls, ID 83402
Illinois	19	31	Chicago — Dolores Colford, 1052 E. 100th Pl., Chicago, IL 60628
	20	32	Northern — John Goetschel, 3327 W. Elm St., McHenry, IL 60050
	21	31	Southern — Robert J. (Bob) French, R.R. 2, Box 37-B, Astoria, IL 61501
Indiana	22	31	Northern — John W. (Bill) Peters, 1726 Crabtree La., Elkhart, IN 46514
	23	32	Southern — Jill S. Johnston, 26 Druid Hill Dr., Carmel, IN 46032
Iowa	24	31	Doris Beacom, 1808 Jackson St., Sioux City, IA 51105
Kansas	25	32	Robert Talkington, 10308 W. 61st St., Shawnee Mission, KS 66203
Kentucky	26	32	Billy Moore, Rte. 1, Box 108, Casey Creek, KY 42723
Louisiana	27	31	Jack Elbert, 3885 Greenway Pl., Shreveport, LA 71105
Maine	28	32	Frank Rinaldo, R.F.D. 1, P.O. Box 515, Rumford, ME 04276
Maryland	29	32	Frank Youell, Bay City 17-21, Stevensville, MD 21666
Massachusetts	30	31	Eastern — William J. (Bill) Downey, 33 Lafayette St. Ext., Amesbury, MA 01913
	31	32	Western — Elizabeth M. (Betty) Reed, 206 Merrimac Ave., Springfield, MA 01105
Michigan	32	31	Central — John R. (Jack) Whitehouse, 19225 Woodbine, Apt. 37, Detroit, MI 48219
	33	31	Southeastern — Clyde Swaim, 18002 Prosper, East Detroit, MI 48021
	34	32	Western — Ronald (Ron) Bush, 511 S. Broas, Belding, MI 48809
Minnesota	35	32	Northern — Tom LeTourneau, Lot 10, Lakeland Mobile Home Park, Gilbert, MN 55741
	36	31	Southern — Stan Mann, R.R. 1, Box 158, Birch Echo Rd., Minnesota City, MN 55959
Mississippi	37	32	Percy Moore, 5107 Maid Marion Dr., Pascagoula, MS 39567

State	Area no.	Panel	
Missouri	38	31	Eastern — Carlene Reel, 10338 Yarwood Ct., St. Louis, MO 63136
	39	31	Western — LaVerne (Blackie) Brandon, 306 Wall St., Joplin, MO 64801
Montana	40	32	Ray Vevik, 419 Connell Ave., Missoula, MT 59801
Nebraska	41	32	Derald L. (Cork) Oberg, Rte. 1, Ericson, NE 68637
Nevada	42	31	Gregory B. (Greg) MacNeil, 3940 Rice Rd., Fallon, NV 89406
New Hampshire	43	32	Richard E. (Dick) Darling, 29 Noyes St., Concord, NH 03301
New Jersey	44	31	Northern — Stan (Stash) Brys, 29 Rose St., South River, NJ 08882
	45	32	Southern — Madge Mansfield, 111 Thornhill Rd., Cherry Hill, NJ 08003
New Mexico	46	32	David Leonard, 800 Spruce Ave., Alamogordo, NM 88310
New York	47	31	Central — Maurice M. Welch, 263 Homcroft Rd., Syracuse, NY 13206
	48	32	Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire — John D. Currier, P.O. Box 201, West Winfield, NY 13491
	49	31	Southeastern — Alex Macaulay, 34-57 82nd St., #2C, Jackson Heights, NY 11372
	50	32	Western — George Lathrop, R.D. #3, Box 148A, Olean, NY 14760
	51	31	Gertrude Brown, 2714 Gordon St., Raleigh, NC 27608
North Dakota	52	32	Elmer Johnsrud, 714 2nd Ave. E., Williston, ND 58801
Ohio	53	31	* Central & Southeastern — Roscoe Betsill, 2319 Ridgeway Ave., Columbus, OH 43219
	54	31	Northeastern — Joan H. Anderson, 1326 Orlando Ave., Akron, OH 44320
	55	32	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Michigan — Margaret A. (Peggy) Screptock, 2205 Mescher Dr., Monclova, OH 43542
	56	32	S.W. Ohio/N. Kentucky — Ralph L. Huelsman, 241 N. Walnut St., St. Henry, OH 45883

*Alternate

State	Area no.	Panel		Area no.	Panel	
Oklahoma	57	31	LaVern Walker, 1400 W. Blue Starr Dr., #6F, Claremore, OK 74017	Puerto Rico	77	32 Luis Raul Hernandez, P.O. Box 6222, Arecibo, PR 00612
Oregon	58	32	Diana M. Salnave, 371 N.E. Village Sq. Ave., #20, Gresham, OR 97030	Canada		
Pennsylvania	59	31	Eastern — Lee Brooks, 875 W. Miner St., West Chester, PA 19380	Province		
	60	31	Western — B. (Bud) Turner, 1657 Skyline Dr., Pittsburgh, PA 15227	Alberta/Northwest Territories	78	32 Ken Treganowan, 11143 77 Ave., Edmonton, Alta. T6G 0L5
Rhode Island	61	32	Gerard (Gerry) Coutu, Rocky Hill Rd., Box 530, North Scituate, RI 02857	British Columbia/Yukon	79	31 W. F. (Webb) Johnson, Box 38, Sta. A, North Vancouver, B.C. V6C 2L3
South Carolina	62	32	William H. (Bill) Blount, P.O. Box 1041, Beaufort, SC 29902	Manitoba	80	32 Phil Cels, 5 Balmoral Bay, Brandon, Man. R7A 6E5
South Dakota	63	32	Mabel A. Moebeck, Box 446, Edgemont, SD 57735	New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island	81	32 Myron Snow, P.O. Box 1542, Sackville, N.B. E0A 3C0
Tennessee	64	32	W. Buford (Lew) Lewallen, 405 Eagle Bend La., Clinton, TN 37716	Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	82	31 Eddie MacMullin, 4 Division La., Glace Bay, N.S. B1A 5H1
Texas	65	31	Northeastern — Joe French, 1136 S. Brighton, Dallas, TX 75208	Ontario	83	31 Eastern — Gordon Dracup, 91 Park St. S., Peterborough, Ont. K9J 3R6
	66	32	Northwestern — Doug Riley, Box 743, Snyder, TX 79549		84	31 Northeastern — Bernard (Skip) Murphy, 272 Laurier Ave., Sault Ste. Marie, Ont. P6C 5J2
	67	31	Southeastern — Martha L. Wat- son, 6231 Westward, #37, Houston, TX 77081		85	31 Northwestern — Arthur Cald- well, R.R. #3, Thunder Bay, Ont. P7C 4V2
	68	32	Southwestern — Clyde Mitchell, 808 Hybiscus, Victoria, TX 77904	Quebec	86	32 Western — Barney John Malik, 74 Glen Castle Dr., Hamilton, Ont. L8K 5Z5
Utah	69	31	Jesse G. Bowen, 953 South 100 East, Orem, UT 84057		87	32 Southwestern — Stella Lefebvre, Box 26, Lachute, Que. J8H 3X2
Vermont	70	32	Sarah Gunzinger, R.F.D. #1, Perkinsville, VT 05151		88	31 *Southeastern — Rosaire Vanasse, 585 Fortin, Sherbrooke, Que. J1E 2Z1
Virginia	71	31	Dorothy (Dottie) Rapp, 218 Forest Dr., Falls Church, VA 22046		89	31 Northeastern — Marcel Labrie, 54 Rue Boucher, Loretteville, Que. G2B 3C8
Washington	72	31	Richard W. (Dick) Pittard, 1002 S. 144th St., Tacoma, WA 98444		90	32 Northwestern — Roland (Rolly) Brunet, 2020 Jasmine Cres. #1111, Ottawa, Ont. K1J 8K4
West Virginia	73	31	Bill Bailey, 2 Dry Ridge Pl., St. Albans, WV 25177	Saskatchewan	91	32 Garnet Wipf, 1139 22nd St. E., Prince Albert, Sask. S6V 1P2
Wisconsin	74	32	N. Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan — John Heidemann, Rte. #1, Box 490, Ishpeming, MI 49849			
	75	31	Southern — John C. Brémer, 3212 S. Burrell St., Milwaukee, WI 53207			
Wyoming	76	32	Dave McHenry, 3528 Duff Ave., Cheyenne, WY 82001			

*Alternate

Books

Booklets

Pamphlets

If You Are a Professional . . .	58,000
Inside A.A.	93,000
Is A.A. for You?	539,200
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	192,400
It Happened to Alice	92,100
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	63,700
The Jack Alexander Article	80,200
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	32,900
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	149,000
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	150,600
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	56,300
A Newcomer Asks . . .	328,600
Problems Other Than Alcohol	114,600
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	242,300
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	42,000
This Is A.A.	496,900
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	43,100
Time to Start Living	119,000
Time to Start Living (large print)	14,500
Too Young?	187,700
Twelve Concepts for World Service	5,000
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	69,200
Understanding Anonymity	219,700
What Happened to Joe	97,300
Young People and A.A.	255,500
Foreign translations	135,300
Total	6,221,300

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards — two-fold	891,800
Wallet cards — I Am Responsible	115,400
Wallet cards — Anonymity	44,900
Parchment — scrolls	6,200
Placards	700
A.A. Guidelines	81,500
Group Handbook	4,900
Wire racks	1,800
Cassettes	3,000
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette)	1,700
Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records)	2,000
A.A. Public Information Workbook	900
Hanging displays	1,900
Fact Files	6,400
Total	1,163,100

Circulation 4/1/81—124,300; 4/1/82—122,470

Increase/decrease: 1,700, 1,700, 1,700, 1,700, 1,700, 1,700						Increase/decrease: 1,700, 1,700, 1,700, 1,700, 1,700, 1,700											
U.S.		No. GvRs		Circulation		Increase/ de- crease	U.S.		No. GvRs		Circulation		Increase/ de- crease				
4/81	4/82	4/1/81	4/1/82	4/81	4/82		4/1/81	4/1/82	4/81	4/82	4/1/81	4/1/82					
Ala.	31	43	1,152	1,105	- 47	Mont.	69	86	751	758	+ 7	P.R.	4	4	129	113	- 16
Alsk.	13	18	383	380	- 3	Nebr.	102	161	1,732	1,724	- 8	U.S.Poss.	—	—	9	14	+ 5
Ariz.	73	84	1,294	1,257	- 37	Nev.	6	12	441	413	- 28		4,292	5,717	105,989	105,177	
Ark.	87	92	635	656	+ 21	N.H.	33	40	812	805	- 7						Decrease for period: 812
Calif.	326	423	10,741	10,591	- 150	N.J.	61	84	3,246	3,104	- 142	Canada					
Colo.	65	71	1,488	1,462	- 26	N.M.	26	26	643	642	- 1	Alta.	58	73	2,023	2,021	- 2
Conn.	48	126	2,119	2,343	+ 224	N.Y.	204	283	7,825	7,417	- 408	B.C./Yukon	44	72	2,662	2,436	- 226
Del.	29	47	313	330	+ 17	N.C.	62	146	2,478	2,522	+ 44	Man.	22	34	1,143	981	- 162
D.C.	70	71	556	454	- 102	N.Dak.	103	198	878	845	- 33	N.B./P.E.I.	11	50	676	594	- 82
Fla.	151	220	4,546	4,521	- 25	Ohio	244	265	3,845	3,855	+ 10	N.S./Nfld./ Lab.	38	60	1,347	1,354	+ 7
Ga.	165	205	2,206	2,059	- 147	Okla.	66	91	1,648	1,718	+ 70	Ont.	287	413	6,521	6,067	- 454
Haw.	41	41	306	325	+ 19	Oreg.	42	61	1,053	1,023	- 30	Que.	12	20	508	502	- 6
Idaho	30	36	590	854	+ 264	Pa.	203	311	3,638	3,625	- 13	Sask.	58	78	1,451	1,423	- 28
Ill.	88	119	4,868	4,708	- 160	R.I.	36	36	628	579	- 49		530	800	16,331	15,378	
Ind.	80	220	1,822	1,873	+ 51	S.C.	123	160	1,348	1,454	+ 106						Decrease for period: 953
Iowa	51	63	1,777	1,755	- 22	S.Dak.	17	29	826	819	- 7	Foreign	16	32	1,981	1,915	- 66
Kans.	41	58	1,608	1,626	+ 8	Tenn.	149	163	1,315	1,254	- 61		4,838	6,549	124,301	122,470	
Ky.	38	40	993	976	- 17	Tex.	104	202	4,578	4,548	- 30	Total					Decrease for period: 1,831
La.	35	44	1,294	1,333	+ 39	Utah	76	80	386	362	- 24						
Me.	19	34	757	765	+ 8	Vt.	15	18	476	425	- 51						
Md.	57	71	1,965	2,254	+ 289	Va.	259	171	2,815	2,811	- 4						
Mass.	77	99	4,580	4,265	- 315	Wash.	61	107	2,834	2,807	- 27						
Mich.	127	159	3,654	3,633	- 21	W.Va.	42	47	619	593	- 26						
Minn.	198	190	5,262	5,258	- 4	Wis.	118	172	3,011	3,069	+ 58						
Miss.	21	30	714	716	+ 2	Wyo.	47	55	327	359	+ 32						
Mo.	59	105	2,075	2,020	- 55				105,851	104,050							